

**ADVISORY ACTIONS  
OF THE  
GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE OF  
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

**1951-2025**

**Advisory  
Actions**

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"While no one can speak for A.A. officially, the Conference [through its Advisory Actions] comes close to being A.A.'s voice. It cannot be an A.A. authority, but it can bring into free discussion problems and trends and dangers that seem to affect Fellowship harmony, purpose, and effectiveness."

—*The A.A. Service Manual*  
(page S81, 1998-99 edition)

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## Introduction

From the Report of the first annual General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous (1951):

### The Sense of the Meeting

“‘Genuine faith,’ a thoughtful spiritual leader tells us, ‘is more than insight. It is always the “beginning of action.” It is propulsive. It fortifies the will. *It begins as an experiment and ends as an experience.*’ The first General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous fulfilled each particular of that definition. It was an unbounded expressions of faith in the future of Alcoholics Anonymous.

“The Conference reflected the insight of the earliest members into the crucial problems of continuing A.A. unity, continuing service to individuals and groups already in A.A., and the compelling need to reach and help ‘the million who still don’t know.’

“The Conference was, in truth, *the beginning of action*, designed to preserve and strengthen A.A. This constructive action was expressed in two ways. Through the Conference, the founders and their friends, who have sustained A.A. from the beginning, delivered to the membership the legacy of service which began in Akron, Ohio, sixteen years ago. Through the Conference, the total membership is acquiring new knowledge of, and responsibility for, this legacy.

“The General Service Conference was evolved not to govern A.A. in any sense but to serve the entire movement. The Conference serves A.A. by assuming responsibility for basic direction of the General Service Office in New York and by advising the Alcoholic Foundation,<sup>1</sup> the custodian of A.A. policy and tradition at the national level. . . .

“One of the problems facing the Conference from the moment it convened was how to get ‘the sense of the meeting’ on the most important matters presented to the Conference. . . . The need for a minimum number of committees to review various subjects considered during the meeting and prepare reports for approval (or rejection) by the full Conference soon became apparent. By common consent, it was agreed committees on the following should be constituted:

1. Advisory Committee on the Budget
2. Committee on Agenda (to select issues for consideration by the Conference at its final meeting.)
3. Committee on the Conference Report
4. Committee on New Trustees”

At the Fourth General Service Conference in 1954, a summary of previous Conference activity was reported. The six basic reasons underlying the co-founders’ 1950 proposal for a General Service Conference were reviewed. They were:

- “1. Realization that Dr. Bob and Bill ‘could not last forever.’
2. The fact that the trustees were generally unknown to the movement.
3. Recognition that the trustees would need future guidance from the movement itself.
4. Appreciation that A.A. was ‘growing up’ and was able to assume rightful responsibility for its Headquarters<sup>2</sup> and services.
5. The importance of bringing the trustees into closer contact with the movement.
6. The need to be as completely prepared as possible to face some potentially grave crisis with action in the best interest of all A.A.s. . . .

“Major developments at each of the three previous Conferences were outlined. It was recalled, for example, that the first Conference in 1951, representing only half of the Conference territories, had wisely deferred making a number of decisions until full representation would be on hand the following year. The 1951 sessions were notable for providing patterns for conducting future meetings, particularly in the matter of devising simple means of selecting Conference committees and in developing Conference Advisory Actions for the information and guidance of the trustees.

“In 1952, with full representation, the Conference reviewed and considered a number of policy problems affecting the movement as a whole and initiated a planned program of Conference-approved literature service.

“The 1953 Conference, emphasizing ‘maturity,’ marked a further step toward full participation by the delegates in all matters of general interest. Special provision was made for full consideration of questions, comments and criticisms from A.A. areas. Nearly 40 topics were placed on the agenda anonymously, through a convenient question box.”

### Full Participation

“It was pointed out that the 1954 Conference represented a further extension of the ‘full-participation’ policy, since nine policy matters had been submitted to the movement

<sup>1</sup> Now the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous.

<sup>2</sup> Now known as the General Service Office.



for discussion prior to the meeting and a full Conference session had been set aside 'for Delegates only.'

"Experience of the past three Conferences has demonstrated, the secretary said, that 'the Conference truly is not a governing or legislative body. Instead it is a service group which in its actions, or even lack of action, faithfully reflects the collective conscience of the movement itself.'"

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In time, as other Conference Committees were formed, items from the various trustees' committees were submitted to the appropriate Conference Committees for consideration by the Conference, leading to how the Conference functions in the present.

For many years, the General Service Office distributed "A Summary: Advisory Actions of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous." It was a matter of editorial decision to select actions for inclusion and they were often reworded for clarity.

With the conclusion of fifty General Service Conferences, the time has come for a comprehensive book of Conference Advisory Actions. An attempt has been made to include every Advisory Action of every Conference. The only omissions were expressions of gratitude to the General Service Office and members of the staff. In years when there were no Actions from a particular committee, the year has been omitted. The original wording of the Advisory Actions has been used as much as possible. Rather than revise the wording for the sake of clarity, it

was the consensus that the actions as originally written are preferable for credibility as well as for historical and sentimental reasons.

In reviewing early Conference Reports, it is sometimes difficult to determine if an action was truly an "Advisory Action" as many actions were taken on the Conference floor in policy sessions rather than as committee recommendations and the wording was somewhat vague.

Since Admissions to the Conference are now a function of the Conference Committee on Conference Policy and Admissions, all actions relating to Conference Admissions are in that section, although in the early years Admissions comprised a separate committee and later became part of the Conference Agenda Committee.

Although Conference recommendations are no longer made at the Delegates Only Meeting, early Conference Reports indicate that at some Conferences, recommendations from the Delegates Only Meeting were considered Advisory Actions.

Since Conference Committees sometimes make recommendations relevant to other committees, many actions have been listed under the committee of origin, the relevant committee and in the General Category section, if applicable. This is also true of Floor Actions. The many duplications are an attempt to make this information as useful as possible.

This document reflects the group conscience of the Fellowship as it has emerged in the form of Conference Advisory Actions.







## Advisory Actions Relevant to the Conference Agenda Committee

**1951** It was recommended that:

Non-alcoholics should continue to serve on the Board of the Alcoholic Foundation.

In future years A.A. textbook literature should have Conference approval. (Prior to the vote on this subject, it was pointed out that adoption of the suggestion would not preclude the continued issuance of various printed documents by “non-Foundation” sources. No desire to review, edit, or censor non-Foundation material was implied. The objective was to provide in the future a means of distinguishing Foundation literature from that issued locally or by non-A.A. interests.)

The alcoholic members of the board of trustees ought to have a fixed term of office.

Attendance at next year’s Conference sessions be limited to members only. (In addition to delegates, Conference members include trustees of the Alcoholic Foundation and accredited staff members of the General Service Office and the Grapevine.

The subject of A.A. auxiliaries or family groups should be taken back to local groups for further discussion and should be considered at the 1952 General Service Conference.

Our temporary charter, as outlined in the Third Legacy pamphlet, is suitable for the coming three years and that the general principles guiding assemblies are also approved.

**1952** It was recommended that:

Before recommending topics for the 1953 Conference, the committee will correspond with all Conference committees, the board of trustees, and the General Service Office.

**1953** It was recommended that:

The panels conducted by the secretaries and including various delegates’ remarks were a highlight of this year’s agenda and should by all means be carried into next year’s program.

Whenever controversial issues arise after due discussion and to avoid needless hassling on the Conference floor and to avoid postponement and where apparently no conclusion is imminent, the chair should immediately select a committee of second-year delegates from the hat and ask them to retire to another room, talk the matter over, and come back with a recommendation.

**1954** It was recommended that:

Delegates having suggestions for the agenda for the closed or “unchaperoned” Conference session send such suggestions to the Conference secretary at least 90 days prior to the next Conference.

The first business session of the Conference open with a reading of the Preamble from Chapter V of the Big Book, together with the Twelve Suggested Steps and the Twelve Traditions. (Floor Action)

The opening session of each day would begin with some form of prayer, as may be suggested by the delegates. All other sessions to open with a brief period of silence. (Floor Action)

The Conference would adjourn its final session with the recitation of the Lord’s Prayer. (Floor Action)

A 2nd-year delegate serve as Chairman of “Area Delegates Only” sessions, with the vice-chairman a 1st-year delegate, succeeding to the chairmanship in the subsequent year. (Floor Action)

**1957** It was recommended that:

G.S.O. continue the briefing sessions for new delegates prior to the opening of Conference deliberations.

**1958** It was recommended that:

One full afternoon is too much time to devote to the *Grapevine*. The *Grapevine* report should be condensed to cover important facts concerning finances, circulation, the trends of both and what we can do about them.

G.S.O. continue briefing sessions for new delegates prior to opening of Conference deliberations.

**1959** It was recommended that:

The G.S.O. staff reports be given more time to provide more human-interest anecdotes, and that they be scheduled as the first order of business, one after the other, and not with other reports. Ten minutes is suggested for each report.

The selection of Conference Committees again be the second order of business in the opening morning session.

The General Service Board report and those of its committees be limited to five minutes each and scheduled with other business for the second Conference session in the afternoon, or in later sessions if desirable.

G.S.O. briefing session for new delegates prior to the opening of Conference deliberations be continued.

Delegates speaking from the floor limit themselves to three minutes.

The Puerto Rican flag be displayed with the American and Canadian flags at future Conferences.

**1960** It was recommended that:

An agenda similar to the 1960 Conference agenda be continued.

**1961** It was recommended that:

Area highlights be reported half by first-year and half by second-year delegates.

That all Conference participation be limited by clock to the following schedule: 10 minutes Panel Chairman, 5 minutes Panel Speakers & Reports, 3 minutes Area Highlights, 2 minutes from the floor.



**1962** It was recommended that:

The Area-Delegates-Only meeting be scheduled earlier in the Conference; that it be held on Thursday evening.

Area Highlights continue to include specific subjects relating to the 1963 Conference theme.

**1963** It was recommended that:

Subjects should be submitted to Agenda Committee throughout the year as they come up; suggest July and October Policy Committee meetings also review Conference discussion subjects.

If any vital or more important agenda subject comes to the attention of A.A.W.S. after approval of tentative agenda in October, it is requested that it, as well as an indication of which previously approved subject is to be eliminated, if any, be brought to attention of Agenda Committee for reaction prior to G.S.B.'s final determination.

Agenda Committee suggest specific subjects before finalizing the agenda.

G.S.O. review throughout coming year appropriate expression of gratitude to Bill and Lois—for presentation to 1964 Conference.

Any items not included on current agenda be offered to the succeeding committee.

Area highlights be continued around a central theme.

**1964** It was recommended that:

The 1965 Conference cover a six-day period.

The "Area Delegate Only" meeting be held on the third evening of the 1965 Conference.

The responsibilities and functions of Conference committees be explained thoroughly, prior to the selection of committee-men at future Conferences.

All members of the committee receive copies of all correspondence on agenda matters in which G.S.O. staff members and committee members are involved.

Committee members be informed of the action taken on their recommendations to the Policy Committee.

Committee members be notified of the dates of all General Service Board meetings and G.S.B. Policy Committee meetings so that suggestions may be forwarded in time to assure proper consideration and action prior to the 1965 Conference.

Committee members review background material on previous Conferences' actions, as a guide in preparing recommendations for the 1965 Conference agenda.

Consideration be given to scheduling panels on "Attraction versus Promotion" or on "Affiliation versus Cooperation."

A "Sharing Session" involving delegates and the G.S.O. staff be scheduled in 1965, and that the possibility of joint meetings of such Conference committees as "Agenda" and "Policy" be considered.

Consideration be given to the possibility of permitting ex-delegates to attend future Conferences at their own expense as spectators.

Consideration be given to the possibility of scheduling a workshop session on the functions of Conference committees.

**1965** It was recommended that:

Area Highlights be retained for next year's Conference, with recommendation that diversified topics be given to incoming panel delegates in order to avoid repetitious presentations.

The present Chairman retain his chairmanship until the following Conference, at which time the elected Co-Chairman will take over.

Committees include all delegates as active voting members and that alternates or observers be dispensed with.

The present method of choosing committee members be retained.

The Policy Committee and the board of trustees inform the Agenda Committee members of actions taken on proposed agenda subjects. A brief reason be given for rejections, if any.

Subjects approved for the agenda by Policy and board be made available to delegates through the *Interim Report [Quarterly Report]*, following the January quarterly meeting.

The workshops be retained.

The following items be considered by the Policy Committee of the board for next year's agenda:

Consideration be given to a review of the exclusion of a candidate for nomination of a Class B trustee within a 75 mile radius of the New York area.

The Delegates' Only Meeting be held before any consideration of the 5-Year Plan.

A presentation, discussion and guidance be given on the topic of bringing back the "Old Timers" to participate in group and area activity.

Consideration be given to arranging "Interview Time" at next Conference by staff territorial assignments.

**1966** It was recommended that:

The Agenda and Admissions Committees be combined, to be called the Conference Agenda-Admissions Committee.

"How do you present the spiritual side of the program to a newcomer?" be a discussion subject for the 17th (1967) General Service Conference.

Panel 17 delegates be asked to give 3-minute "Area Highlights" in 1967, each to choose his own subject.

"Interview Time," with Conference members divided into six regional groups, be used again in 1967.

"Workshops and Sharing Sessions" on Third Legacy structure and procedures be repeated in 1967, but with Conference members divided alphabetically into four groups instead of two.

When the Third Legacy Manual is updated, it should carry a glossary of terms such as *Area, District, Assembly*, etc. so terms can become more uniform throughout the continent.

**1967** It was recommended that:

The following subjects be considered for next year's agenda: how we can make A.A. more attractive to young people; duties and responsibilities of Committee members; keeping oldtimers active; "Fellowship—the Spirit of A.A." as possible theme; sharing A.A. inside and outside the Fellowship; keeping the faith; service to A.A.—what it means; and "my personal obligation outside A.A."

A review be made of Third Legacy electoral procedures.



More emphasis be placed upon workshops, and that we explore the possibility of breaking up into smaller groups after presentations; also, that a fresh look be taken at the method of forming workshops, using area size and population as criteria rather than region.

Delegates send agenda recommendations to G.S.O. before October.

**1968** It was recommended that:

A study of admissions procedures be conducted and that the Agenda/Admissions Committee meet in the fall of 1968 in New York after preliminary exploration through correspondence.

Delegates be informed of important issues so they can read prepared material and perhaps discuss before voting.

**1969** It was recommended that:

The committee continue to advise G.S.O. on agenda content and format and its broad approval of same following the board's approval in January.

The Conference format rotate emphasis on workshops and presentations on a yearly basis, with greater emphasis upon workshops.

The Sunday afternoon delegates' reception be continued as a hospitality fellowship reception of an informal nature, rather than as a more formal planned or pre-arranged meeting. (Delegates Only Meeting)

**1970** It was recommended that:

All Conference agenda subjects received during the year, where time permits, be referred to the Agenda/Admissions Committee before presentation to the Policy and board Committees for final approval.

A separate, one-page agenda be printed for the convenience of the delegates. (Delegates Only Meeting)

**1971** It was recommended that:

The Agenda/Admissions Committee remain Agenda/Admissions; that the "Admissions" part of this committee *not* become a part of the Committee on Conference Policy, as suggested by a former delegate.

The A.A. meeting on Monday night be retained, and that the G.S.O. staff be presented for short A.A. talks every other year, with a delegate chairman; also, that there be two delegate speakers with a delegate chairman on alternate years. This format to be reviewed *every year* by the Agenda/Admissions Committee.

The same format be used for workshops for next year's Conference, and the number of workshops be a minimum of two—more if possible.

Specific time be allotted to all speakers, and the "bell" rung no matter who is speaking; presentations be kept in brief form; nothing vital be scheduled after a presentation or session which may become controversial; gripe sessions be held between 3:00 and 5:00 p.m. when they can run into the evening session and not interfere with an important session; priorities be established as to which subjects are best for the groups as a whole; and Agenda/Admissions members send in opinions as to what modifications of present agenda should be made for next year's agenda prior to November 1, 1971.

In view of the heavy agenda this year and the apparent problem in completing it on time, some items (possibly of lower priority) be shown as optional subjects. These should be so placed

on the agenda that if we run out of time on earlier subjects, the optional items could be eliminated for that specific year.

It is the primary responsibility of the duly elected delegates to see that the heretofore agreed-upon contribution of \$150 toward Conference expenses be paid by March 1; if not received by March 1, a letter be sent directly to the delegate, pointing out that unless this area shares in the expenses of the Conference, said delegate will be referred to the Agenda/Admissions Committee for discussion.

The subject of clubs be a major item on the 1972 Conference agenda. (Floor Action)

The idea of considering February 14 or the month of February as a permanent special memorial time for Bill and others who have departed be placed on the agenda of the 1972 Conference. (Floor Action)

**1972** It was recommended that:

We follow the guidelines that we set up at last year's Conference: that the A.A. meeting on Monday night be retained, and that in even years we have delegate participation, and in odd years, we have G.S.O. and Grapevine staff participation for short talks with a delegate chairman. This format to be reviewed every year by the Agenda/Admissions Committee.

All motions that are to be acted upon by the delegation be, as *much as possible*, submitted in writing beforehand and, if time permits, be distributed to the delegates by mail.

Delegate participation in some way be scheduled on Monday.

Consideration be given to the following suggested agenda item: A scheduled workshop on inactive members be on the agenda for the 1973 Conference, and that there be no outline material (no scheduled questions).

**1973** It was recommended that:

We follow the guidelines set up at last year's Conference: that the A.A. meeting on Monday night be retained, and that in even years, we have delegate participation, and in odd years, we have G.S.O. and G.V. staff participation for short talks with a delegate chairman. This format to be reviewed every year by the Agenda/Admissions Committee.

In order to improve the functioning of the Agenda/Admissions Committee, it was suggested that:

Members of that committee, when writing to G.S.O., indicate on their letters when they wish copies to be sent to the other members of the committee.

Background material be sent to members of the Agenda/Admissions Committee on suggestions received for Conference agenda items.

Results of the Conference evaluation questionnaire be sent to members of the Agenda/Admissions Committee.

A discussion of special purpose groups be an agenda item for the 1974 General Service Conference. (Floor Action)

**1974** It was recommended that:

The A.A. meeting at the opening dinner be retained, and G.S.O. and G.V. staffs be presented for short talks every other year, with one delegate speaker. That there be delegate speakers with a delegate chairman on alternate years, and that this format be reviewed every year by the Agenda/Admissions committee.

The "admissions" function of the Agenda/Admissions Committee be transferred to the Committee on Conference



Policy, if agreeable to that committee. (**Note:** In the future the Agenda/Admissions Committee will be called the Committee on the Conference Agenda, and its Scope and History will be amended.)

This recommendation from the Committee on Conference Policy be considered: that as many Conference agenda items as possible be finalized for approval at the October Policy Committee and board meeting, so the November *Quarterly Report* will reflect this approval and allow for early assembly discussions, and that further agenda items be forwarded to the delegates as soon as the items have been approved.

The 1975 Conference theme be built around unity, love, and service, and these suggestions are offered for possible 1975 Conference themes:

- Unity Through Service
- Unity Through Service—Gateway to the Future
- The Traditions—Our Security
- Unity—Through Love and Service

The following agenda topics be considered for the 1975 Conference:

- a. Discussion or workshop on the growing trend of holding regional get-togethers for the past and present delegates and trustees
- b. Presentation followed by a workshop on the Twelve Concepts
- c. Presentation on "Understanding and Living the A.A. Traditions—Delegates Share Their Experience"
- d. Workshop on understanding the role of A.A. members who wear "two hats"
- e. Workshop on the responsibilities of district committee members
- f. Presentation on "Group Support for Group Service."

The midweek A.A. meeting continue to be scheduled, with the understanding that it may be omitted if time is needed to discuss unfinished Conference business.

**1975** It was recommended that:

The A.A. meeting at the opening dinner be retained, and the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs be presented for such talks every other year, with one delegate speaker. On alternate years, there be delegate speakers with a delegate chairman, and this format be reviewed every year by the Agenda Committee. The committee reviewed the recommendation received from the Committee on Conference Policy and Admissions that the opening-night A.A. meeting should always include the G.S.O. and G.V. staff members, but the committee prefers the original recommendation.

In view of the fact that the 1974 Conference spent many hours discussing the question of special purpose groups, it is the feeling of the committee that the Conference should concern itself with other matters, and that further discussion of this subject would *not* be productive at the present time. Therefore, it is the unanimous recommendation of this committee that a two-year moratorium (until 1977) be placed on discussion of special purpose groups.

The following suggestions for the 1976 Conference agenda be considered:

- a. Presentation followed by a workshop on sponsorship of the new member.

- b. Public information presentation and workshop with emphasis on the importance of carrying the message in this way.
- c. The suggestion from the Conference Institutions Committee that the subject of A.A. in hospitals be discussed at the Conference was accepted, and the committee suggests that the subject can best be discussed in a structured workshop.
- d. One unstructured workshop be retained for the 1976 Conference.
- e. A presentation and discussion on A.A. literature.
- f. The Ask-It Basket be retained in a one- to one-and-a-half-hour session
- g. Visit to G.S.O. and Grapevine be continued unless the time is needed for Conference business.

The delegates make every effort to send to G.S.O. no later than October 1 their suggestions for the 1976 Conference agenda, and those of their G.S.R.s and area committee members, for consideration.

The same basic format for the Conference agenda be retained.

The 1976 Conference theme be built around sponsorship; the following are suggestions for possible themes: (a) Sponsorship—the Language of the Heart; (b) Sharing Through Sponsorship; (c) Sponsorship—the Hand of A.A.; (d) Sponsorship—Sharing Our Way of Life; (e) Growth Through Sponsorship; (f) Sponsorship—Our Primary Purpose; (g) Love for One Another Through Sponsorship; (h) When Anyone, Anywhere. . . .

**1976** It was recommended that:

The A.A. meeting at the opening dinner be retained, and the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs be presented for talks every other year with one delegate speaker. On alternate years, that there be delegate speakers with a delegate chairman, and that this format be reviewed every year by the Agenda Committee.

The following suggestions for the 1977 General Service Conference be considered:

- a. The 1975 General Service Conference recommended a two-year moratorium be placed on the discussion of special purpose groups. The 1976 Agenda Committee, after much discussion, recommended that at this time there is no need for further discussion of this subject.
- b. Presentations followed by a workshop on the importance of rotation throughout the Fellowship.
- c. Cooperation and communication among all levels of service.
- d. Report on the A.A. directories.
- e. The word "Reports" be added to Area Service Highlights.
- f. A roll call of the Conference members be taken at the opening session of the Conference.
- g. A presentation followed by a workshop on the Conference Charter and Warranties.
- h. The importance of the role of the alternate in service.

The 1977 Conference theme be built around the A.A. group. The following are suggestions for possible themes: (a) "The A.A. Group—the Heart of Our Fellowship"; (b) "The A.A. Group—Foundation of Services"; (c) "The A.A. Group—Where It Begins"; (d) "Service—Our Assurance of Survival"; (e) "Our Group—Our Service—Our Life"; (f) "Group Responsibility"; (g) "Our Responsibility to the Group"; (h) "Group Leadership."



The delegates make every effort to send to G.S.O., no later than October 1, their suggestions for the 1977 Conference agenda and those of their G.S.R.'s and area committee members for consideration.

**1977** It was recommended that:

The format of the A.A. meeting be reviewed every year. It was further recommended that in 1978 the A.A. meeting be chaired by a G.S.O. staff member with three delegate speakers.

The following be subjects for presentations at the 1978 Conference:

- a. Finance
- b. Let's Carry the A.A. Message
- c. How Our General Service Office Serves Us
- d. The Participation of the G.S.R., the Vital Link Between the A.A. Group and the General Service Conference

The following be subjects for discussion at the 1978 Conference:

- a. Are We Letting Others Do Our Work?
- b. Who Establishes Policy in A.A.? You, That's Who

The following be topics for workshops at the 1978 Conference:

- a. A.A.—What We Can Do for the Alcoholic
- b. Working with Others Inside and Outside A.A.

The theme for the 1978 Conference be built around "The Individual and the Group: Growth Through Participation"; it was further recommended that the Twelve Steps, with emphasis on the Twelfth Step, be incorporated into the 1978 Conference agenda.

All Conference mailings and the monthly letter to delegates be sent to alternate delegates.

**1978** It was recommended that:

The theme of the 1979 General Service Conference be built around "The Legacies: *Our Heritage and My Responsibility*."

The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 1979 Conference consist of six speakers—three delegates and three members of the G.S.O./G.V. staff—and that all members of the G.S.O. and G.V. staff be seated on the dais. It was further recommended that the format of the meeting be reviewed each year by the Conference Agenda Committee.

The following be subjects for presentations at the 1979 Conference:

- a. Archives
- b. The Three Legacies
- c. Let Gratitude Be Our Attitude
- d. Are We Building a Class Distinction in Service?
- e. The Vote and the Voice—Who Is in Control?
- f. Our Responsibilities to the Future
- g. How Do Roundups, Jamborees, Cruises, Rallies, etc., Fit Into A.A. Tradition?

A topic for a workshop at the 1979 Conference be "Group Autonomy and A.A. Unity," and a question be included in this workshop concerning the difference between an A.A. group and an A.A. meeting.

The subject of listing special interest groups in the A.A. directories not be included on the agenda of the 1979 Conference.

In response to a request from a past delegate that levels of service (group, district, and area) be explored to try to determine if the current structure provides maximum opportunity for the

best possible service in the Fellowship, the committee felt that the current structure does provide such opportunity.

**1979** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 1980 General Service Conference be built around "Participation—the Key to Recovery."

The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 1980 Conference consist of one leader and five speakers—three delegates and two staff members (one G.S.O. and one Grapevine). It was further recommended that the format of the meeting should be reviewed each year by the Conference Agenda Committee.

With regard to the committee's recommendations for presentation/discussion topics (among them: "Working With Others," "The Role of the Alternate at All Levels of Service," "The Cornerstone of Structure—the G.S.R.," "Where There Is Good Service Structure, There Is Growth in A.A. Membership," and "Let's Not Squander Our Inheritance"), the Conference retain the general idea of the topics, but the Conference Agenda Committee make additional suggestions.

At the 1980 General Service Conference, there be three workshops: two structured and one unstructured. It was further recommended that one of the workshops be on the topic "Working With Others."

During the roll call at the 1980 Conference, Conference members should stand when their names are called.

In response to a request from members of one of the workshops, a discussion on "How are expenses for service workers at all levels of service met in your area?" be included on the agenda of the 1980 General Service Conference.

**1980** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 1981 General Service Conference be built around "A.A. Takes Its Inventory—General Service Conference Structure."

The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 1981 Conference consist of five speakers—three delegates and two staff members (one G.S.O. and one G.V.)—and one leader. It was further recommended that the format of the meeting should be reviewed each year by the Conference Agenda Committee.

The following presentation/discussion subjects be considered for the 1981 Conference:

- a. The Spiritual Meaning of Anonymity  
(on opening day if feasible)
- b. Let's Examine Our Committee System
- c. Should Clubs be Entitled to the A.A. Group Discount on Literature?

At next year's Conference, we have two structured workshops, with one workshop topic to be "Let's Examine Our Committee System."

There be a "What's on Your Mind?" session or sharing session scheduled for the full Conference body instead of a third workshop.

**1981** It was recommended that:

Suggestions for a possible theme for the 1982 General Service Conference be built around one of the following:

- a. Equal Voice—Equal Responsibility
- b. Equal Authority—Equal Responsibility



c. The Traditions—The Way to Unity

d. A.A.—Its Structure

The following presentation/discussion subjects be considered for the 1982 Conference:

- a. Equal Authority—Equal Responsibility  
(on the opening morning if feasible)
- b. How We Carry the Message to Alcoholics Coming to Us  
From Outside Agencies

At next year's Conference, we have two structured workshops:

- a. How We Carry the Message to Alcoholics Coming to Us  
From Outside Agencies
- b. Why A.A. Works—The Traditions

The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 1982 Conference consist of five speakers—one trustee, two delegates, and two staff members (one G.S.O. and one G.V.)—and one delegate chairing. It was further recommended that the format of the meeting should be reviewed each year by the Conference Agenda Committee.

**1982** It was recommended that:

The following be considered for the 1983 Conference theme:

- a. Group Responsibilities in Service—Back to Basics
- b. The A.A. Member—Service, Privileges, and Responsibilities
- c. Anonymity—Our Spiritual Foundation

The following presentation/discussion subjects be considered for the 1983 Conference:

- a. How Is the A.A. Member's Voice Heard at the General Service Conference?  
Through an Informed Group Conscience  
Through Correspondence to G.S.O.  
Through District Activity  
Through His/Her Delegate
- b. The Member, the Group, and Their Money  
The Cost of Involvement in Service  
How Are District Activities Funded?  
What Will a Dollar in the Basket Do Today?
- c. Sponsorship  
In Recovery  
In Service

At next year's Conference, the following structured workshops be considered

- a. Communications: Group—G.S.R.-D.C.M.
- b. Informed Group Conscience
- c. Rotation in Service

The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 1983 Conference consist of five speakers—one trustee, two delegates, two staff members (one G.S.O. and one G.V.)—and one delegate chairing. It was further recommended that the format of the meeting be reviewed each year by the Conference Agenda Committee.

**1983** It was recommended that:

The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 1984 Conference consist of five speakers—one trustee, two delegates, two staff members (one G.S.O. and one G.V.)—and one delegate chairing. It was further recommended that the format of the meeting be reviewed each year by the Conference Agenda Committee.

The following be considered for the 1984 Conference theme:

- a. Our Primary Purpose
- b. The Frontier for A.A.'s Future—The Group
- c. Gratitude—The Language of the Heart

The following presentation/discussion topics be considered for the 1984 Conference:

- a. How Does A.A. Respond to a Changing World?  
Are We Listening to the Newcomer?  
Open-Mindedness  
Working With Third Parties
- b. The Informed Group Conscience—My Obligation  
To Understand the Steps  
To Understand the Traditions  
To Understand the Concepts
- c. Sobriety—What Is It?

At next year's Conference, the following structured workshops be considered:

- a. Solutions for Everyday Problems in A.A.
- b. How Does A.A. Respond to a Changing World?

The Conference Agenda Committee secretary outline the procedure for selecting Conference items and send it to the Agenda Committee members with their February letter.

Conference Agenda Committee members wait seven days from the date of the postmark before replying to the Agenda Committee secretary's request for approval of the trustees' Conference Committee recommendations regarding the next year's Conference agenda.

**1984** It was recommended that:

At the dinner of the 1985 General Service Conference, there be a light system on the podium and the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be designated chairperson of the A.A. meeting and that his or her duties be limited to introducing the leader and monitoring the time of the meeting.

In addition to the meeting chairperson, the format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 1985 Conference remain the same as 1984, consisting of a delegate leader to introduce five speakers—one trustee, two delegates, two staff members (one G.S.O. and one G.V.).

The following suggestions be made for a possible theme for the 1985 Conference with grateful recognition that we will celebrate A.A.'s 50th Anniversary in 1985:

- a. Service—The Golden Key
- b. Love and Service
- c. Golden Moments of Reflection

The following presentation/discussion and/or workshop topics be considered for the 1985 Conference:

- a. Will the Hand of A.A. Always Be There?  
The Middle Years of Sobriety—A Dangerous Time  
Are We Diluting Ourselves?  
Communication Within the Fellowship
- b. The Warranties
- c. Beyond the Seventh Tradition—Group Responsibility  
In the Meeting Place  
To the Newcomer
- d. Fifty Years of Caring and Sharing  
In Treatment Centers  
In Correctional Facilities



With Young People  
In the Group

- e. The G.S.R.—The Key Role  
Obtaining the Most Qualified Member  
The Service Sponsor

**1985** It was recommended that:

At the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 36th General Service Conference, there be a light system on the podium; the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be designated chairperson of the A.A. meeting and that his or her duties be limited to introducing the leader and monitoring the time of the meeting.

In addition to the meeting chairperson, the format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 36th General Service Conference remain the same as 1985, consisting of the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee as leader to introduce five speakers—one trustee, two delegates, two staff members (one G.S.O. and one Grapevine).

For a possible theme for the 36th General Service Conference, the following suggestions be made:

- a. Service: Our Legacy of Life
- b. The Third Legacy: Hope for the Future
- c. A.A.'s Future: Our Responsibility

The following presentation/discussion topics for the 1986 Conference be considered:

- a. The Committee System  
Do We Trust It?  
Does It Eliminate Conflict?
- b. Responsibility In Service  
Why Are You a General Service Representative?  
Why Are You a District Committee Member?  
Why Are You an Area Officer?  
Why Are You a Trustee?
- c. Trusted Servants  
Do We Trust Them?  
Ultimate Authority—Are We Listening?  
Are Trusted Servants Informed?  
The Importance of Rotation

The following two workshops be considered for the 36th General Service Conference:

- a. Letting Go of Old Ideas  
Suggesting that the following be specifically addressed in the workshop questions:  
New Ways of Carrying the A.A. Message  
Are We Getting Too Rigid?
- b. A.A.'s Impact On the World  
With emphasis on:  
Are We Being Friendly With Our Friends?  
How A.A. Cooperates

**1986** It was recommended that:

The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner at the 37th General Service Conference consist of the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee as leader to introduce five speakers—one Class B trustee, two delegates, two staff members (one G.S.O. and one G.V.).

There be a light system on the podium; the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be designated chairperson of the A.A. meeting and that his or her duties be limited to introducing the leader and monitoring the time of the meeting.

The microphone be checked before the A.A. meeting and the speakers be advised to speak clearly into the microphone and limit their talks to ten minutes each.

One of the following four suggestions be the theme of the 37th General Service Conference:

- a. Our Primary Purpose—The Second Fifty Years
- b. The Promises: Our Today—Their Tomorrow
- c. The Seventh Tradition—A Turning Point
- d. A.A.—A Spiritualized Society

The presentation/discussion topics for the 1987 Conference be:

- a. Are We Carrying the Message to All?
- b. Area Structure  
General Service Representative  
District Committee Member  
Area Committee  
Delegate
- c. Finance  
Can G.S.O. be Self-supporting Through Group Contributions Only?  
What About the Birthday Plan?  
Could Groups Pledge Contributions?  
Group Support to District, Area and Intergroup
- d. Publishing—Too Much?  
A.A. World Services  
A.A. Grapevine
- e. Maintaining the Basics—A.A.'s Principles  
Our Primary Purpose  
The Twelve Steps  
The Twelve Traditions  
The Twelve Concepts—How Can We Live the Concepts in Service?
- f. Right of Decision  
Two Workshops for the 1987 Conference be:  
Unity—Let's Talk About It  
Living Sober—Growing Together or Growing Apart?

**1987** It was recommended that:

The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner of the 38th General Service Conference consist of the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee as leader to introduce five speakers: One Class B trustee, two delegates, two A.A. members rotating from the following (G.S.O staff, Grapevine staff, Archives or of the corporate boards); and that their talks be limited to ten minutes each.

There be a light system on the podium; the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be designated as chairperson of the A.A. meeting and that his or her duties be limited to introducing the leader and monitoring the time of the A.A. meeting.

"Self-Support" be a presentation/discussion topic for the next five years, in keeping with the spirit of the Seventh Tradition.

The theme of the 38th General Service Conference be "Our Singleness of Purpose—Key to Unity."

A workshop topic be on the theme "Our Singleness of Purpose—Key to Unity." A second workshop be scheduled, if time permits, with the subject to be determined at the trustees' Conference Committee's discretion.

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1988 Conference:

- a. Self-support



- b. Singleness of Purpose—Key to Unity
  - Groups vs Meetings
  - Are We Being Too Friendly with Our Friends?
  - Our Primary Purpose—Is Our Message Clear?
- c. Focus on the Positive
  - Communications—Challenges
  - What Are We Doing Right?
  - Spirit of Rotation

The consideration of inviting intergroups and central offices into the general service structure be referred to the Agenda Committee for the 1988 Conference. (Floor Action)

**1988** It was recommended that:

The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner of the 39th General Service Conference consist of the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee as leader to introduce five speakers: one Class B trustee, two delegates, two A.A. members rotating from the following (G.S.O. staff, Grapevine staff, Archives or of the corporate boards); and that their talks be limited to ten minutes each.

There be a light system on the podium; the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be designated as chairperson of the A.A. meeting and that his or her duties be limited to introducing the leader and monitoring the time of the A.A. meeting.

The theme of the 39th General Service Conference be “Anonymity—Our Past, Present and Future” or “Anonymity—Living Our Traditions.”

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1989 Conference:

- a. Self-support
- b. G.S.O. Finances
- c. Anonymity
  - How it Developed
  - Its Necessity Today
  - Principles Before Personalities
- d. Back to Basics
  - The Group in the Structure
  - Sponsorship in Recovery and Service
  - A.A. Literature—Tool or Mandate

A workshop topic be on the Conference theme and a second workshop on “Love and Service” be scheduled if time permits.

A “What’s on Your Mind?” session continue to be scheduled in the beginning of the week.

We continue the practice of allowing more time for Committee meetings.

**1989** It was recommended that:

The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner of the 40th General Service Conference consist of the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee as leader to introduce five speakers: one Class B trustee, two delegates, two A.A. members, alternating from among the A.A. staff, Grapevine staff, Archives and corporate boards.

There be a light system on the podium; the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be designated as chairperson of the A.A. meeting and that his or her duties be limited to introducing the leader and monitoring the time of the A.A. meeting.

The following themes be considered for the 1990 General Service Conference:

- a. Home Group—Where Love and Service Begin
- b. Home Group—Our Link to the Fellowship
- c. Home Group—Our Responsibility and Link to A.A.’s Future.

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1990 General Service Conference:

- a. The Importance of the Home Group
  - In Recovery
  - For Unity
  - For Service
- b. Sponsorship
  - In Recovery
  - For Unity
  - For Service
- c. Self-support
- d. G.S.O. Finances

One workshop be held at the 1990 General Service Conference and the topic be on the Conference Theme.

**1990** It was recommended that:

The format of the A.A. meeting following the Opening Dinner of the 1991 General Service Conference be as follows: the Chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be chair of the meeting, with his or her duties limited to introducing the meeting leader and monitoring the time allotted by means of a light-timer system; and the Alternate Chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be leader of the meeting, introducing five speakers, one Class B Trustee, two Delegates, and two other A.A. members alternating from among the A.A. staff, Grapevine staff, Archivist, and corporate boards.

In order of preference, the theme for the 1991 General Service Conference be selected from among the following:

- a. Sponsorship: Gratitude in Action
- b. Sponsorship: Our Three Legacies
- c. Sponsorship: The Hand of A.A.

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1991 General Service Conference:

- a. Sponsorship
  - Help and Hope
  - I Am Responsible
  - A Way of Life
- b. Our Collective Humility
  - How We Identify Ourselves
  - Anonymity—Our Spiritual Foundation
  - In All Our Affairs
  - Self-support Project—Five Years Later
  - G.S.O. Finances

One Workshop be held at the 1991 General Service Conference, with the topic to be on the Conference theme.

**1991** It was recommended that:

The format of the A.A. meeting following the Opening Dinner of the 1992 General Service Conference be as follows: the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be chair of the meeting, with his or her duties limited to introducing the meeting leader and monitoring the time allotted by means of a light-timer system; and the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be leader of the meeting, introducing five speakers: one Class B trustee, two delegates, and two other A.A. members alternating from among the A.A. staff, Grapevine staff, archivist, and corporate boards.



The theme for the 1992 General Service Conference be: The A.A. Message in a Changing World.

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1992 General Service Conference:

- a. The A.A. Message in a Changing World  
Our Common Welfare  
Unity: Together We Can  
The Language of the Heart Worldwide
- b. The Joy of Living  
The Newcomer: A.A.'s Future  
Principles Before Personalities  
Humility Through Rotation
- c. Love and Service
- d. G.S.O. Finances

There be one workshop for the 1992 General Service Conference, with the topic to be on the Conference theme.

**1992** It was recommended that:

The format of the A.A. meeting following the Opening Dinner of the 1993 General Service Conference be as follows: the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be chair of the meeting, with his or her duties limited to introducing the meeting leader and monitoring the time allotted by means of a light-timer system; and the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be leader of the meeting, introducing five speakers: one Class B trustee, two delegates, and two other A.A. members alternating from among the A.A. staff, Grapevine staff, archivist, and corporate boards.

The theme for the 1993 General Service Conference be: A.A. Takes Its Inventory—The General Service Conference Structure.

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1993 General Service Conference:

- a. A.A. Takes Its Inventory  
The Purpose of the General Service Conference  
The Conference Relation to A.A.  
The General Service Conference and Its  
General Procedures
- b. A.A. Takes Its Inventory  
Conference Relation to the General Service Board  
and Its Corporate Services  
The General Service Board:  
Composition, Jurisdiction, Responsibilities
- c. The General Warranties of the Conference
- d. A.A. Takes Its Inventory: Finance
- e. A.A. Takes Its Inventory: The Grapevine

There be two workshops for the 1993 General Service Conference: one workshop to be on the Conference theme with the focus to be on the other six articles of the Conference Charter; and another workshop to be titled "A Vision for Us—Where Are We and Where Are We Going?" with questions to be gathered from the Fellowship.

The proposal of the General Service Board to directly manage A.A.W.S./G.S.O. on an experimental basis for nine months not be implemented.

Members of a Conference Committee be informed as soon as practical after it becomes known that an item will be on the agenda of their Conference Committee, rather than waiting until January.

The 1993 Conference Agenda Committee investigate the possibility of forming an ad hoc committee similar in intent to the inventory committee proposed by Area 36 in their April 7, 1992 letter.

**1993** It was recommended that:

The format of the A.A. meeting following the Opening Dinner of the 1994 General Service Conference be as follows: The chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee chair the meeting, with his or her duties limited to introducing the meeting leader and monitoring the time allotted by means of a light-timer system; and the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be leader of the meeting, introducing five speakers: one Class B trustee, two delegates, and two other A.A. members alternating from among the G.S.O. staff, Grapevine staff, archivist, and corporate boards.

The theme for the 1994 General Service Conference be: Spirit of Sacrifice.

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1994 General Service Conference:

- a. Spirit of Sacrifice: Bill's and  
Dr. Bob's Farewell Messages:  
Bill's Message  
Dr. Bob's Message
- b. Spirit of Sacrifice in the Long Form of the Traditions:  
Traditions One, Two and Three  
Traditions Four, Five and Six
- c. Spirit of Sacrifice in the Long Form of the Traditions:  
Traditions Seven, Eight and Nine  
Traditions Ten, Eleven and Twelve

The following be the workshop for the 1994 General Service Conference: The Twelfth Step in Action:

- a. Where have we been?
- b. Where are we now?
- c. Where are we going?

**1994** It was recommended that:

The format of the A.A. meeting following the Opening Dinner of the General Service Conference be as follows: The chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be chair of the meeting, with his or her duties limited to introducing the meeting leader and monitoring the time allotted by means of a light-timer system; and the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be leader of the meeting, introducing five speakers: one Class B trustee, two delegates, and two other A.A. members alternating from among the A.A. staff, Grapevine staff, archivist, and corporate boards.

The theme for the 1995 General Service Conference be: Pass It On—Our Three Legacies.

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1995 General Service Conference:

- a. Pass It On: Recovery—Our First Legacy
- b. Pass It On: Unity—Our Second Legacy
- c. Pass It On: Service—Our Third Legacy

The following be the workshop for the 1995 General Service Conference:

How We Pass It On:

- a. Our Basic Message
- b. Sponsorship in Recovery and Service
- c. Communication—The Language of A.A.



**1995** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 1996 General Service Conference be: Preserving Our Fellowship—Our Challenge.

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1996 General Service Conference:

- a. Preserving Our Fellowship—Let It Begin With Me
- b. Preserving Our Fellowship—Carrying Our Original Message
- c. Preserving Our Fellowship—Unity and Spirituality in All Our Affairs

The following be the Workshop Topic for the 1996 General Service Conference:

Preserving Our Fellowship—Our Challenge:

- a. Through Your Home Group
- b. Through Your District
- c. Through Your Conference Area

**1996** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 1997 General Service Conference be: Spirituality—Our Foundation.

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1997 General Service Conference:

- a. Group Conscience—Seeking Our Ultimate Authority
- b. Carrying A.A.'s Message Around the World
- c. The Hat—Where Money and Spirituality Mix

The following be the workshop topic for the 1997 General Service Conference:

Spirituality—Our Foundation:

- a. Spirit of Rotation
- b. Working with Faith, Serving with Love
- c. Unity—We Are Responsible

**1997** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 1998 General Service Conference be: "Our Twelfth Step Work."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1998 General Service Conference:

- a. Our Twelfth Step Work:
  - 1. Reaching the Newcomer
  - 2. Carrying This Message
  - 3. Back to Basics
- b. Tools for Twelfth Stepping:
  - 1. The A.A. Member
  - 2. Sponsorship
  - 3. Literature
- c. Diversity of Twelfth Step Work:
  - 1. Home Group
  - 2. Service Structure
  - 3. Around the World

The following be the workshop topic for the 1998 General Service Conference:

- a. Our Twelfth Step Work:
  - 1. In the Home Group
  - 2. In the Service Structure
  - 3. Around the World

**1998** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 1999 General Service Conference be: "Moving Forward: Unity Through Humility."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1999 General Service Conference:

- a. Our Responsibility to A.A. Unity:
  - 1. Home Group
  - 2. A.A. Service Structure
  - 3. A.A. Worldwide
- b. Many Faces—One Fellowship:
  - 1. Accepting Our Differences
  - 2. I Am Responsible. . .
  - 3. Principles Before Personalities
- c. Our Future Together:
  - 1. Sponsorship
  - 2. A.A. Literature
  - 3. Tradition Seven

The following be the workshop topic for the 1999 General Service Conference: Moving Forward: Unity Through Humility:

- a. Harmony in the A.A. Community
- b. Principle of Rotation
- c. Spiritual Significance of Anonymity

**1999** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2000 General Service Conference be: "Trusting Our Future to A.A. Principles."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2000 General Service Conference:

- a. Recovery:
  - 1. Trust the God of Your Understanding
  - 2. Clean House
  - 3. Work With Others
- b. Unity:
  - 1. Our Common Welfare
  - 2. The Informed Group Conscience and Substantial Unanimity
  - 3. Practicing Genuine Humility Through Anonymity
- c. Service:
  - 1. I Am Responsible. . .
  - 2. Our Primary Purpose
  - 3. Spirit of Rotation

The following be the workshop topic for the 2000 General Service Conference: Trusting Our Future to A.A. Principles.

- a. Twelve Steps
- b. Twelve Traditions
- c. Twelve Concepts

**2000** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2001 General Service Conference be: "Love and Service."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2001 General Service Conference:

- a. Sponsorship:
  - 1. The Home Group
  - 2. Sponsorship into Service
  - 3. Never Too Late to Get a Sponsor



- b. Language of the Heart:
  - 1. Listening to the Language of the Heart
  - 2. Sharing Experience, Strength and Hope
  - 3. Passing On Our Three Legacies
- c. The G.S.R.'s Role in A.A.:
  - 1. In the Home Group
  - 2. Link to the District, Area and G.S.O.
  - 3. Guardian of the Traditions

The following be the workshop topic for the 2001 General Service Conference: "Love and Service."

- a. Carrying the Message of Service
- b. Living the A.A. Principles in All Our Affairs
- c. Maintaining the Spirit of Anonymity

**2001** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2002 General Service Conference be "Sharing the Steps, Traditions and Concepts."

The following be Presentation/Discussion topics for the 2002 General Service Conference:

- a. Unity:
  - 1. Spirit of Rotation—Letting Go!
  - 2. Does Our Committee System Work?
  - 3. The Internet—A Part of or Apart From?
- b. Inventory:
  - 1. A.A. Literature—Is It Being Utilized or Collecting Dust?
  - 2. Seventh Tradition and Spirituality—Do They Really Mix?
  - 3. The following be the Workshop Topic for the 2002 General Service Conference: "Using the Steps, Traditions and Concepts in Our Daily Lives."

**2002** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2003 General Service Conference be: "Living A.A.'s Principles Through Sponsorship."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2003 General Service Conference:

- a. Sponsorship:
  - 1. Responsibilities of Sponsorship.
  - 2. Is Sponsorship Fading Away?
  - 3. Working with Medical Practitioners, Other Professionals and Friends.
- b. Principles:
  - 1. What are the Principles?
  - 2. Living the Principles, Accepting Our Differences.

The following be the workshop topic for the 2003 General Service Conference: "Sponsorship — Remembering to Practice Our Principles."

**2003** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2004 General Service Conference be: "Our Singleness of Purpose — The Cornerstone of A.A."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2004 General Service Conference:

- a. Our Singleness of Purpose:
  - 1. Our Responsibility to the Newcomer
  - 2. Communicating Our Singleness of Purpose

- b. The Cornerstone of A.A.:
  - 1. Safeguarding Our Unity
  - 2. The Role of the Home Group
  - 3. Traditions Three and Five: Our Members, Our Message

The following be the workshop topic for the 2004 General Service Conference:

"How is Singleness of Purpose Important to the Individual, Group, District, Area, G.S.O. and Grapevine Office?"

**2004** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2005 General Service Conference be: "Basics of Our Home Group — Recovery, Unity and Service."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2005 General Service Conference:

- a. Recovery:
  - 1. "How It Works" in Our Home Group
  - 2. Carrying the Message Through Practicing the Principles in Our Daily Lives
- b. Unity:
  - 1. "Love and Tolerance of Others is Our Code" (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 84)
  - 2. The Basket — Where Money and Spirituality Mix
  - 3. The Spiritual Principle of Our Twelfth Tradition
- c. Service:
  - 1. Concept One — Final Responsibility and Ultimate Authority
  - 2. Concept Five — Minority Opinion — Are We Listening?
  - 3. Leadership — Responsibility for A.A.'s Future — Concept Nine

The following be the workshop topic for the 2005 General Service Conference: "Do I Carry the A.A. Message Or My Own?"

**2005** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2006 General Service Conference be: "Sponsorship, Service and Self-Support in a Changing World."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2006 General Service Conference:

- a. Sponsorship:
  - 1. Presenting A.A. to Newcomers
  - 2. Changes in the Alcoholic Coming to A.A.
  - 3. Sponsorship Into Sobriety, Into Service
- b. Service:
  - 1. Performing Service Without Expectations
  - 2. Leadership — An Ever Vital Need
  - 3. Responsibility With Accountability
- c. Self-Support:
  - 1. An Informed Group Conscience
  - 2. Gratitude Through Self-Sacrifice

The following be the workshop topic for the 2006 General Service Conference: "Passing It On in a Changing World."

**2006** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2007 General Service Conference be: "Our 12th Step Responsibility—Are We Going to Any Length?"



The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2007 General Service Conference:

- a. Inclusiveness in A.A.:
  - 1. Our 3rd Tradition
  - 2. Growth of the Fellowship
  - 3. Reaching Out to All Who Want It
- b. Our Primary Purpose:
  - 1. Attraction Rather Than Promotion
  - 2. Working with Wet Drunks
  - 3. Practicing These Principles in All Our Affairs
- c. Humility and Responsibility:
  - 1. Expressed by Anonymity
  - 2. Are We Resting on Our Laurels?
  - 3. Raising Literature Prices or Footing the Bill?

The following be the workshop topic for the 2007 General Service Conference: "Spiritual Value of Our A.A. Dollars."

**2007** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2008 General Service Conference be: "Communication and Participation—The Key to Unity and Self-Support."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2008 General Service Conference:

- a. Communication and Participation:
  - 1. Sharing the Message of Service
  - 2. Our Key to Keeping A.A. Strong
  - 3. Leadership in A.A.: Building Communication
- b. Unity:
  - 1. Our Common Welfare Should Come First
  - 2. Principles Before Personalities
  - 3. Diversity: Reaching Out to All Alcoholics
- c. Self-Support:
  - 1. Self-Supporting Through Members' Voluntary Contributions Only
  - 2. Contempt Prior to Investigation
  - 3. Responsibility to Communicate and Participate

The following be the workshop topic for the 2008 General Service Conference: "Love and Tolerance, Now More Than Ever."

**2008** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2009 General Service Conference be: "Our Commitment to Carry A.A.'s Message—Enthusiasm and Gratitude in Action."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2009 General Service Conference:

- a. Humility and Sacrifice:
  - 1. Setting an Example
  - 2. Changing Our Perceptions
  - 3. Anonymity—Sacrificing Our Egos
- b. Enthusiasm and Gratitude:
  - 1. Hope and Purpose from Defeat and Despair
  - 2. Happy, Joyous and Free
  - 3. Enthusiasm—A Gift of Inventory
- c. Spiritual Program in Action:
  - 1. Maximum Service—Our Spiritual Benefit
  - 2. Persistence—The Key to Progress
  - 3. Living the Traditions

The following be the workshop topic for the 2009 General Service Conference: "Language of the Heart—Keeping It Simple."

**2009** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2010 General Service Conference be: "Practicing A.A.'s Principles—the Pathway to Unity."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2010 General Service Conference:

- a. Practicing These Principles in All Our "Service" Affairs:
  - 1. What is the Difference Between General Service and Service in General?
  - 2. Love and Tolerance is Our Code.
  - 3. Setting an Example—Attraction to Service.
- b. Unity Through Inventory:
  - 1. Our Common Welfare Should Come First.
  - 2. This We Owe to A.A.'s Future.
  - 3. What Happens After Inventory.
- c. General Service Conference Agenda Selection Process:
  - 1. How it Works.
  - 2. Collective Participation.
  - 3. Communication—The Key to an Informed Decision.

The following be the workshop topic for the 2010 General Service Conference: "Discuss the General Service Conference Agenda Selection Process" and that all background provided to the 2009 Conference Agenda Committee regarding the "General Service Conference Agenda Selection Process," be sent to the members of the 60th General Service Conference in February 2010 as background for the 2010 Conference workshop session along with any additional related background material that may be compiled by the General Service Board, the trustees' Committee on the Conference, the General Service Office or other resources.

**2010** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2011 General Service Conference be: "We are Responsible for A.A.'s Future—Let it Begin With Us."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2011 General Service Conference:

- a. Alcoholics Anonymous in a Digital Age:
  - 1. Practicing Our Traditions in a Digital Age.
  - 2. Carrying A.A.'s Message Online.
  - 3. Grapevine—"A.A.'s Meeting in Print" and More...
- b. An Informed Group Conscience: The Voice of A.A.:
  - 1. Self-Support—Where Do Money and Spirituality Mix?
  - 2. Humility—Accepting the Group Conscience.
  - 3. An Informed Group Conscience—Using the Three Legacies.
- c. Diversity in A.A.:
  - 1. The Language of the Heart is Spoken Here.
  - 2. The Hand of A.A.—Inclusive Never Exclusive.
  - 3. Tradition Five—Our Primary Purpose.
- d. Sponsorship:
  - 1. Importance of a Home Group.
  - 2. Leading by Example—Attraction Not Promotion.
  - 3. Recovery, Unity, Service.

The following be the workshop topic for the 2011 General Service Conference: "How to Increase Participation in A.A.—Striving for Self-Support in All Our Affairs."



**2011** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2012 General Service Conference be: "Anonymity: Our Spiritual Responsibility in the Digital Age."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2012 General Service Conference:

- a. Carrying the A.A. Message:
  1. Still Our Primary Purpose.
  2. Social Web Sites.
  3. Young People in A.A.
  4. Importance of Sponsorship.
- b. Change — Essential to A.A.'s Growth:
  1. Service: Our Third Legacy.
  2. Spirit of Rotation.
  3. Diversity — Let's Keep Our Doors Open for any Who May Suffer from Alcoholism.
  4. Archives — Where the Past Meets the Present.

The following be the workshop topic for the 2012 General Service Conference: "Safety in A.A.: Our Common Welfare."

**2012** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2013 General Service Conference be: "The General Service Conference Takes Its Inventory — Our Solution in Action."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2013 General Service Conference:

Spiritual Principles for World Service:

- a. The Triangle — More Than a Shape
- b. The General Service Conference Inventory — Why is it Necessary?
- c. Self-Support — What Does it Mean to the Fellowship?
- d. Primary Purpose — Carrying the A.A. Message

The following inventory questions listed in the "INVENTORY PLAN," which were approved by the 2011 G.S.C., be discussed each year for the 2013, 2014 and 2015 General Service Conferences:

### Inventory Plan

#### **2013** Inventory Questions

- A. Effectiveness of the Conference/Conference Process Overall
  1. Reflecting on Concept One, how does the Conference ensure that it is the conscience of A.A. as a whole?
  2. How well is the use of floor actions serving us?
  3. Reflecting on Concept Ten, how well is the authority of the Conference defined?
  4. How well does the Conference fulfill the General Warranties of Concept Twelve?
- B. Composition of Conference
  1. Should delegate areas be more consistently based on actual membership numbers?
- C. Committee System
  1. Could the committee process be improved to more effectively introduce change in the Fellowship, and if so, how?
- D. Yearlong Process Effectiveness
  1. What improvements could be considered to make sure the agenda selection process is more effective?

2. How well do all Conference members communicate to the Fellowship about why we have a Conference and how the committee system works? How could we improve in this communication?

#### E. Conference Preparation

(background, content, delivery, etc.)

1. How well do the delegates balance their preparation for the Conference, especially in keeping with Concept Three and Article Three of the Conference Charter? How could we improve in the practice of our rights and responsibilities under Concept Three and Article Three of the Conference Charter?

#### F. Conference Week Schedule

1. How can we improve the way time is allotted during the Conference for reports, presentation/discussion/workshop topics, and thorough discussion of agenda items?
2. How are leadership and participation affected by late night work sessions?

#### G. General Service Board/Corporate Boards

(A.A.W.S. & A.A. Grapevine)

1. Is the current makeup of the board (numbers and proportions) still the most effective? If not, what changes should we consider?
2. How could we improve the methods used to solicit trustees and directors to get the most appropriate people interested in the positions?
3. What more could be done to insure the General Service Board remains transparent and thorough in their reporting to the Fellowship?

#### H. Leadership

1. Reflecting on Concept Nine, are the qualities of leadership, as identified in the leadership essay in the *Service Manual*, still the qualities that we should try to encourage in Conference members? If so, how successful are we in encouraging those qualities? If not, what changes should we consider?

#### **2014** Inventory Questions

##### A. Effectiveness of the Conference/Conference Process Overall

1. Reflecting on Concept Four, how effective are we in treating all Conference members as equals (no one regarded as second class)?
2. Reflecting on Concept Five, how well does the Conference facilitate the hearing and resolution of minority appeals/report? How could it be improved?
3. Does the structure encourage each individual in the Fellowship to feel and act as a member of a "society of alcoholics in action?" If not, how could we improve?
4. Does the yearlong Conference process effectively encourage all Conference members to lead (or serve) in the spirit of our upside-down service structure? If not, how can we encourage all Conference members to do so?

##### B. Composition of Conference

1. Should regional divisions be based on membership numbers, the number of areas contained in each region or some other criteria? Please explain.



#### C. Committee System

1. What is the right balance of participation among committee members (delegates, staff) and how can we best achieve that balance?

#### D. Yearlong Process Effectiveness

1. How well is the message of the Conference theme being carried out throughout the year?
2. What other suggestions do we have for how to improve the effectiveness of the yearlong process?

#### E. Conference Preparation

(background, content, delivery, etc.)

1. How can we improve the manner in which Conference background material is developed and distributed?

#### F. Conference Week Schedule

1. At the Conference, what is the difference between being a leader or being a reporter? Can a person be both at the same time?

#### G. General Service Board/Corporate Boards (A.A.W.S. & A.A. Grapevine)

1. Reflecting on Concept Eleven, does the General Service Board exercise serious care in having the best possible assistance in carrying out their duties? How can this process be improved?
2. Does the current role of the board most effectively address the needs of the Fellowship? If not, how should their role be changed?
3. Is the selection/election process for trustees and directors effective and impartial/fair? How would you change it?

#### H. Leadership

1. How can we improve the methods of selecting effective leaders and nurturing leadership qualities in our trusted servants?
2. What more could be done to ensure broad diversity of representation in our A.A. leaders?

### 2015 Inventory Questions

#### A. Effectiveness of the Conference/Conference Process Overall

1. Reflecting on Concept Two, how can we better serve as the actual voice and be an effective conscience for our whole society?
2. Reflecting on Concept Three, how can we effectively balance the freedoms and responsibilities that come with the right of decision?
3. How might any one of the Concepts be revised in essence or wording to more effectively and relevantly guide our leaders?

#### B. Composition of Conference

1. Is the size and structure (proportions of delegate/trustee/staff) of the Conference the most effective for conducting the work of the Fellowship? If not, how could it be made more effective?

#### C. Committee System

1. Committee system (Structure, Composition, Effectiveness, etc.): Does the Conference committee system function in accordance with our principles? If not, what changes should we consider regarding: a) structure b) composition c) effectiveness?

#### D. Yearlong Process Effectiveness

1. How can we better communicate that the Conference process is more than one spring week in New York?
2. How do the delegates and regional trustees support the yearlong process effectiveness?

#### E. Conference Preparation

(background, content, delivery, etc.)

1. What more could be done to prepare delegates for the Conference?

#### F. Conference Week Schedule

1. What Conference activities give participants the most opportunities to be leaders?
2. Does the time allotted and the manner in which information is communicated from the trustees and board members allow delegates to adequately understand and/ or question their reports? How could this be improved?

#### G. General Service Board/Corporate Boards (A.A.W.S. & A.A. Grapevine)

1. Reflecting on Concept Six, how can the Conference ensure that the authority we delegate to the General Service Board is commensurate with the responsibility we have entrusted to them?
2. Reflecting on Concept Eight: (a) How well is the General Service Board exercising custodial oversight and how effectively are they serving as the principle planners and administrators of policy and finance? (b) What are the boundaries between oversight vs. delegation? When is each practiced?
3. Should the Fellowship have more direct influence in the selection of Class A trustees, corporate directors, and general service trustees? If yes, how might that be accomplished?

#### H. Leadership

1. How well is the Third Legacy Procedure serving us? How could it be improved?

### 2013 It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2014 General Service Conference be: "Communicating Our Legacies — Vital in a Changing World."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2014 General Service Conference:

Living in the Heart of A.A.

- a. Recovery, Unity and Service — Our Responsibility
- b. Passing It on Through Sponsorship
- c. Participating in Our Common Welfare through Contributions
- d. Inventory — A Guiding Tool to Our Future

### 2014 It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2015 General Service Conference be: "Celebrating 80 Years of Recovery, Unity and Service — The Foundation for Our Future."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2015 General Service Conference:

"Our Common Welfare Through Gratitude in Action"

- a. Diversity in A.A. — Our Heritage of Inclusion
- b. Safety and Respect — Practicing the Principles Begins in our Home Group



- c. Safeguarding our Traditions through the Evolution of Technology

- d. Inventory — Looking Back to Move Ahead

The Conference Evaluation Form be available in English, French and Spanish beginning in 2015.

The description of the Conference Agenda Committee in Chapter 8, “Conference Committees,” in the 2013-2014 Edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*, which currently reads:

AGENDA (*trustees’ committee: General Service Conference*): Reviews and approves the overall format and content of the agenda for the annual Conference meeting; Considers proposed Conference themes and presentation/discussion topics.

Be revised to read:

AGENDA (*trustees’ committee: General Service Conference*): Reviews and approves the overall format and content of the agenda for the annual Conference meeting; Considers proposed Conference themes, presentation/discussion topics and Conference Evaluation Questionnaire.

**2015** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2016 General Service Conference be: “Our Spiritual Way of Life: Steps, Traditions and Concepts.”

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2016 General Service Conference:

- a. Connecting With the Newcomer:
  - 1. All Inclusive — Never Exclusive
  - 2. Are We Doing Enough to Help the Newcomer — Are We Going to Any Length?
  - 3. Home Group — Where It Begins
- b. Connecting With Each Other:
  - 1. Singleness of Purpose — Staying Pertinent in a Changing World
  - 2. Informed Group Conscience — The Key to Unity
  - 3. Be Involved, Be Inspired, Be of Service
- c. Connecting With A.A. as a Whole:
  - 1. Participating in All of A.A.
  - 2. Understanding Self-Support
  - 3. Reaching Out to the Next Generation of A.A.s

The following be the workshop topic for the 2016 General Service Conference: “Anonymity — The Spiritual Foundation.”

**2016** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2017 General Service Conference be: “Supporting Our Future.”

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2017 General Service Conference:

- a. Growth:
  - 1. Diversity — Outreach and Attraction
  - 2. Safety — An Important Consideration
  - 3. Communication — Today and Tomorrow
- b. Participation:
  - 1. Fellowship vs. Membership
  - 2. Leadership: “I am Responsible...”
  - 3. Is Your Voice Heard?
- c. Contributions:
  - 1. Spirituality and Money

- 2. Fully Self-Supporting Our Obligations

- 3. Apathy and Power of the Purse

The Conference Agenda Committee review the summary of the previous year’s Conference evaluations and, where appropriate, make suggestions for improvement to the trustees’ Committee on the General Service Conference.

The General Service Office post to the Conference dashboard, and regularly update information concerning the status of the proposed Conference agenda items.

The General Service Board develop a new policy and a plan that enhances the General Service Conference Agenda Review and Selection Process, providing the area delegate members of the Conference a role in the vetting and selection of proposed agenda items through the Conference process to be brought to the 2017 General Service Conference. (Floor Action)

**2017** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2018 General Service Conference be: “A.A. — A Solution for All Generations.”

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2018 General Service Conference:

- a. Today’s Alcoholic: Inclusion, Not Exclusion
- b. Participation in All of A.A. — Is My Triangle Balanced?
- c. A.A. Technology: Where Innovation Meets the Traditions
- d. Attraction Not Promotion: A.A.’s Relation to the World
- e. Group Conscience: The Guiding Force

The following be the workshop topic for the 2018 General Service Conference: “Getting the A.A. Message Out...”

In the spirit of unity and inclusiveness, the General Service Office strive to provide Conference background materials in English by February 15 and Spanish and French by the first week in March, beginning with the 68th General Service Conference. (Floor Action)

**2018** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2019 General Service Conference be: “Our Big Book — 80 Years, 71 Languages.”

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2019 General Service Conference:

- a. Yesterday’s World — Our Legacies Begin
- b. Today’s World — Demonstrating Integrity, Anonymity and Service
- c. Tomorrow’s World — Courage to be Vigilant

The following be the workshop topic for the 2019 General Service Conference: “Clarity of Purpose — Addressing the Needs of Our Meetings.”

**2019** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2020 General Service Conference be: “2020: A Clear Vision for You.”

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2020 General Service Conference:

- Recovery — Who Is Missing in Our Rooms?
- Unity — Practicing Our Principles
- Service — Keeping A.A. Relevant

The workshop topic for the 2020 General Service Conference be: Attraction Through Action



**2020** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2021 General Service Conference be: "A.A. in a Time of Change."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2021 General Service Conference:

Practicing A.A.'s Spiritual Principles in a Changing World:

Recovery in a Changing World

Unity in a Changing World

Service in a Changing World

The workshop topic for the 2021 General Service Conference be:

Inform — Communicate

Involve — Act

Inspire — Attract

**2021** It was recommended that:

The following be the theme for the 2022 General Service Conference: "A.A. Comes of Age 2.0: Unified in Love and Service."

The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2022 General Service Conference:

1. How do A.A.s go to any lengths to Recover, Unify, and Serve?

2. Going Beyond Fear

3. How to Reach Anyone, Anywhere

The workshop topic for the 2022 General Service Conference be:

The Warranties — Our Promise to the Fellowship and the World.

**2022** It was recommended that:

The theme for the 2023 General Service Conference be: "A.A.'s Three Legacies — Our Common Solution."

The presentation theme and topics for the 2023 General Service Conference be:

Presentation Theme:

General Service — Our Mighty Purpose and Rhythm

Presentation Topics:

1. Our Common Perils and Common Solution

2. Using A.A.'s Literature in Carrying the Message

3. Fostering a Thriving Three Legacy Culture

The workshop topic for the 2023 General Service Conference be:

Practicing Our Twelve Traditions Across All Group Settings.

The General Service Board develop a status report on the progress and outcomes from the 2013-2015 Conference inventory and include a draft plan for another Conference inventory with considerations of its value, timeline and approach to be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Agenda.

**2023** It was recommended that:

- The following theme for the 2024 General Service Conference be: "Connecting with Love, Unity and Service."
- The committee recommended the following presentation theme and topics for the 2024 General Service Conference:

Presentation Theme:

"Responsibility in Service: When and How to Give"

Presentation Topics:

1. "Safety Throughout the Structure in our Fellowship"

2. "1728 Sponsorship"

3. "Overcoming the Barriers to Participation"

- The workshop topic for the 2024 General Service Conference be: "Connecting Home Groups to the Conference Throughout the Year, to Better Inform the Group's Conscience."
- The General Service Conference conduct a thorough inventory of itself during the 2025 General Service Conference and that a Conference Inventory Planning Committee be established by the General Service Board to develop a comprehensive inventory plan, timeline and cost estimate, to bring forward to the 2024 Conference Committee on Agenda for consideration.

**2024** It was recommended that:

- The following be the theme for the 2025 General Service Conference: "Working Together, Increasing Trust."
- The following be presentation theme and topics for the 2025 General Service Conference:
  1. "Delegating: It is okay to ask for help."
  2. "Closing the Gap: How do we make the voice of every Group count?"
  3. "Our Financial Responsibility in carrying the message."
- The following be the workshop topic for the 2025 General Service Conference: "How do we address the new financial reality facing our spiritual movement?"
- The General Service Conference Inventory Plan be approved and that an inventory summary (not to exceed eight pages), be included in the 2025 Final Conference Report.
- A comprehensive summary of the 2025 General Service Conference Inventory be developed and distributed as an electronic version only.

**2025** It was recommended that:

- The following theme for the 2026 General Service Conference be: "Humility in Action."
- The following presentation theme and topics for the 2026 General Service Conference be:
  1. "Restoration and Discovering Grace, Unity and Fellowship"
  2. "Gossip vs Facts: Examining the Health of Our Own Communications"
  3. "Finding Common Ground"
- The following workshop topic for the 2026 General Service Conference be: "Keeping Our Own House in Order."
- A Conference Inventory Implementation Committee with a composition similar to the makeup of the General Service Conference (delegates, trustees, nontrustee directors, and staff members from the General Service Office and AA Grapevine) be established by the General Service Board to identify and implement actionable items, based on the inventory report-back sessions held at the 2025 General Service Conference. The committee requested that an implementation committee report be brought back to the 2026 General Service Conference.
- On a quarterly basis, the General Service Office provide a grid of proposed agenda items and their disposition status to reaffirm the 2016 Advisory Action, "The General Service Office post to the Conference dashboard, and regularly update information concerning the status of the proposed Conference agenda items."



## Advisory Actions relevant to the Conference Archives Committee<sup>1</sup>

The Conference Archives Committee first met at the 1999 General Service Conference. It is a secondary committee assignment and the committee meets jointly with the trustees' Archives Committee.

**1952** It was recommended that:

Facsimile reproductions of the Lasker Award be made available to all A.A. Groups in suitable form for framing where desired. (Literature)

**1980** It was recommended that:

The archives filmstrip "Markings on the Journey" be Conference-approved. (Floor Action)

**1981** It was recommended that:

The filmstrip "Markings on the Journey" be shown within the Fellowship only. (Floor Action)

**1986** It was recommended that:

The 1987 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee consider the formation of a Conference Archives Committee. (Floor Action)

**1987** It was recommended that:

While the committee recognizes the need for and encourages the development of area Archives and Archives committees, with the resulting benefit to General Service and the Fellowship as a whole, a Conference Archives Committee should not be formed at this time because the needs of local Archives committees are being well served by the trustees' Archives Committee and the General Service Office Archivist. (Policy/Admissions)

**1988** It was recommended that:

The A.A. Archives continue to protect the anonymity of deceased A.A. members as well as other members. (Public Information)

**1989** It was recommended that:

The description "What Is an A.A. Group" contained in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be added to the *The A.A. Service Manual*, and that, when adding the material, the circular structure chart of the group be amended to include "Archives Representative." (Report and Charter)

**1993** It was recommended that:

In response to the proposal to create a Conference Committee on Archives, the 1987 General Service Conference Action #45 be reaffirmed as follows: (Policy/Admissions)

"While the committee recognizes the need for and encourages the development of area Archives and Archives committees, with the resulting benefit to General Service and the Fellowship as a whole, a Conference Archives Committee should not be formed at this time because the

needs of local Archives committees are being well served by the trustees' Archives Committee and the General Service Office Archivist."

**1998** It was recommended that:

A Conference Archives Committee, composed of nine delegates (five from Panel 48 and four from Panel 49), meet at the 49th General Service Conference as a secondary committee assignment and that the committee meet jointly with the trustees' Archives Committee. (Policy/Admissions)

**1999** It was recommended that:

The trustees' Archives Committee review the Archives Handbook and consider the need for any changes and/or an Archives Kit.

**2002** It was recommended that:

The video "Markings on the Journey" be approved by the General Service Conference.

**2007** It was recommended that:

Any future proposed project involving widespread distribution of archival recordings be submitted to the Conference Archives Committee so that the Conference might provide guidance prior to production.

**2012** It was recommended that:

The Conference Committee on Archives meet separately at the General Service Conference following a joint meeting with the trustees' Committee on Archives.

**2013** It was recommended that:

The Archives video *Markings on the Journey* be revised and updated with the proposed changes (estimated cost \$5,000) and brought back to the 2014 Conference Archives Committee.

A commemorative 75th Anniversary Edition of the first edition, first printing of *Alcoholics Anonymous* be published in April 2014.

The posting of freely accessible, anonymity-protected archival audio clips on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site be done at the discretion of the trustees' Committee on Archives and G.S.O.'s Archivist.

**2014** It was recommended that:

The video *Markings on the Journey* be approved.

**2017** It was recommended that:

A draft or a progress report of *Unity in Action: Bill W.'s General Service Conference Talks, 1951 – 1970* (working title) be brought back to the 2018 Conference Committee on Archives for review.

**2018** It was recommended that:

The proposed new publication, *Our Great Responsibility: A Selection of Bill W.'s General Service Conference Talks, 1951 – 1970* be approved with minor editorial changes.

<sup>1</sup> Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.



**2019** It was recommended that:

The 1940s home movie of the co-founders and their wives be added to the Archives video "Markings on the Journey" at an estimated cost of \$5,000.



## Advisory Actions Relevant to the Conference Committee On Cooperation with the Professional Community (C.P.C.)

**1959** The Study Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies recognized the need for clarifying the relationship of the A.A. movement with outside alcoholic agencies and for providing material which will assist Delegates in the solution of problems which may arise in such relationships.

The committee recommended that the Conference take the following actions:

Provide a Conference resolution reaffirming the principles involved in such relationships.

Approve the preparation of an Information File on the subject which will be made available to Delegates and others interested.

Approve the preparation of a pamphlet or reprint to be offered to the membership through the publishing company.

The committee suggested that the resolution be worded as follows:

A Resolution of the 1959 General Service Conference

Be it hereby resolved that: It is the sense of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous that its membership is deeply appreciative of the spirit and assistance manifested by various agencies in dealing with the problem of alcoholism, and it is further the sense of this Conference that its membership is willing and anxious to cooperate in all efforts to assist the suffering alcoholic short of affiliation with outside agencies in any way, and it is further the sense of this Conference that although our Fellowship does not operate or finance facilities of the nature provided by national, state and local agencies and committees, it is deemed entirely proper that some of its members, acting solely as citizens, may take position with these agencies or commissions, but in no way acting or speaking as representatives of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The committee suggested that the Information File contain:

1. A statement of the A.A. principles involved and a review of the critical areas which A.A. individuals and groups should recognize in their relationships with outside agencies.
2. Press releases and radio and TV scripts clarifying A.A.'s proper relationship.

It was recommended that:

A pamphlet to inform clergymen of A.A.'s sole purpose and how they can help the alcoholic find sobriety in A.A. be prepared. (Literature Committee)

The Delegates to the 1960 Conference be surveyed for information about industrial and business programs in their areas, and suggested that information be obtained from outside sources as well, so that G.S.O. material can be brought up-to-date and the pamphlet "The Alcoholic Employee" can be revised. (Literature Committee)

The recommendation of the Study Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies for a brief folder on *cooperation but not affiliation* with outside agencies be handled as a *Grapevine* article and reprinted and made available to A.A. members and outside agencies by G.S.O. (Literature Committee)

**1960** The Special Study Committee on Relation with Outside Agencies took the following actions:

Approved the questions and answers as revised on April 22, 1960 and recommended that this Fact File be made available to groups in loose-leaf form.

Referred the final draft of the Fact File to the Literature Committee for such action as it may wish to take in the publication of a pamphlet.

Recommended to the Conference that it authorize another Study Committee which will report to the 1961 Conference any essential revisions or additions to the currently approved Fact File.

The Conference approved unanimously a report of the Study Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies which reaffirms and documents the traditional A.A. policy of cooperation, but non-affiliation, with A.A.'s many friends in outside agencies. (Floor Action)

The Conference recommended that the Study Committee's "Fact File" be made available to the Areas as soon as possible and that the Committee be continued on an interim basis so that necessary changes or revisions may be adopted to make the "Fact File" increasingly useful to the Areas. (Floor Action)

Recognizing that the material compiled by the *Study Committee on Outside Agencies* will be distributed in mimeographed form shortly after the Conference, the Literature Committee recommended that the material be considered as incomplete, so that additional supplements may be added as the need for them is manifested. (Literature Committee)

The Literature Committee reaffirmed the need for the pamphlets approved by the 1959 Conference, namely: for the Clergy, the Inmate, a revision of "Young People and A.A." and "The Alcoholic Employee." (Literature Committee)

**1961** The Special Study Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies recommended that:

Questions and Answers Number 19, 20, and 21 submitted to the 1961 Conference be added to the report, "A.A.'s Relations with Outside Agencies" approved by the 1960 Conference.

Ever mindful of A.A.'s traditional policy of "Cooperation: Yes—Affiliation: No," the Public Information Committee, when requested to do so, continue to meet with organizations outside A.A. concerned with the problem of alcoholism, for the purpose of improving communications and understanding and discussing mutual problems.



The Delegates be encouraged to establish and maintain communications with the Directors of state-supported alcoholism agencies within their respective Areas.

The Study Committee be made a permanent Conference Committee. **Note:** The Committee was called the Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies.

**1962** It was recommended that:

The new policy recommended by the G.S.B. Public Information Committee that the A.A. exhibits be available for display at meetings of appropriate national professional groups without restriction as to the geographic areas they represent be approved.

The following 1961 Conference Advisory Action be reaffirmed:

- a. That, ever mindful of A.A.'s traditional policy of "Cooperation, YES—Affiliation, NO" the Public Information Committee, when requested to do so, continue to meet with organizations outside of A.A. concerned with the problem of alcoholism for the purpose of improving communications and understanding and discussing mutual problems.
- b. The delegates be encouraged to establish and maintain communications with the directors of state-supported alcoholism agencies within their respective areas.

**1963** It was recommended that:

The following questions and answers on Retreats be approved for addition to "Cooperation But Not Affiliation."

- Q. What is the relationship of A.A. to retreats or other meetings for alcoholics held under the auspices, or in connection with the activities, of religious denominations?
- A. There is no formal relationship. Movement-wide experience might be summarized as follows:
  1. Traditionally, A.A. does not sponsor such gatherings. There is no such thing as an "A.A. retreat" any more than there is an "A.A. hospital" or an "A.A. clinic." Members participate in such activities as individuals.
  2. Since the Fellowship does not affiliate with other organizations, the A.A. name cannot properly be used to identify or publicize retreats or activities sponsored by others. This applies even when most of the participants (perhaps all of them) consider themselves members of A.A. The objective is to minimize public misunderstanding of A.A.'s purpose and functions.
  3. If reference to the participation of A.A. members seems unavoidable in advance notices or in reports, such reference should also emphasize that A.A., as a movement, does not sponsor retreats or religious activities and members attend as *individuals*.

The following actions be reaffirmed:

- a. That a member of P.I.C. represent the Board of Trustees at the annual meeting of the North American Association of Alcoholism Programs.
- b. That ever mindful of A.A.'s traditional policy of "Cooperation But Not Affiliation" the Public Information Committee, when requested to do so, continue to meet with organizations outside of A.A. concerned with the problem of alcoholism for the purpose of improving communications and understanding and discussing mutual problems.

- c. That the Delegates be encouraged to establish and maintain communications with Directors of state-supported alcoholism agencies in their respective Areas. Addresses are available from G.S.O.

**1964** It was recommended that:

The statement prepared by the Public Information Committee defining A.A.'s position in the field of alcoholism be accepted by the Conference.

G.S.O. put into effect, in cases involving possible misunderstanding of A.A.'s relationship to retreats, a procedure similar to that followed in cases of anonymity breaks.

(Persons believed to be responsible for creating an erroneous impression that A.A. as a Society sponsors retreats should be advised that this is not the case and their attention should be directed to the section, "Questions and Answers on Retreats" in the brochure entitled "Cooperation but not Affiliation."

Copies of such communications should be sent to the area delegates involved.

G.S.O. correspondence concerning outside organizations and Traditions be shared with the area delegate.

Delegates be encouraged to establish and maintain communications with directors of state-supported alcoholism agencies in their Areas.

**1965** It was recommended that:

Delegates establish lines of communication with directors of tax-supported and voluntary alcoholism programs in their areas.

The Conference reaffirm the comment on question 16 in the pamphlet "Cooperation But Not Affiliation" and request publication of the following in the A.A. Grapevine:

Experience shows that A.A. groups and intergroups or central committees should not operate or manage these ventures. Individual A.A.s frequently set up such related facilities, being careful not to use the A.A. name on solicitation, advertising and publicity. These ventures are usually set up on a nonprofit basis, incorporated under the charitable and educational laws of the state and excluding "Alcoholics Anonymous" from their names.

Hospitals and rest homes and other community rehabilitation aids bear the same relationship to A.A. groups, intergroups or central committees as do any other outside agencies. With full cooperation of the groups in the community they are used for referral, provided A.A.'s tradition of nonendorsement and nonaffiliation is made clear.

Since these ventures are separate from the Fellowship, it is advisable that they operate under names which do not link them to A.A.—under names other than "Twelve Step House," "Alanon House," etc.

In accordance with past procedure, the "World Directory" should not be made available to other organizations because of its confidential nature.

The title of the Conference "Committee on Relations with Outside Organizations" be changed to the Conference "Committee on Relations with Other Agencies."

**1966** It was recommended that:

The "Committee on Relations with Other Agencies" change its name to the "Conference Committee on Public Information."



The new pamphlet "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community" produced to replace "Helpful Ally" be approved.

All Delegates be urged to establish good lines of communication with tax-supported and voluntary alcoholism programs in their areas.

Delegates screen requests for the *World Directory* from outside A.A.

Reaffirmation that the color-sound film, "Bill's Own Story," is for use by A.A. Groups only, not for outside agencies.

When problems of A.A. relationships with other agencies arise in one area, all members of the new Conference P.I. Committee be informed.

**1967** It was recommended that:

Delegates continue to establish lines of communication with tax-supported and voluntary alcoholism programs in their areas.

G.S.O. refer requests for the *World Directory* from other agencies to the area delegate for follow-up.

Ways were discussed regarding how A.A.s can best participate in the Annual Alcoholism Information Week, such as holding public meetings and appearing on programs when invited, provided anonymity is preserved; and it was suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee provide information concerning A.A. policy on this matter one month in advance of the event.

Trustees' P.I.C. seek opinion of International Doctors Group in A.A. on how groups can improve relations with doctors in their communities.

A position paper on rehabilitation centers to the effect that such rehabs, rest homes and hospitals are *not* part of A.A., and therefore are not responsible for adhering to the Traditions of A.A. be approved. The position paper also suggested that the name of such an institution in no way involve A.A. or any terms identified with A.A. (Floor Action)

**1968** It was recommended that:

The pamphlet "The Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous" be approved with minor changes and carry the seal.

"Suggestions for Improving A.A.'s Relations with the Medical Profession in the Community," be approved and recommended that it be made available to all A.A. groups.

Confirmed Tradition of self-support by agreeing that Telephone Meetings in which the Telephone Company makes its facilities available without charge are not within this Tradition.

**1969** It was recommended that:

No special material for judges, law enforcement people, or teachers be considered at the present time.

G.S.O. consider sending a questionnaire to delegates and public information committees on the subject of cooperation between A.A. members and affiliates of the North American Association of Alcoholism Programs.

**1970** It was recommended that:

The Fellowship go on record as opposing the use of the title, "A.A. Counselor." (Floor Action)

**1971** It was recommended that:

We accept the recommendation from the Conference Committee on Public Information for the formation of a Conference

Committee on Professional Relations to correspond with the Trustees' Committee on Professional Relations; that five delegates from Panel 22 be drawn by lot for the Conference Committee on Professional Relations, that four members from Panel 23 will be added to the committee to bring it up to its full complement of nine. The Conference will then have ten Conference Committees comprised of nine members each at the present Conference size. (Policy)

**1972** It was recommended that:

A.A. members approach the professional community without anxiety or fear, but with confidence that we have something to offer the alcoholic through the professional.

A.A. members approach the professional with the point of view that we have a mutual interest in helping the alcoholic, and with the idea of sharing our 37 years of experience as a resource for alcoholics.

The pamphlet "If You Are a Professional. . ." be approved with minor editorial changes.

The secretary send each member of the committee a copy of the monthly report of Professional Relations activity.

**1973** It was recommended that:

The question of attempting to carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous to the U.S.S.R. should be referred to the Third A.A. World Service Meeting.

In view of the impact of strong agencies and facilities on our Fellowship, as evidenced by increased membership, increased need for Twelfth Step workers, and forecast of continuing increase, we should be mindful at every level of the increasing importance of the understanding and applications of our Twelve Traditions.

The General Service Office of Alcoholics Anonymous, as well as the members of the Fellowship cooperate with agencies dealing with alcoholism—welcoming referrals, being guided by applicable Traditions, and keeping in mind as our primary purpose the welfare of the alcoholic and his recovery.

The Conference reaffirm that the furnishing of information about, and explanation of, Alcoholics Anonymous to professional societies is not in violation of the Traditions.

We encourage the use of all present means of communication (Grapevine, Box 4-5-9, and appropriate literature) to communicate to A.A. members an understanding of professional relations with emphasis on availability and value of the Guidelines.

Consideration be given to the compilation of Guidelines for Professional Relations Committees.

Consideration be given to a presentation to the 24th General Service Conference, "How One Area Developed an Effective Professional Relations Program."

The Conference reaffirm the need at all levels to recognize interested A.A. members and develop an understanding of professional relations within the framework of our Traditions, keeping in mind our primary purpose.

No special literature addressed to law-enforcement officials is needed at this time, because current A.A. material is suitable for this purpose.

**1974** It was recommended that:

Information to A.A.s about what is being done in the field of alcoholism is adequately covered in the gray pages of the



Grapevine and no additional publication is needed. Some members felt that a well-informed A.A. member is a better servant.

Understanding of the role of the A.A. member who wears “two hats” would be advanced by discussion at assembly or committee meetings. It was also suggested that a workshop on “Live and Let Live” could be helpful in understanding this subject.

The action of previous Conferences be reaffirmed, namely, that A.A.s employed in the alcoholism field be eligible for election as trusted servants at all levels of service. It is up to the individual to assess his or her availability for the time and effort required. The criteria for choosing a trusted servant should be based on A.A. activities rather than on personal employment.

Where possible, A.A. members of an area cooperate with alcoholism counselors in starting A.A. meetings in treatment centers, rather than leaving this responsibility to the counselors

On the question of professionals’ making A.A. contact, in some areas it is common knowledge how to reach A.A. In others, A.A. contacts are provided to professionals through intergroup offices, answering services, personal contact, etc.

Area committees on cooperation with the professional community would improve understanding and cooperation in the area.

The name of the Conference Committee on Professional Relations be changed to Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, and that the full title be used instead of the initials.

**1975** It was recommended that:

The film “Bill’s Own Story” may be shown at A.A. orientation sessions in rehabilitation facilities provided it is under the control of an A.A. member.

Although most A.A.s understand the difference between Twelfth Step work, sponsorship, and referral to A.A., there is still a big need for sponsorship in some areas.

Attitudes and not titles are the problem with the “two-hatter.” If changing the title could change attitudes, a change could be considered.

We continue to cooperate with the professionals, because doing so helps us to fulfill our primary purpose of carrying the message of A.A. to the alcoholic. As Bill suggested, “Let’s be friendly with our friends.”

More sharing of the results of cooperation between professionals and A.A.s might improve understanding of professional efforts in the field of alcoholism.

More time be spent on the study of the Traditions by all A.A. members, including those working as professionals in the field. The Traditions enable us to better our relations with the professional community and with each other.

We drop the term “two hatter” in our official literature and use instead “A.A. member employed in the field of alcoholism” or the equivalent. (Floor Action)

No further discussion of John O’s letter concerning St. Luke’s Hospital in Phoenix is necessary, and a vote of confidence was unanimously given to Milton Maxwell, Class A. trustee. (Floor Action)

**1976** It was recommended that:

More effort be directed toward utilizing the service structure we have available to implement our recommendations.

We, as A.A. members, give to A.A. members interested in working or volunteering in the alcoholism field the following suggestions:

- a. Take advantage of the literature already in existence.
- b. Get adequate training.
- c. Have three to five years of good, stable sobriety.
- d. Get and keep a sponsor who does *not* work in the alcoholism field.
- e. Be thoroughly familiar with *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*. Carefully consider whether or not you are suited to work in the field of alcoholism.

To alleviate some of the problems involved in sponsoring people coming to A.A. from treatment centers, court/A.S.A.P. programs, etc., we should:

- a. Establish greater communication between the referral sources and local A.A. groups.
- b. Recognize the necessity of meeting the new member where he presently is, listen to him, try to determine what he really knows about the A.A. program.
- c. See that specific programs are set up for sponsoring people from treatment centers into local A.A. groups.

G.S.O. prepare a paper, consolidating existing information, for prospective members sent to us by the courts and other referral agencies, explaining our position on signing forms and describing the different types of A.A. meetings available, and that this paper should be directed particularly to the courts and other referral agency personnel, and to the new member, so that all concerned will know what A.A. can do and what A.A. cannot do.

In order to improve communication between A.A. and the professional community, we encourage A.A. members to become active on cooperation with the professional community committees. Where there are existing public information and institutions committees, encourage cooperation among members of all committees, keeping always in mind that our primary purpose is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers.

*Specific suggestions:* Sponsor your doctor; sponsor your clergyman; sponsor your employer; communicate with the academic world; hold workshops at all service levels.

**1977** It was recommended that:

In the spirit of cooperation, we respond to all calls for help with information about A.A., whether the call comes from the alcoholic or from the professional who is calling for his patient or client. As members of A.A. it is our responsibility to try to carry our message of recovery wherever we can.

We reaffirm the 1976 C.P.C. Conference Committee’s recommendation to “Recognize the necessity of meeting the new member where he presently is, listen to him, try to determine what he really knows about the A.A. program,” and we reaffirm, not only this agenda item, but the entire 1976 C.P.C. Conference Committee report.

A joint meeting of the Conference and trustees’ Committees on P.I., C.P.C., and Institutions would not be practical. However, the committee recommended that the General Service Board consider the possibility of holding a joint meeting (between the 1977 and 1978 Conferences) of the trustees’ Committees on P.I., C.P.C., and Institutions. It was the committee’s feeling that while there is bound to be some overlapping of the responsibil-



ities of the three [now four] committees, more specific guidance on who does what is needed. It was also felt that we should do all we can to eliminate any competition so that each committee can function in unity and do the job of carrying the message in the best way possible.

In the interest of communication and cooperation, reports of all three [now four] trustees' committees be distributed to the delegate members of the three [now four] corresponding Conference committees after each trustees' committee meeting.

**1978** It was recommended that:

A.A. members who meet with the administration of a treatment facility concerning the formation of an A.A. group on its premises should explain group autonomy, as well as what A.A. can and cannot do (Traditions) and also have a good understanding of the facility's rules and regulations. After mutual agreements are reached, it is important that this information be shared with the A.A.s who will be attending the group's meetings. It was suggested that groups meeting in treatment facilities try to abide by the self-support tradition. If money for rent is not accepted by a facility, groups should contribute in some other way. It was also felt that the A.A.s employed by the facility should not run the groups at the facility.

**1979** It was recommended that:

A.A. members, through their C.P.C. committees where feasible, assume the responsibility for communicating with treatment facilities and court programs, letting them know which meetings are available for prospective members, including beginners meetings, where possible. Each group's autonomy should be kept in mind. It was further suggested that sponsorship be made available for those new members coming from treatment facilities. (The committee noted that it did not want to detract from the help provided to alcoholics by the professional community, but wished to be of maximum service through cooperation in helping the alcoholic get involved in group life and understanding of the A.A. program.)

The 1976 Conference C.P.C. Committee's recommendation be reaffirmed: "That in order to improve communication between A.A. and the professional community, we encourage A.A. members to become active on C.P.C. committees. Where there are existing public information and institutions committees, encourage cooperation among members of all committees, keeping always in mind that our primary purpose is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Specific suggestions: (a) Sponsor your doctor; (b) sponsor your clergyman; (c) sponsor your employer; (d) communicate with the academic world; (e) hold workshops for all service levels.

"Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends" continue to be available as an A.A.W.S. reprint of a Grapevine article.

"Problems Other Than Alcohol" be Conference-approved.

**1980** It was recommended that:

In keeping with our Eleventh and Twelfth Traditions, A.A. members who are requested to videotape talks and meetings preserve anonymity at the level of press, radio, film, and videotapes, realizing that anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions. The committee further recommended that talks by A.A. members be given in person rather than videotaped, in view of the temptation for videotaping to place personalities before principles.

The pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate" be revised to include information in regard to the functions of area and local committees on cooperation with the professional community.

The recommendation of the 1976 General Service Conference in regard to A.A. members working in the field of alcoholism be reaffirmed. "That we, as A.A. members, give to A.A. members interested in working or volunteering in the alcoholism field the following suggestions: (a) Take advantage of the literature already in existence; (b) get adequate training; (c) have three to five years of good, stable sobriety; (d) get and keep a sponsor who does *not* work in the alcoholism field; (e) be thoroughly familiar with *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*; (f) carefully consider whether or not you are suited to work in the field of alcoholism.

A renewed effort be made to inform A.A.s working in the alcoholism field of our Twelve Traditions, and that they be thoroughly familiar with A.A. Guidelines for A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field.

A.A. continue to devote effort toward cooperation with the professional community. Recognizing that our Fellowship is experiencing a rapid influx of new members, it was further recommended that A.A. groups remember their primary purpose of carrying the message to the alcoholic by:

- a. Providing greeters to welcome new members and visitors
- b. Emphasizing and accepting the responsibilities of sponsorship
- c. Taking group inventories periodically to determine if the group is fulfilling its primary purpose

The pamphlet "Alcoholics Anonymous and the Medical Profession" be condensed and rewritten to reflect current information about A.A.

The topic "Is A.A. Devoting More Attention To Our Relationships Outside A.A. Than We Do To What Is Going On Inside A.A.?" be referred to the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference for consideration as a workshop item at the 1981 General Service Conference.

The Conference reaffirm the recommendation of the 1977 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, as follows: "In the interest of communication and cooperation, reports of trustees' committees on P.I., C.P.C., Correctional Facilities, and Treatment Facilities be distributed to the delegate members of the corresponding Conference committees after each trustees' committee meeting. (Policy/Admissions)

**1981** It was recommended that:

A.A. publish a leaflet addressed to labor and management.

The leaflet "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community" be reinstated as General Service Conference-approved literature and put back into distribution as soon as possible.

**1982** It was recommended that:

The draft of a pamphlet directed to the medical profession be approved with some minor changes to be made in the editing stage, with the title "A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession."

**1983** It was recommended that:

The statement that "A.A. does not provide letters of reference to parole boards, lawyers, court officials, social agencies, employers, etc." be included in the pamphlets "A.A. in Your Community," "If You Are a Professional," "How A.A. Members



Cooperate," the flyer "A.A. at a Glance" and the A.A. Guidelines on Cooperating With Court, A.S.A.P., and Similar Programs.

**1984** It was recommended that:

A statement be included in the pamphlet "A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession" stating that when physicians recommend A.A. to their patients, the physicians not base their opinion of the effectiveness of A.A. on one or two meetings attended by the patients, but give A.A. a fair trial.

Cooperation with the professional community news be regularly included in *Box 4-5-9*, eliminating the *P.I.-C.P.C. Bulletin*.

**1985** It was recommended that:

The following be inserted in the pamphlets "If You Are a Professional" and "How A.A. Members Cooperate":

The only requirement for membership in A.A. is a desire to stop drinking. If the person is not sure about this point, then he or she is most welcome to attend an open A.A. meeting. If the person is sure that drinking is not his or her problem, then he or she may wish to seek help elsewhere.

The pamphlet "If You Are a Professional" be revised and that a draft of the revision of that pamphlet be returned to the 1986 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community for their consideration.

The general manager designate a staff person to coordinate and pull together (at the General Service Office), all available information about spreading the A.A. message to the native North American population, including but not limited to (1) translation of their languages and dialects, (2) experiences of various A.A. groups in their contact with these populations and to explore with a view toward consolidating and expanding A.A.'s experience in these areas; to report back to the 1986 General Service Conference through whatever committee the general manager feels is appropriate. (Floor Action)

The Treatment Facilities, Correctional Facilities, and Cooperation With the Professional Community Workbooks be translated into Spanish. (Floor Action)

**1986** It was recommended that:

The guidelines for use of the Professional Exhibit be as follows:

That the C.P.C. staff person explore the possibility of seeking invitations to exhibit at conferences and conventions of professions outside the field of alcoholism where we've not exhibited before and we perceive a need for an awareness and knowledge of A.A.

That the trustees' C.P.C. Committee review the schedule for the Professional Exhibit annually at their July meeting in order to evaluate the ongoing effectiveness of the exhibit and make recommendations to the C.P.C. staff person for the following year; and that the C.P.C. staff person give a quarterly report to the committee about the Professional Exhibit. That a letter be sent to delegates, alternates and C.P.C. chairpersons annually to make them aware of the Professional Exhibit.

When an exhibit is scheduled, the staff person notify the area delegate for the city in which it is booked, asking for their assistance in providing volunteers to staff the booth. There will be ample opportunity for local committees to raise any problem issues in connection with the exhibit.

In the pamphlet "A Clergyman Asks About Alcoholics Anonymous" in the fifth paragraph on page 8, the sentence which reads "Newcomers are encouraged to attend one or more

meetings a week" be changed to "Newcomers are encouraged to attend meetings as frequently as possible."

No change is required in the wording of Item 3c on page 11 of the pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate," since decisions about whether or not such information is provided is up to the group conscience of the A.A. entity involved in accordance with the Fourth Tradition.

The new "If You Are a Professional" pamphlet, with some design suggestions and editorial changes in the manuscript, be approved.

**1987** It was recommended that:

The C.P.C. staff person write to all area assembly chairpersons to gather information on their interest in having tabletop exhibits and the areas' desire to purchase them.

The title of the pamphlet "A Clergyman Asks" be changed to "The Clergy Asks" when it comes up for reprint.

**1988** It was recommended that:

The following sentence "Dually or multiply addicted persons are asked to seek A.A. membership only if one of their addictions is to alcohol" be deleted in the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional" under the section titled "Problems Other Than Alcohol" at the next printing.

After discussing in depth the need for carrying the A.A. message to the black community, the committee decided that the scope of the initiative be broadened to include all minorities with emphasis on the black community and recommended that the C.P.C. secretary and the Public Information secretary consider the suggestions listed in the *P.I./C.P.C. Bulletin*, Fall 1981, and use them as guidelines for carrying the message to all minorities.

A letter be sent to all area P.I. and C.P.C. chairpersons with these revised suggestions for carrying the A.A. message to minority group members.

In order to follow the progress of this initiative to minorities, the committee requested that the secretary send the committee members a full report of whatever action takes place at the trustees' C.P.C. and P.I. Committees at the July board meeting and that discussion of the initiative be an item on the agenda of the 1989 Conference C.P.C. Committee.

**1989** It was recommended that:

The revised text of the pamphlet "A.A. and Occupational Alcoholism Programs" be approved with minor changes.

The title of the pamphlet "A.A. and Occupational Alcoholism Programs" be changed to "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs."

In carrying the A.A. messages to minorities:

- a. The focus and work of the C.P.C. trustees' Committee, C.P.C. staff and all C.P.C. committees continue to gather information on how the A.A. message of recovery can better be carried to and through minorities, minority professionals, and all professionals who work with minorities.
- b. That any initiative to better carry the A.A. message to and through minorities media and media which focus on minorities readers, viewers or listeners, and in schools with high minorities populations, be referred to the appropriate public information committees for any continued consideration.



- c. That any further consideration of how minorities may better be reached within the A.A. Fellowship with the message of becoming involved in service, be through future consideration by the General Service Conference.
- d. That our minorities initiatives reflect our primary concern for helping all alcoholics.

A revised text of the pamphlet "The Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous" be placed on the agenda for the 1990 General Service Conference C.P.C. Committee.

The trustees' C.P.C. Committee and G.S.O. staff update the C.P.C. Workbook, giving consideration to including a service piece similar to one submitted by Southern Minnesota Assembly.

Consideration be given to development of a guideline for area C.P.C. committees to set up exhibits at state and local professional conventions.

Consideration be given by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee to the development of a video which addresses the need to inform both professionals and A.A. members how our friends historically have helped the Fellowship and how we can cooperate within the framework of our purpose, experience and Traditions, and that discussion of the feasibility of such a project be placed on the agenda of the 1990 General Service Conference C.P.C. Committee.

**1990** It was recommended that:

The revised pamphlet "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous" be published, with minor changes, once the present supply of the old pamphlet is exhausted.

**1991** It was recommended that:

The Preamble, the Twelve Steps and the Twelve Traditions be added to the following pamphlets: "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs," "A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession" and "If You Are a Professional," when pamphlets are reprinted. Estimated cost: \$5,000.

**1992** It was recommended that:

The revised pamphlet "A.A. as a Resource for the Healthcare Professional" be approved, replacing "A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession," because of the need to include information for all healthcare professionals.

The following changes be made in the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional" when reprinted:

- a. Delete the words "self-help" in two places.
- b. Change the second sentence, third paragraph on page 5 to read "Consequently, while we welcome the opportunity to share our principles and methods with others, only they can provide the essential ingredient for success: their common bond."

The Preamble, Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions be added to all C.P.C. pamphlets when reprinted, to provide consistent and uniform information.

The following paragraphs be added to all C.P.C. pamphlets when reprinted, to provide consistent and uniform information:

Many local A.A. service committees will, upon request, provide informational presentations for your organization. Sessions can be tailored to meet your needs. A typical agenda might include one or several A.A. films and a presentation by one or more A.A. members on "What A.A. Is and What It Is Not."

Please check your local telephone directory or newspaper for the number of Alcoholics Anonymous.

**1993** It was recommended that:

At the next printing of the pamphlet "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community" the following revisions be made:

- a. Change the heading "A.A.'s Position in the Field of Alcoholism" to "A.A. and Alcoholism."
- b. Delete the subheading "How A.A. Views Alcoholism" and change "Alcoholism is, in our opinion. . ." to "From the beginning, many A.A. members have come to believe alcoholism is a progressive illness—spiritual and emotional (or mental), as well as physical."

Because the phrase "A.A.'s position in the field of alcoholism" could imply a point of view or an opinion, consistency in our literature be maintained by changing that phrase wherever it appears in A.A. literature to "A.A. and Alcoholism" or similar wording that would remove the sense of a point-of-view or opinion when such material is due for reprint.

**1994** It was recommended that:

The changes to "How A.A. Members Cooperate with Other Community Efforts to Help Alcoholics," prepared by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee, be approved with these additional changes:

- a. This header be added to the contents page for the first page of text: "A.A. publications referred to in these pages are listed on the inside back cover."
- b. Abbreviations and acronyms be spelled out or explained the first time or two each is used.
- c. On page 16 of the draft, question 17 "How can local A.A. groups and members help patients who are being discharged from treatment facilities?" be answered: "In order to bridge the gap, A.A. members have volunteered to be temporary contacts and introduce newcomers to Alcoholics Anonymous. Many local groups and committees have established such temporary contact programs. (For more information, see the 'Bridging the Gap' pamphlet.)"
- d. On page 20 of the draft, the first line of the answer to question 4, "Why is C.P.C. activity important?", be changed from "The professional can help the alcoholic want to hear the A.A. message of recovery" to: "The professional can help the alcoholic become willing to hear the A.A. message of recovery."
- e. The pamphlet's title be changed to "How A.A. Members Cooperate with Professionals" with the subheading "Cooperation, But Not Affiliation."

The policy on distributing A.A. confidential directories to outside organizations, treatment professionals and others requesting this information, when approved by the Area delegate, be changed as described below, because of the need to respect the autonomy and anonymity of other groups and members, as well as A.A. as a whole:

- a. The General Service Office no longer provide A.A. confidential directories outside the Fellowship.
- b. G.S.O. respond to future requests with a friendly letter of explanation enclosing the listing of Central Offices, Intergroups and Answering Services for United States and Canada; and, forward the request to the Area delegate for information and follow up.



The format of the C.P.C. Workbook be changed as described below to enable wider use of this information, and to reduce the costs to local committees:

- The format be changed to a soft-cover booklet, comparable to the Correctional Facilities Workbook, and the booklet enclosed in a folder with related C.P.C. materials.
- The booklet be available separately, as well as in the complete kit.
- The contents of the kit be addressed and discussed by the 1995 Conference C.P.C. Committee.
- The text be revised and condensed for clarity, and to eliminate inconsistencies and redundancies, and a draft sent as background to the 1995 Conference C.P.C. Committee for approval.

**1995** It was recommended that:

The soft-cover C.P.C. Workbook be made available as a single item, as well as in a simple binder labeled "C.P.C. Kit" containing related items suggested by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee.

**1997** It was recommended that:

The following statement regarding Singleness of Purpose be added to the C.P.C. pamphlets: "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community," "A.A. and Employees Assistance Programs," "A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional," "How A.A. Members Cooperate With Professionals," "If You Are a Professional," and "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous" under the title "Singleness of Purpose and Problems Other Than Alcohol" at the next printing:

"Alcoholism and drug addiction are often referred to as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Alcoholics and non-alcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend *open* A.A. meetings. But only those with a *drinking* problem may attend *closed* meetings or become A.A. members. People with problems other than alcoholism are eligible for A.A. membership *only* if they have a drinking problem."

The following items be added or replaced under the title "What A.A. Does Not Do" to the following pamphlets: "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community," "If You Are a Professional" and "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous," at the next printing:

A.A. does not: Furnish initial motivation for alcoholics to recover; solicit members; engage in or sponsor research; keep attendance records or case histories; join "councils" of social agencies; follow up or try to control its members; make medical or psychological diagnoses or prognoses; provide drying-out or nursing services, hospitalization, drugs, or any medical or psychiatric treatment; offer religious services; engage in education about alcohol; provide housing, food, clothing, jobs, money or any other welfare or social services; provide domestic or vocational counseling; accept any money for its services or any contributions from non-A.A. sources; provide letters of reference to parole boards, lawyers, court officials, social agencies, employers, etc.

The C.P.C. Kit and Workbook be designated as service material rather than "A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature."

**1998** It was recommended that:

The draft revision of the pamphlet to replace "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs" be approved with the title

"Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?" and the following changes:

- In the section to the co-worker, delete the line: "Al-Anon is not affiliated with A.A., but its contribution to increased understanding of the A.A. recovery program has been substantial."
- In reference to Al-Anon in the text of the pamphlet, insert the text from the footnoted material on page 121 of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* as follows: "Though it is entirely separate from Alcoholics Anonymous, it uses the general principles of the A.A. program as a guide for husbands, wives, relatives, friends, and others close to alcoholics."

**2003** It was recommended that:

The "Singleness of Purpose" statement in six designated C.P.C. pamphlets ("Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community," "Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?" "A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional," "How A.A. Members Cooperate with Professionals," "If You are a Professional . . .," and "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous") be changed to read:

"Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend *open* A.A. meetings, but only those with a *drinking* problem may attend *closed* meetings."

Three changes to the pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate with Professionals" (P-29):

- The sentence on page 14, Number 2, item F, which reads "G.S.O. staff members also have assignments in those fields," be changed to read: "G.S.O. staff members also have rotating assignments in those fields;"
- The sentence on page 15, Number 5, which reads: "If asked, individual members may recommend someone—but with the clear understanding that the reference is strictly personal, *not* made in behalf of A.A.," be changed to read: "If asked, individual members may recommend someone—but with the clear understanding that the reference is strictly personal, *not* made on behalf of A.A."
- The sentence on page 21, Number 19, first paragraph, which reads: "There is no formal relationship at all, any more than there is a structural or official relationship between A.A. and any church, temple, ethical or humanist or agnostic society, or medication centers that a member may attend," be changed to read "There is no formal relationship at all, any more than there is a structural or official relationship between A.A. and any church, temple, ethical or humanist or agnostic society, or meditation centers that a member may attend."

**2006** It was recommended that:

Three short video segments be produced that can be accessed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and directed to professionals in the employment/human relations, legal/criminal justice, and medical fields and brought back to the 2007 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community, with a total cost not to exceed \$60,000. [See Floor Action]

To amend the Cooperation With the Professional Community Advisory Action:

The committee recommended that three short video seg-



ments be produced that can be accessed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and directed to professionals in the employment/human relations, legal/criminal justice, and medical fields [with a total cost not to exceed \$60,000].

By inserting the following language into the Advisory Action after medical fields:

"and brought back to the 2007 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community"

So that it would read:

The committee recommended that three short video segments be produced that can be accessed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and directed to professionals in the employment/human relations, legal/criminal justice and medical fields, and brought back to the 2007 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community, with a total cost not to exceed \$60,000. (Floor Action)

**2008** It was recommended that:

The video segments directed to professionals in the legal/criminal justice and healthcare fields to be streamed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site be approved with suggested changes and that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities oversee these changes.

**2009** It was recommended that:

The video segments directed to professionals in the employment/human relations field to be streamed on to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site be approved.

**2012** It was recommended that:

The current statement regarding "Singleness of Purpose" in C.P.C. literature which reads:

"Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend open A.A. meetings, but only those with a drinking problem may attend closed meetings"

Be revised to read as follows:

"Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Nonalcoholics may attend open A.A. meetings as observers, but only those with a drinking problem may attend closed A.A. meetings."

The text in the "What A.A. Does Not Do" section in the C.P.C. pamphlets "A.A. in Your Community," "If You Are a Professional" and "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous" be replaced with the text in the section "What A.A. Does Not Do" in the "A.A. at a Glance" flyer and the entire section read as follows:

#### **What A.A. Does NOT Do**

A.A. does not: Furnish initial motivation for alcoholics to recover...solicit members...engage in or sponsor research...keep attendance records or case histories...join "councils" or social agencies (although A.A. members, groups and service offices frequently cooperate with them)...follow up or try to control its members...make medical or psychological diagnoses or prognoses...provide detox, rehabilitation or nursing services, hospitalization, drugs, or any medical or psychiatric treatment...offer religious services or host/sponsor retreats...engage in education about alcohol...provide

housing, food, clothing, jobs, money, or any other welfare or social services...provide domestic or vocational counseling...accept any money for its services, or any contributions from non-A.A. sources...provide letters of reference to parole boards, lawyers, court officials, social agencies, employers, etc.

**2013** It was recommended that:

The statement in the section Referrals From Court and Treatment Facilities in the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional..." which currently reads:

"Some groups, with the consent of the prospective member, have the A.A. group secretary sign or initial a slip that has been furnished by the court together with a self-addressed court envelope. The referred person supplies identification and mails the slip back to the court as proof of attendance."

Be revised as follows:

"Each group is autonomous. Some groups, at the request of the prospective member, have the A.A. group secretary sign, initial or stamp a slip that has been furnished by the court. The referred person provides the slip to the court as proof of attendance."

The statement in the section How to Make Referrals to A.A. in the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional..." which currently reads:

"Or, you can contact the General Service Office of Alcoholics Anonymous for help and information. Write:

P.O. Box 459  
Grand Central Station  
New York, NY 10163  
Or phone: (212) 870-3400"

Be revised as follows:

"You can also contact the General Service Office of Alcoholics Anonymous for help and information at:

P.O. Box 459  
Grand Central Station  
New York, NY 10163  
(212) 870-3400  
www.aa.org "

The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities revise the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional..." taking into consideration suggested changes of the Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community and bring back a report or draft pamphlet to the 2014 Conference Committee.

**2014** It was recommended that:

The statement in the section Referrals From Court and Treatment Facilities to A.A. on page 4 in the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional..." which currently reads:

#### **Referrals From Court and Treatment Facilities**

Today numerous A.A. members come to us from court programs and treatment facilities. Some arrive voluntarily, others do not.

A.A. does not discriminate against any prospective member. Who made the referral to A.A. is not what interests us — it is the problem drinker who elicits our concern.

*Proof of attendance at meetings.* Sometimes a court asks for proof of attendance at A.A. meetings.

- Some groups, with the consent of the prospective member, have the A.A. group secretary sign or initial a



slip that has been furnished by the court together with a self-addressed court envelope. The referred person supplies identification and mails the slip back to the court as proof of attendance.

- Other groups cooperate in different ways. There is no set procedure. The nature and extent of any group's involvement in this process is entirely up to the individual group.

Be revised to read:

***Referrals From Judicial, Health Care, or Other Professionals***

Today numerous A.A. members come to us from **judicial, health care, or other professionals**. Some arrive voluntarily, others do not.

A.A. does not discriminate against any prospective member. Who made the referral to A.A. is not what interests us — it is the problem drinker who elicits our concern.

*Proof of attendance at meetings.* Sometimes a **referral source** asks for proof of attendance at A.A. meetings.

- **Groups** cooperate in different ways. There is no set procedure. The nature and extent of any group's involvement in this process is entirely up to the individual group.
- Some groups, with the consent of the prospective member, have **an A.A. member acknowledge attendance on a slip that has been furnished by the referral source. The referred person is responsible for returning the proof of attendance.**

The statement in the section *How to Make Referrals* to A.A. on page 5 in the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional..." which currently reads:

Alcoholics Anonymous is listed in most telephone directories. (Some professionals call A.A. while the person is in the office, thus giving the individual an immediate opportunity to reach out for help.)

Or, you can contact the General Service Office of Alcoholics Anonymous for help and information. Write:

P.O. Box 459, Grand Central Station, New York, NY 10163  
(212) 870-3400  
www.aa.org

Be revised to read:

Alcoholics Anonymous **can be found on the Internet at [www.aa.org](http://www.aa.org)** and in most telephone directories by looking for 'Alcoholics Anonymous' or 'A.A.' **(Some professionals ask the person they are referring to call the local A.A. number while still in the office, thus offering an immediate opportunity to reach out for help.)**

Or you can contact the General Service Office (G.S.O.) of Alcoholics Anonymous for help and information. **G.S.O.'s A.A. website [www.aa.org](http://www.aa.org) can aid in finding local resources.**

P.O. Box 459, Grand Central Station, New York, NY 10163  
(212) 870-3400  
www.aa.org

On page 6 in the pamphlet "A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional" the following text be deleted:

"I can't stand the smoking."

There are nonsmoking meetings available. Check the local meeting book for them or contact the local A.A. central office which is listed in your telephone directory.

**2016** It was recommended that:

A new section on A.A. and medications be added to the pamphlet "If You are a Professional..." with the following text:

**A.A. Members and Medications**

A.A. does not provide medical advice; all medical advice and treatment should come from a qualified health care professional. The suggestions provided in the pamphlet "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" may help A.A. members minimize the risk of relapse.

Text be added to the last paragraph of the first page of the pamphlet "Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?" to read (additions in bold):

A.A. can help organizations, **corporations and businesses, regardless of size**, contact men and women who have achieved sobriety, and are willing to share their experience freely with anyone who seeks help.

Several minor revisions to the pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate With Professionals" be approved.

An introductory paragraph for professionals be added to the pamphlet "Problems Other Than Alcohol" addressing the notion that while some language in the 1958 pamphlet is dated, the issues are prevalent today, and asked that a draft introductory paragraph be brought back to the 2017 Conference Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee for review.

**2017** It was recommended that:

The pamphlet "Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W." be retired.

A footnote with the following text be added to the pamphlet "Problems Other Than Alcohol" at the bottom of page 1:

This pamphlet is derived from an article written by A.A. co-founder Bill W. in 1958. Therefore, some of the language may be dated, but the issues addressed are prevalent today.

The title of the pamphlet "Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?" be changed to "Is There a Problem Drinker in the Workplace?"

The trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community review the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional," develop text to include information for professionals who come in contact with veterans and active members of the Armed Services, including information on how to contact A.A. worldwide, and bring back a report or draft text to the 2018 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community for review.

The trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community review the pamphlet "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous," develop text to include information for professionals who come in contact with veterans and active members of the Armed Services, including information on how to contact A.A. worldwide, and bring back a report or draft text to the 2018 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community for review.

The trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community review the pamphlet "A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional," develop text to include information for professionals who come in contact with veterans and active members of the Armed Services, including information on how to contact A.A. worldwide, and bring back a report or draft text to the 2018 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community for review.



**2018** It was recommended that:

The text on page 9 of the pamphlet “A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional” which currently reads:

Sharing experience as peers is the unique service Alcoholics Anonymous offers. In most instances, health care professionals find A.A. members not only willing but eager to introduce newcomers to the A.A. program.

Be revised to read:

Sharing experience as peers is the unique service Alcoholics Anonymous offers. With no membership requirements beyond the desire to stop drinking, members are on an equal footing. What’s important is getting the help that is needed, and in most instances, health care professionals find A.A. members not only willing but eager to introduce newcomers to the A.A. program.

The text on page 10 of the pamphlet “A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional” which currently reads:

A.A. is listed in most telephone directories or local newspapers, and a phone call is all that is needed for help.

Be revised to read:

Alcoholics Anonymous can be found on the Internet at aa.org and in most telephone directories by looking for “Alcoholics Anonymous.” Additionally, online A.A. meetings are available, which members of the military and others often use when they are in places where there are no meetings nearby.

A new section be added beginning on page 16 of the pamphlet “Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous,” between the sections “Why Would the Clergy be Concerned with A.A.?” and “Do Any of the Clergy Belong to A.A.?” with text as follows:

#### **What If You Are a Chaplain in the Military?**

Like other members of the clergy, military chaplains are often the “safest” people a problem drinker can approach. Chaplains can help direct alcoholics to available A.A. meetings, either on or near the base. Additionally, if no meetings are available, chaplains may be able to connect interested alcoholics with other A.A. materials, such as books and pamphlets or A.A.’s magazines, Grapevine and La Viña. Online meetings are also available for those members of the military who may be deployed, and chaplains can help get them connected electronically through correspondence groups. (A.A.’s General Service Office can provide information on such resources.)

Text be added to the pamphlet “If You Are a Professional...” on page 4, first paragraph, to read (additions in bold):

*Meetings:* At the heart of the program are its meetings, which are conducted autonomously by A.A. groups in cities and towns throughout the world, **even in jails, institutions and on military bases.**

Text be added to the pamphlet “If You Are a Professional...” on page 4, last section, to read (additions in **bold**):

Referrals from Judicial, Health Care, **Military**, or other Professionals

Today numerous A.A. members come to us from judicial, health care, **military** or other professionals.

Text be added to the pamphlet “If You Are a Professional...” in the last full paragraph on page 5, to read (additions in **bold**):

Or you can contact the General Service Office (G.S.O.) of

Alcoholics Anonymous for help and information. G.S.O.’s A.A. website aa.org can aid in finding local resources. **Additionally, online A.A. meetings are available, which members of the military and others often use when they are in places where there are no meetings nearby.**

A.A. World Services, Inc. develop a company page on LinkedIn with the following goals in mind:

- To offer another digital resource, in addition to aa.org, where professionals can find accurate information about A.A.
- To broaden the reach of the About A.A. newsletter for professionals
- To offer a platform where our professional friends may recommend us
- To raise awareness of exhibits staffed by local C.P.C. committees at national and local professional conferences
- To expand the network of our professional friends and perhaps deepen the pool of Class A Trustee candidates
- By our presence on LinkedIn, to reinforce the continuing relevance and efficacy of A.A. to professionals

The text on page 18 of the pamphlet “Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous” that currently reads:

Please check your local telephone directory or newspaper for the number of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Be revised to read:

Alcoholics Anonymous can be found on the Internet at aa.org and in most telephone directories by looking for “Alcoholics Anonymous.” Additionally, online meetings are available, which members of the military and others often use when they are in places where there is no meeting nearby. (Floor Action)

**2019** It was recommended that:

The text “They may help arrange hospitalization” be removed from the section “What can you expect from A.A.?” in the pamphlet “Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community.”

**2021** It was recommended that:

The goals expressed in the 2018 Advisory Action establishing a dynamic A.A.W.S. LinkedIn page be implemented by G.S.O., to provide current and relevant content about A.A. to professionals in accordance with A.A. principles and Traditions; and that a progress report on the usefulness and effectiveness of implementing these updates on the A.A.W.S. LinkedIn page be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

The trustees’ Cooperation with the Professional Community/ Treatment and Accessibilities Committee develop a pamphlet directed to mental health professionals. The committee requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought to the 2022 Conference Committee Cooperation with the Professional Community.

The updated draft pamphlet “Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous” be approved with minor editorial changes and retitled “Faith Leaders Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous.”

**2023** It was recommended that:

- The pamphlet “A.A. in Your Community” be approved with minor editorial changes.

**2025** It was recommended that:

- The project for the development of an outward-facing



pamphlet for mental health professionals be redirected, utilizing existing content in the current draft and reformatted in a quad-fold layout. The committee requests that a draft pamphlet or progress report be brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

- On a one-year trial basis, AAWS subscribe to a LinkedIn premium business account at a cost not to exceed \$1,000 per year, and to bring back a report on the effectiveness of the upgraded account to the 2026 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.



## Advisory Actions Relevant to the Conference Finance Committee

### Advisory Committee on the Budget

**1951** It was recommended that:

Each delegate report to his State or Provincial committee a summary of the financial report.

Each delegate advise his Committee of the film strip presentation approved for general issue, illustrating the services rendered by the Grapevine and the General Service Office.

The primary report to area groups and A.A. members consist of this visual presentation and the information that the services rendered by the Grapevine and the General Service Office should not be curtailed.

Following this description of services, it is suggested that all be acquainted with the projected 1951 General Service Office budget, which is \$107,000. In this connection, it is suggested that those groups wishing to participate in contributing to the Alcoholic Foundation give a minimum of two dollars per member for the year 1951. (As more groups participate it is hoped the succeeding annual request per member may be decreased.)

The Board of Directors of the Grapevine adopt some mild form of promotion for an increase in circulation. An illustration might be the distribution of a postage-free envelope in a distinctive color to provide for an initial trial subscription at a cost of \$1. for four months.

On October 1, 1951, the financial results of the operations of the Grapevine to that date be reviewed. If there is no considerable improvement, an increase in price is recommended to avoid further impairment of the Alcoholic Foundation reserve fund.

### Committee on Finance

**1952** It was recommended that:

The policy of seeking group contributions at the rate of \$2.00 a year for each member be continued in effect. It is suggested that groups provide for these contributions in monthly or quarterly budgets or schedules of expenditures.

As a means of informing the groups, a simple summary of General Office Financial operations be prepared, showing current conditions, including the Group Fund's accumulated indebtedness of \$24,000 to the Alcoholic Foundation.

Delegates and state committeemen make a special effort to enlighten their groups in respect to the position of the General Service Office as the functional center of the A.A. movement, operating as the support of the existing membership and the bearer of the message to those alcoholics who still do not know.

**1953** It was recommended that:

The policy of seeking contributions at the rate of \$2.00 per member per year be continued and that further efforts be made to bring to the attention of the non-contributing groups the position of the General Service Headquarters as the functional

center of the A.A. movement as well as the remaining indebtedness of \$20,000 to The Alcoholic Foundation, Inc.

Delegates and state committeemen continue their fine work in emphasizing to the groups the importance of the General Service Conference in relation to the policies and responsibilities of the A.A. movement as a whole so that the need for the financial support will be understood.

For the time being, no reduction be made in selling prices of pamphlets. In view of the feeling expressed by the Conference in reference to any future need for increasing the reserve fund that the delegates and committeemen review with the groups in their areas, the possible question of selling books to the groups at the retail price should such future need arise.

The next appeal for contributions from the groups should be made in the form of a letter over the name of the General Service Conference. (Floor Action)

**1954** It was recommended that:

The policy of seeking group contributions at the suggested minimum rate of \$2.00 per member per year be continued, and that greater efforts be made by all delegates to increase not only the amount of group contributions but also the number of groups contributing. Furthermore, that the delegates are asked to have their groups remit their contributions quarterly to the General Service Board.

With regard to an unusual bequest, the trustees be instructed to execute an appropriate instrument transferring the interest acquired by A.A. under this will proportionately to the other beneficiaries named by the deceased person. (Floor Action)

**1955** It was recommended that:

More emphasis should be placed on our coming of age, on our responsibilities as A.A. citizens, on our gratitude to our services, and our desire to see to it that A.A.'s message can always be carried to the alcoholic who does not know, no matter where he may be.

Each delegate either through his committeemen or personally, make an effort to reach the general service representative of each group so that the general service representative may personally follow through at the group level and individually, in making more members aware of these responsibilities.

Since there is no longer a Conference Fund, this decision having been reached by the delegates to this Conference, and since the Conference will be supported from over-all group funds in the future, it is further necessary that group contributions be increased. Therefore, it is suggested that over and above the customary group contributions which are based on the yardstick of \$2. per year per member, those delegates who care to, might also put into circulation in their areas the Birthday Plan which has been successful in Oklahoma. Additional suggested plans for increasing contributions consist of the following:



1. Earmarking specific meetings for Headquarters contributions.
2. Piggy banks possibly in the form of empty whiskey bottles with the notation "Pour it in, Don't pour it out" or "Are you a piggy backer or piggy banker?"
3. Take a percentage of each group meeting collection for group contributions.
4. Remind each member that 4 cents a week is more than \$2 per year.

The Conference Fund appeal be discontinued. (Floor Action)

**1956** It was recommended that:

In order to put Headquarters on a current financial basis, perhaps it would be possible to increase the weekly contribution to 10 cents per member for six months. This would mean that by October the estimated budget of General Service Headquarters would be covered. . . and current. Then by dropping back to 5 cents per week, if all groups would send in their contributions every three months, instead of six months, then General Service Headquarters would stay on a current basis.

General Service Headquarters designate Thanksgiving Week each year as "A.A. Gratitude Week" and that this action be noted in the annual pre-Thanksgiving appeals to the groups for funds to help support A.A.'s worldwide services. (Floor Action)

**1957** It was recommended that:

All delegates urge all of their committeemen to do everything they can to tell every member of every group what G.S.H. does, and what it uses the money for.

G.S.H. furnish each delegate with a summary of Headquarters' services and expenditures. Each delegate should have enough copies to furnish one copy to each committeeman and each group secretary.

Groups be urged to collect 20 cents per month per member and send it in to G.S.H. every month, rather than twice a year.

General Service Headquarters designate Thanksgiving Week as "A.A. Gratitude Week." In this connection, it is to be suggested to groups that a special appeal for funds to support A.A.'s world services be made at local meetings. (Floor Action)

The suggestion of the Finance and Budgetary Committee that contributions from individual members be limited to \$100. in one year be approved. (Delegates Only Meeting)

**1958** It was recommended that:

The following plan of the Finance Committee's be adopted: Each delegate member of the Finance Committee will fully instruct his Area committeemen and Group Representatives at meetings within the next few weeks that each member of each group will be expected to contribute 4 cents a week minimum, collectible quarterly, for the maintenance of A.A. World Services at G.S.O. The general service representative will be responsible for sending the money to G.S.O. Each delegate will repeat this mouth-to-ear appeal during the year.

Several more delegates, both panel 7 and panel 8, help the Finance Committee meet the need for wider participation in group contributions.

All areas with Birthday Plan experience forward data to Anita R. at G.S.O. where a file will be opened to collate this material for presentation to the 1959 Conference.

A voluntary pilot plan of letters from A.A.s to their friends who no longer contribute to G.S.O. through their groups—close

friends who are no longer as active in their group as formerly—should be cleared through G.S.O. to prevent duplications.

Accredited Delegates from U.S. Territories, possessions and the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico should receive the same financial considerations as the Delegates from the U.S. and Canada, as these delegates have been accepted by the Conference as a part of the Conference structure. (Floor Action)

**1959** It was recommended that:

The pilot plan for individual contributions continue to be explored.

Each Delegate choose a Group Fund Plan he believes is most likely to be successful in his area:

- a. Birthday Plan
- b. Monthly budgeted contributions
- c. Pint-a-Month donations
- d. Coin Folders
- e. Card or receipt for individual members
- f. Pass empty whiskey bottle at each meeting earmarked for worldwide Twelfth Step work.
- g. Tin can or piggy bank
- h. Five cents per member present at each meeting taken out of collection.

Delegates send list of their groups to G.S.O. quarterly and have contributions filled in when it will be helpful.

New pamphlet "Inside A.A." be utilized in informing our membership on "Getting Things Done in A.A. on a Worldwide Basis."

The over-all problem of providing sufficient funds be approached with an attitude of optimism.

\$3.00 per member replace the \$2.00 suggested as annual contribution to G.S.O. (Policy Committee)

Traditional A.A. policy of declining bequests in any form, from A.A.'s or non-A.A.'s be reaffirmed, and that all Delegates receive a copy of current letter used in declining such requests. (Policy Committee)

The pilot plan for individual contributions be continued on an exploratory basis. (Floor Action)

**1960** It was recommended that:

We continue to suggest \$3.00 per member per year as the yardstick for group contributions, bearing in mind that some areas of service can be expanded if we continue to increase our group contributions. *The committee suggests this might best be accomplished by:*

1. Continued effort on the part of the delegates, committeemen and G.S.R.'s to enlighten the members of their groups as to the *need* for, and the services rendered by, our G.S.O. which could not be done by individual groups or members.
2. By thanking and complimenting those groups already contributing their share.
3. By offering to groups having difficulty, the suggestions and plans of groups participating in the Legacy of Service. Participation creates a sense of unity otherwise impossible.
4. By recognizing that each local area may find a different method successful in stimulating contributions to G.S.O.



5. By reminding the groups that it is helpful to G.S.O. to have contributions quarterly or even monthly, rather than waiting until the end of the year.

The budget for 1960 submitted by the General Service Board's Budget and Finance Committee be adopted.

A new simplified manner of presenting financial data be approved. (Floor Action)

**1961** It was recommended that:

The Birthday Plan to provide "supplementary" support of A.A.'s world services be adopted and continued

The present contributions yardstick of \$3.00 per member per year be reaffirmed and maintained.

Delegates consider various plans to increase their support of World Services that may prove most adaptable to their own areas.

The adoption of any of these plans be reported to the Secretary of the Conference Finance Committee so that reports on them may be made available to the 1962 Conference.

\$5,000 be taken from the General Fund and earmarked to assist overseas groups in the preparation and translation of Conference-approved literature for the period of one year only.

**1962** It was recommended that:

Use of the Birthday Plan as adopted by the 1961 Conference to provide supplementary support of A.A. World Services be continued.

The present contribution yardstick of \$3.00 per member per year be reaffirmed and maintained.

Delegates consider various plans to increase support of world services that may prove most adaptable to their own areas, and that the nature and success of various plans used be shared with G.S.O.

Allocation of \$5,000 from the General Fund to assist overseas groups in the preparation and translation of Conference-approved literature in the coming year be renewed.

The area committee and assemblies continue to be responsible for the delegate's travel expense to the General Service Conference meeting in New York up to \$100, and that this amount not be increased to \$150 at the present time.

A study be made by the Finance and Budgetary Committee of the General Service Board on the savings which might be made if delegates traveled by Jet Tourist Class, when practical in their areas, and that consideration be given to use of this type of travel.

The General Service Board, in following the traditional policy of declining In Memoriam contributions from nonmembers, limit its standard letter of declination to an expression of gratitude and a statement of tradition on such matters.

**1963** It was recommended that:

In a joint meeting of the trustees' and Conference Finance Committees, it was agreed to reconvene on November 1 and 2, 1963, subject to the approval of the Chairman of the General Service Board, in accordance with the proposal of the 1963 Conference. The meeting will be for the purpose of examining suggestions and recommendations received from delegates to make G.S.O. self-supporting.

The combined Committee "looks with favor on increased participation by overseas A.A. units in the General Service

Conference and recommends that a study of factors involved be made by the G.S.O. staff.

Any records of contributions received by G.S.O. in Canadian dollars be clarified with a footnote which would indicate that there is a difference in the exchange rate, so the reader will understand that contributions in Canadian dollars are larger than the amount shown.

A plan to explore the possibility of making General Services increasingly self-supporting by encouraging groups to contribute on the basis of monthly sharing (regular monthly contributions) be approved. (Floor Action)

**1964** It was recommended that:

General Service Agencies should not adopt a fiscal year.

The present pattern of book discounts (whereby the groups have waived a portion of their discount to permit creation of an adequate reserve fund) be deferred for such action as may be taken by the 1965 Conference.

A pension program for G.S.O. employees with possible linkage to income from book discount waivers be explored.

The 1964 General Service Budget, as presented by the General Manager of G.S.O., be accepted.

An agreement between Bill W., co-founder, and A.A. World Services, Inc., covering royalties derived from Bill's writings be approved.

Under the terms of the contract, a royalty of 15 per cent is paid to Bill, except that no royalties are paid on "overseas editions." Royalties are to be paid to Bill and Lois, his wife, during their lifetimes; following the deaths of Bill and Lois, royalties revert in shares of royalties to living heirs. These shares revert to A.A.W.S. upon the deaths of the beneficiaries. Not more than 20 per cent may be bequeathed to any heir under the age of 40 years as of the date of the agreement between Bill and A.A.W.S. (April 29, 1963). The contract provides protection of royalties against "cheap books" and protection of A.A.W.S. and Bill against fluctuations in general economic conditions. A.A.W.S. retains the right of "first refusal" on any future literary works of Bill's.

Action on extending the scope of the Monthly Sharing Plan, after noting the encouraging results in the six test Areas during the first quarter of 1964 be deferred. (Contributions up 60%; participating Groups up 33%.)

**1965** It was recommended that:

Regarding the Book Discounts/Retirement Fund,

- a. The policy of book discounts being waived by groups, established by 1954 and modified by 1955 Conference actions, be continued.
- b. The Reserve Fund, which reached \$307,775.26 as of December 31, 1964, receive no more funds from book discounts waived.
- c. For the year 1965 and subsequent years, funds received from book discounts waived, together with funds, if any, determined each year by the Board of Directors of Grapevine to be available for such purposes, be used to provide retirement income for regular employees of A.A. World Services, Inc., and of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., pursuant to a pension plan or retirement plan in form as may hereafter be adopted by the General Service Board.



That the system of quarterly acknowledgments of Group contributions be adopted by all the groups in the United States and Canada be approved.

G.S.O. and Grapevine budgets be approved.

Regarding two motions and three recommendations stemming from the Finance Workshop, that all five be approved. They are as follows:

- a. The present method of choosing Conference committees be retained, i.e., drawing from the hat at the Conference.
- b. In future years, Conference Committee Co-Chairman be elected at the last meeting of the Conference Committee rather than the first, to provide a greater length of time for the Committee members to make a choice.
- c. It be reaffirmed that the Co-Chairman start to serve as Chairman immediately following the Conference.
- d. With respect to the Finance Committee, that the members serving this year as observers be incorporated as voting members immediately and that the sense of the motion be that the same recommendation be given to the Policy Committee to affect all Conference Committees (effective immediately 1965).
- e. Communications between Conference committee members and, if desired, with members of the General Service Board Committee members be improved and facilitated through the Conference Committee Secretary and Conference Committee Chairman throughout the year.

**1966** It was recommended that:

Groups be educated regarding the functions of G.S.O.

A pension plan for G.S.O. employees be approved.

The delegates' expense allowance revision be studied by all Areas in assemblies during the next year, to find some fairer distribution of financial responsibility for the Conference, and that the 1967 Conference Finance Committee review findings and recommend such for the Conference Policy Committee.

The General Service Board can now accept a bequest of no more than \$100 left to it by an A.A. member and reaffirmed that G.S.O. should continue *not* to accept any bequest from non-A.A.'s. (Floor Action)

**1967** It was recommended that:

Delegates' expense allowance remain unchanged.

The General Service Board make use of investment income from the Reserve Fund for whatever purpose the Board may authorize.

Some consideration be given to reversing the clauses in the preamble to read as follows: "We are self-supporting through our own contributions; there are no dues or fees for A.A. membership."

The ceiling on the amount an individual can contribute to the General Service Office be increased from \$100 a year to \$200. (Floor Action)

**1968** It was recommended that:

The Regular Contribution Plan flyer be mailed again to all groups, strongly stressing that committee members, G.S.R.s, secretaries, etc., be kept well informed of any mailings such as this in order to help stimulate interest in contributing to the General Service Office.

The need for better communication between the delegates, committee members, G.S.R.'s and groups be stressed, pointing

out that better informed groups will support G.S.O. without the need of a "hard sell" from the delegate.

**1969** It was recommended that:

The proposal to change the basis for area support of the General Service Conference be approved and recommended that the Policy Committee give favorable consideration to this proposal.

The folder last issued in 1963, called "What Happens When You Put \$3.00 in the Hat," be rewritten and brought up to date.

All delegates show the G.S.O. filmstrip as often as possible, just prior to their discussion of the need for contributions and support.

The Conference look with favor on the proposal "that each Conference area contribute \$150 every year to the support of the General Service Conference" and suggested the delegates take it back to their areas for consideration. It was further suggested that this item be placed on the 1970 General Service Conference Agenda. (Policy)

**1970** It was recommended that:

Better utilization of the G.S.O. filmstrip should be made and suggested that it be distributed in slide form to make it more convenient to use.

The area committees consider a symposium of services that would include an educational program for G.S.R.'s in the workings of their groups and their relation to G.S.O. The need to employ more articulate people, especially in the role of G.S.R., is stressed.

The Birthday Plan be extended to include the birthdays of individual groups as well as of individual members.

Area and state committees supplement regular group contributions by sponsoring a Gratitude Month, with special emphasis on participation by all groups. Arrangements to be made by the committee for each group participating to receive individual credit.

The idea of a Gratitude Month be incorporated into the next money folder.

These suggestions to increase group support of General Services be included in *Box 4-5-9* in future issues.

**1971** It was recommended that:

The General Service Board's authorization to A.A.W.S. Board of Directors to increase the price on books and literature, if and when necessary be confirmed, to be reviewed by the Conference Finance Committee two years from now.

The \$3.00-per-year, per member yardstick remain as is, and a concentrated effort to involve more groups be undertaken.

The Agenda/Admissions Committee arrange to have extensive sharing sessions on the matter of increasing contributions and finances on the 1972 Conference agenda.

The delegates obtain the thinking of their areas on the uses of the Bill W. Memorial Fund and communicate their findings to the trustees for guidance.

**1972** It was recommended that:

The Group Contribution Fund be combined with the General Fund. This fund is to be utilized for all expenses of the General Service Office, including those formerly charged to both the General Fund and Group Fund, and to be known as the General Fund.



Groups be informed as to how and where they can contribute as well as why they should contribute.

Delegates explain contribution needs to their committee members and to their groups.

Our regular contribution plan be continued with particular emphasis on non-participating groups.

A finance packet or kit be sent to all committee members and area chairmen. This kit to include a package of money folders, group contribution and birthday envelopes.

The limit on individual gifts and bequests be increased from \$200 to \$300 per year.

G.S.O. should not accept contributions from clubs, listed or known as such, whether or not composed solely of A.A. members. Contributions are welcome from groups meeting in clubs as long as they are sent in the name of the group. Letter to be sent to delegates explaining this decision so that they can inform the clubs in their areas.(Floor Action)

*Bill W. Memorial Fund:* It was agreed to defer the decision on the use of the Bill W. Memorial Fund so that the delegates may discuss with their groups the suggestion of a film about A.A., historical or for public information purposes, and come back next year prepared to make a decision on this or some other suggestion. (Floor Action)

**1973** It was recommended that:

The authorization granted to A.A.W.S., Inc., by the 1971 Conference Finance Committee to raise the prices on books and literature, if necessary, be reconfirmed.

The \$3.00 per year per member yardstick be changed to \$3.65, and be emphasized as a penny a day for sobriety.

To increase group participation, i.e., contributions:

- Mailings should be aimed at the G.S.R.s, giving them more information and asking for their cooperation (copies of correspondence to G.S.R.s to be sent to all delegates).
- Delegates ask groups to contribute, no matter how little.
- G.S.O. poll all delegates, asking them to contribute ideas about methods of informing groups regarding contributing regularly in their respective areas.
- The "G.S.R. Corner" in Box 4-5-9 be reinstituted to further communications with the G.S.R.s.

The General Service Board Reserve Fund ceiling be raised from \$300,000 to \$500,000.

The money in the Bill W. Memorial Fund be transferred to the General Fund as expeditiously as possible. (Floor Action)

**1974** It was recommended that:

The "money folder," "How Far Can \$3.00 Go?" be redesigned and rewritten as follows:

- Less copy.
- Use of a pie chart with appropriate footnotes.
- Suggested titles: "A Penny a Day for Sobriety"; "Is Your Sobriety Worth a Penny?"
- The section on "How to Contribute" to remain intact.
- Inclusion of a section on how groups might distribute their contributions after group expenses are paid: that is, 60%, 30%, 10%, divided between central office or intergroup, G.S.O., and the area committee.

There be better utilization of the slogan "A Penny a Day for Sobriety," maybe a brochure itemizing how little \$3.65 will buy today.

The current "Regular Contribution" flyer be updated, adding a footnote, "If you have any other questions, see your G.S.R."

The new flyer be sent in a mailing to groups.

G.S.O. prepare a guideline for delegates on how to approach committee members and G.S.R.s on the subject of financing, i.e., how one area tackled the problem.

There be a broader use and explanation of the In Memoriam contribution envelopes.

Delegates emphasize that the cost of G.S.O.'s service to the Fellowship is not covered by contributions from the Fellowship; the deficit has to be made up by A.A.W.S.

The area contribution toward the General Service Conference expenses be raised from \$150 to \$200.

**1975** It was recommended that:

Delegates, in reports to their areas, place more emphasis on broadening the base of group support because the committee felt that the dependence on literature income could become detrimental to the Fellowship structure.

The 60-30-10 suggested group contribution formula be used, where applicable and practicable, as well as the \$3.65 per year per member plan; and that the 60-30-10 Plan should be encouraged by G.S.O. and all delegates:(60% to the intergroup/central office), 30% to G.S.O., 10% to the area committee.

The recommended \$10 maximum on birthday contributions be eliminated from the birthday envelope.

Delegates emphasize to the groups the effect that inflation has had on the contribution dollar and the necessity for adjusting contributions accordingly.

A set of quarterly contribution statements be mailed to all delegates for their areas on a twice yearly basis rather than once a year, as is now the practice. These statements are to cover the six-month period ending June 30, and the 12-month period ending December 31.

Contributions continue to be listed in the A.A. directories, and the contributions from the previous calendar year be used.

Upon reviewing the G.S.O. salary structure, it was considered to be sound. This information is available to delegates upon request.

**1976** It was recommended that:

The Finance Committee of the General Service Board examine and restate the meaning of a "prudent reserve" as it relates to the G.S.O. structure, for possible consideration at a future Conference.

The General Service Board and A.A. World Services Board of Directors consider reducing the net income from the sale of literature by appropriate means, such as:

- Special consideration given to a substantial reduction in the price of the Big Book
- Liberalizing the discount structure
- Distribution of gratis or low-cost literature to public information committees, institutional committees, or new groups

Delegates should emphasize that the preceding recommendation was made in anticipation of increased group participa-



tion, and that further efforts to control literature costs to the Fellowship, the Conference structure, and A.A. unity depend upon a solid base of group support.

**1977** It was recommended that:

A prudent reserve be established equal to the preceding year's operating expense of the combined expenses of the General Service Board of A.A., A.A. World Services, Inc., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. (with the exception of extraordinary expenses); and that the auditing firm be requested to review and comment annually on the availability, feasibility, and adequacy of this reserve.

After review of the board's proposal to return discounts donated to the group, the cost of the employees' retirement plan be charged to general operating expenses, and that the selling price of books be reduced by those amounts previously used for the retirement plan.

A suggested prudent reserve for a group be dependent on local needs; and that a suggested prudent reserve for central offices, intergroups, and area committees preferably be one to twelve months' operating expense, depending on local needs.

Group contributions continue to be listed in A.A. Directories. (Floor Action)

**1978** It was recommended that:

A new pamphlet on finance, in at least two colors, be prepared and distributed to stress:

- a. Self-support through the 60-30-10 Plan
- b. How the 60-30-10 plan helps carry the A.A. message around the world.

The title of the pamphlet be "Self Supporting? The 60-30-10 Plan."

G.S.O. prepare and distribute a chart illustrating how money flows through the G.S.O. finance structure.

Group treasurers continue to be reached through the G.S.R.s and through the local service level; and further that contributions be acknowledged, as received, to group treasurers or to whoever the sender may be.

The delegate area contribution to Conference expense be increased from \$200 to \$300.

**1979** It was recommended that:

In line with the principle of broadening the base of group support, emphasis should continue to be placed on group contributions. However, it was further recommended that:

- a. The limit on individual contributions should be increased from \$300 to \$500 to compensate for the inflationary factor since the last increase.
- b. Bequests should be subject to the same limit as on individual contributions and be on a one-time-only basis and not in perpetuity.

**1980** It was recommended that:

The discontinuance of mailing contribution statements to Quebec, requested by Quebec delegates, be referred back to the 1981 Conference Committee on Finance for further study and consideration.

The Grapevine Corporate Board consider advising the Canadian subscribers that, when possible, U.S. funds should be used when purchasing a subscription.

**1981** It was recommended that:

All future events, such as the International Convention, not be planned to operate on a deficit basis, and it was also recommended that all future events of this type be self-supporting.

The word "suggested" be added to the title of the 60-30-10 Plan folder, and that the words "where applicable and practicable" be added to the copy of panel 3 of the folder.

The graphics of the 60-30-10 Plan folder should indicate that the 60-30-10 formula is flexible and subject to local autonomy, and that the copy give illustrations reflecting the flexibility to meet local needs (for example, the needs of a D.C.M. for travel expenses). It should also give special emphasis to the Regular Contribution Plan.

Because it was felt that the increasing trend of A.A. financial dependence on publishing income was diminishing the Fellowship's traditional support by group contributions, in delegates' reports to their areas, emphasis should be placed on the basic spiritual need for self-support by communicating to their areas, districts, and groups the need to broaden the base of group support.

Contribution statements to groups in Quebec continue to be sent along with a letter written in both French and English thanking those groups that had contributed directly to their district or area, which, in turn, sent its surplus to G.S.O. The letter is to be generated by lists of contributing groups supplied by the delegates from each of the four Quebec areas. The letter will acknowledge the actual amount received by G.S.O. during a designated period.

Item 3 of the ad hoc committee recommendations of February 3, 1978, which reads as follows, be deleted:

Income earned on that portion of the Reserve Fund attributable to the deferred subscription income will be retained by the General Service Board Reserve Fund as long as the Grapevine has income from operation. In the event of an operating deficit, such income would be credited automatically to the Grapevine to the extent of its deficiency or the limit of such income.

The following paragraph be substituted:

All income earned on that portion of the Reserve Fund attributable to the deferred subscriptions be credited to the Grapevine and reflected on the Grapevine financial statement. The contra amount of the increase in income will be added to the asset account of the General Service Board Reserve Fund.

The reporting and crediting of interest earned on Grapevine unexpired subscription income as originally recommended by the ad hoc committee report of February 3, 1978, be maintained.

Clubs not receive the literature discount available to A.A. groups. (Floor Action)

**1982** It was recommended that:

The following actions be taken in connection with the 60-30-10 pamphlet:

- a. A new concept for the pamphlet to replace the 60-30-10 piece be considered.
- b. All 1981 Advisory Actions, with the exception of the action requesting specific graphics, be incorporated into the new piece; also, emphasis on the Seventh Tradition and how it relates to the individual member be included.



- c. The General Service Office develop the necessary copy and title to further present the need for supporting the A.A. support system.

The Regular Contribution Plan be used to supplement the 60-30-10 Plan.

**1983** It was recommended that:

An earlier treatment of illustrating the Regular Contribution Plan in cartoon fashion be revised and reissued to supplement the pamphlet titled "Supporting the A.A. Support System," with the 1967 A.A. Grapevine article titled "A.A.'s Tradition of Self-Support," written by Bill, printed on the reverse of the flyer. Further, this flyer is to be produced in the English, Spanish, and French languages and distributed simultaneously.

The need to decrease dependence on publishing income and the needs for greater participation and increased contributions from the groups to accomplish this goal be simplified conceptually in graphic form.

In keeping with our Seventh Tradition at the group, area, and G.S.O. level, the Conference stress the importance and necessity of discussing self-support at area and local workshops.

**1984** It was recommended that:

Area contributions toward Conference expenses be increased from \$300 to \$400 effective with the 1985 Conference.

Copies of contribution statements sent to the groups be continued to be sent to all delegates on a twice-a-year basis as of June 30 and December 31, with only a list to be sent on the off quarters.

A change be made in the pamphlet titled "Supporting the A.A. Support System" as follows. Where it now reads, "Bequests in wills: acceptable only from A.A.s and only in the year of the A.A.'s death. The limit is \$500." To read, "Bequests in wills: acceptable only from A.A.s and only on a one-time basis and not in perpetuity. The limit is \$500." This change to be made in the next printing.

The past Advisory Action relating to the need for greater participation and increased contributions from groups, to reduce dependence on publishing income, be supplemented with an explanation aimed at the individual A.A. members regarding what happens to their individual contribution, at the group level, and how it helps carry the message worldwide.

**1985** It was recommended that:

A guideline on finances be developed by the General Service Office.

A cartoon treatment be approved illustrating need for greater group participation and how the individual contributions at the group level help carry the message worldwide.

**1986** It was recommended that:

The finance cartoon flyer be changed in the third panel to list: group expenses, district expenses, intergroup or central office, area committee and General Service Office, eliminating prudent reserve, numerals one to five, and the words "part of the remainder to" and "part to"; and that the second panel be changed to eliminate the numeral five and the words "part to."

The area delegates strongly consider implementation of the following suggestions to improve contributions to G.S.O., area assemblies, districts, and central or intergroup offices:

- a. G.S.O. make available to all delegates an itemized list of group service expenses and other expenses of the board,

combined into one total, representing group services supported by group contributions.

- b. Area delegates contact groups quarterly, either directly or through the D.C.M., distributing self-support pamphlets and contribution statements.
- c. The delegates encourage each group to have a folder which includes a list of addresses to whom monthly contributions could be sent (District, Intergroup/Central Offices, Area Committees and G.S.O.).
- d. Each area affix a list of addresses or stamp addresses on finance flyers and distribute to groups to provide them with the information on "where to send their money."
- e. Areas could provide groups with pre-addressed envelopes as to where they should contribute to the area treasury.

A film on finance is premature (until the Guidelines on Finance are introduced.)

Because of the many facets, the proposal to have G.S.O. self-supporting through group contributions only not be considered at this time, especially in light of the continuing decrease in the percentage of groups contributing to G.S.O.

The limit contributed from individual A.A. members be increased from \$500 to \$1,000 and bequests from A.A. members should be subject to the same limit and be on a one-time-only basis and not in perpetuity.

The following changes be made to "Supporting the A.A. Support System" flyer:

- a. The example which includes "district" be made the first illustration in the flyer, reflecting 50% to inter-group/central office, 30% to G.S.O., 10% to area and 10% to district.
- b. The present 60-30-10 Plan illustration will move to a secondary position.

**1987** It was recommended that:

The "Supporting the A.A. Support System" pamphlet be revised as follows:

- a. On the first page, change the type style for "group expenses" to bold face.
- b. On the fourth page (the last illustration and description), change the current "40% to G.S.O." and "60% to Area Committee" to "30% to G.S.O., 30% to Area Committee, 40% to District."

The concept of the Self-support communications plan be approved; the plan is to provide Self-support information and tools to D.C.M.s and other service people in the Fellowship.

The objectives of the five-year plan be approved and reviewed monthly; the plan projects increased contributions and periodic literature price decrease, which would make A.A. self-supporting in five years or less.

No change in delegates' fees be made at this time, but that this matter be considered again by the 1988 Conference.

The Conference Committee on Finance reviewed the auditor's report on the General Service Reserve Fund which states, in his opinion, "that the balance of Reserve Fund at December 31, 1986, is adequate to meet any adverse events which can be foreseen at the present time."

The Committee recommends the acceptance of the auditor's opinion that the Reserve Fund is adequate at this time.



The 1977 Conference Advisory Action which reads:

"It was recommended that a prudent reserve be established equal to the preceding year's operating expense of the combined expenses of the General Service Board of A.A., A.A. World Services, Inc., and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. (with the exception of extraordinary expenses); and that the auditing firm be requested to review and comment annually on the availability, feasibility, and adequacy of this reserve" be amended to replace the phrase "equal to" with the phrase "not to exceed."

And that a lower limit to the fund not be provided, inasmuch as the auditor is required to comment on the adequacy of the fund.

**1988** It was recommended that:

No change in delegates' fees be made at this time.

The list of possible demands on the Reserve Fund as presented by the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee be made available as a service piece and this list be attached to the finance presentation and made available to the current members of the Conference.

The trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee's proposal for handling possible excesses in the Reserve Fund be approved. The proposal would use literature price reductions as the primary mechanism in adjusting the relationship of the Reserve Fund to the Conference-approved limit of one year's operating expenses.

The statement of clarification recommended by the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee be approved. The statement says that when the auditor comments in his annual financial statements on the availability, feasibility and adequacy of the Reserve Fund, he is measuring the Reserve Fund as of the calendar year just ended, including transfers from such year's income of the operating entities, against the operating expenses of the consolidated entities (A.A. World Service, Inc., General Service Board of A.A., Inc., and the Grapevine, Inc.), for the same year then ended.

Subject to editorial review, the Self-support Committee's suggested revisions to the "Supporting the A.A. Support System" pamphlet be approved with the provision that:

- titles be indicated for the addresses of Districts, Intergroups/Central Offices, Area Committees, and G.S.O.
- a list of services provided to the Fellowship be included under the "Why" section.
- the message of the last panel of the cartoon supplement be incorporated.

The committee see the draft reflecting these recommendations.

The cartoon supplement of the pamphlet "Supporting the A.A. Support System" be discontinued immediately.

The 1988 financial reports be presented as a management report to the Conference, based on broad-based allocations. The committee acknowledges that the more detailed computerized general ledger system will provide more accurate allocation when available.

**1989** It was recommended that:

The need to send complete audited financial statements to each delegate as soon as they are available has not been demonstrated, but that they will be made available upon request. (Available about April 1st, each year.)

Three-part printouts, which are seen as a better working tool for delegates and D.C.M.s, be sent to the delegates every quarter instead of alternating copies of the contribution quarterly statements and quarterly contribution printouts.

Area contributions for delegate expenses for the Conference be increased to \$600 and that, in the spirit of the Seventh Tradition, areas continue to be encouraged to make contributions over and above this requested amount to help cover a greater portion of the Conference costs.

The Conference strongly reaffirms the 1986 Conference Advisory Action on self-support which reads:

"That the area delegates strongly consider implementation of the following suggestions to improve contributions to G.S.O., area assemblies, districts, and central or intergroup offices:

- G.S.O. make available to all delegates an itemized list of group service expenses and other expenses of the board, combined into one total, representing groups services supported by group contributions. (Now a part of the financial statements in the Final Conference Report.)
- Area delegates contact groups quarterly, either directly or through the D.C.M., distributing self-support pamphlets and contribution statements.
- The delegates encourage each group to have a folder which includes a list of addresses to whom monthly contributions could be sent (district, intergroup/central offices, area committees and G.S.O.).
- Each area affix a list of addresses or stamp addresses on finance flyers and distribute to groups to provide them with the information on 'where to send their money.'
- Areas could provide groups with preaddressed envelopes as to where they should contribute to the area treasury."

No change be made in the current literature pricing policy after considering a proposal to change the G.S.O. literature pricing from the existing procedure to one fixed price for everyone, including purchasers who buy in bulk.

The self-support pamphlet reflect the idea that the support of A.A. services (central/intergroup offices, area committee, G.S.O., and district) be a *commitment* by the individual member through his or her home group.

The commitment to the Seventh Tradition on the part of individuals through their home group be emphasized where applicable in other A.A. literature as it comes up for revision.

**1990** It was recommended that:

No change be made to the newly revised pamphlet, "Self-supporting Through Our Own Contributions," which emphasizes the commitment on the part of the individual A.A. member; and any relationship to intergroups be left to the Conference, and the results of such actions then be reflected in the Self-support pamphlet.

There be a reaffirmation of the 1977 Conference Advisory Action which reads: "A suggested prudent reserve for a group be dependent on local needs; and that a suggested prudent reserve for central offices, intergroups, and area committees preferably be one to twelve months' operating expense, depending on local needs."

**1991** It was recommended that:

The format of the Finances presentation of the financial information at the General Service Conference be reviewed and that any revisions or changes be considered and forwarded to



Conference Finance Committee members prior to the end of the year.

The pamphlet “Self-supporting Through Our Own Contributions” not be changed at this time, as there was insufficient input; and that there be further input from the areas prior to any action.

The adaptation of the “Self-supporting Through Our Own Contributions” pamphlet tailored to reflect the Quebec area’s self-support system not receive Conference approval, because there is already existing Conference-approved literature dealing with the subject.

**1992** It was recommended that:

The new computer-monitored Happy Birthday Contribution Plan instituted in 1991 be discontinued immediately and that any database of A.A. members’ names and addresses, together with sobriety birthday dates, that may have been created be destroyed.

The financial statements presented to the Fellowship do not show allocation of expenses between various funds and entities until the basis of such allocations can be justified.

The term “Shortfall of group services supported by group contributions” not be used until the basis of allocations resulting in the amount shown as shortfall can be justified.

The request that contributions to the General Service Office from conferences, conventions, and roundups be limited to the maximum amount an individual may contribute in a given year be forwarded to the 1993 Conference Finance Committee, as there was insufficient information, and that there be input from the areas prior to any action.

The general manager of the General Service Office and the Alcoholics Anonymous World Services Board devise an equitable system of pay for the G.S.O. staff that embraces the spiritual principles of Concept XI and complies with all applicable laws. (Floor Action)

**1993** It was recommended that:

Contributions from conferences, conventions, and roundups not be limited to the maximum amount an individual may contribute in a given year, and in accordance with our Seventh Tradition, only funds from A.A. members attending the event should be contributed to support A.A. services.

In light of declining contributions, a new self-support pamphlet be prepared deleting the charts and percentages, stressing the spirit of the Seventh Tradition, Bill’s vision of self-support, a brief history of A.A. finances, the G.S.R.’s responsibility concerning the financial needs within the service structure, visual aids and description of the various services provided throughout the structure. It is requested that a draft be sent to the 1993 Conference Finance Committee following the October 1993 trustees’ Finance Committee meeting, and brought back to the 1994 Conference Finance Committee meeting for approval.

No change be made at this time to delegate fees, but in the spirit of self-support, areas are encouraged to make a contribution, if possible, to defray the average cost per delegate. This statement should be incorporated in the annual Conference notification to delegates of fees due.

**1994** It was recommended that:

The first draft of the new Self-Support pamphlet not be approved and that the trustees’ Finance Committee work with the Publishing Department to develop several (3-5, estimated

total cost \$3,000 to \$5,000) comprehensive layouts including the long form of the Seventh Tradition, and definition of Prudent Reserve, keeping in mind that all service entities are equally important. It is requested that these layouts be brought to the 1995 Conference Finance Committee for review.

We not form an ad-hoc committee to relocate G.S.O. out of New York, because it is not financially prudent, and such a project is not needed at the present time.

The definition of the Prudent Reserve not be changed. The committee recognized that the new presentation of the financial statements excluding shipping and warehousing from operating expenses has effectively reduced the limit of the Reserve Fund by approximately \$800,000.

We adopt or continue use of the Birthday Plan to provide “supplementary” support of A.A.’s World Services.

Instead of the three-part green bar forms that are sent out on a quarterly basis, a simple 8 1/2 x 11 page listing district, group service number, group name, group city, date of last contribution, and contributions to date be used.

**1995** It was recommended that:

The draft of the pamphlet, “Self-Support Where Money and Spirituality Mix,” which satisfies the 1993 and 1994 Conference Advisory Actions (to prepare a new self-support pamphlet stressing the spirit of the Seventh Tradition, Bill’s vision of self-support, a brief history of A.A. finances, the G.S.R.’s responsibility concerning the financial needs within the service structure, visual aids and a description of the various services provided throughout the structure, the long form of the Seventh Tradition and a definition of Prudent Reserve), be accepted with editorial changes placing emphasis on the informed group conscience and, on page 13, for contributions to A.A. service entities contact your district committee, area committee, local intergroup/central office.

A heading, “Suggested Plans For Group Contributions Toward All A.A. Services,” be included on page 14 (currently blank) of the draft, “Self-Support where Money and Spirituality Mix.” The following five suggested contribution plans that would appear on page 14 (currently blank) will utilize pie charts and percentages to depict examples of contributions to various A.A. service entities to help arrive at a group conscience:

**Example #1:**

15% to district  
15% to area committee  
30% to G.S.O.  
40% to intergroup/central office  
Or

**Example #2:**

20% to area committee  
30% to G.S.O.  
50% to intergroup/central office  
Or

**Example #3:**

25% to district  
25% to area committee  
25% to G.S.O.  
25% to intergroup/central office

If you have no intergroup/central office, suggested contributions might be:

**Example #4:**

50% to area committee

50% to G.S.O.

Or

**Example #5:**

40% to district

30% to area committee

30% to G.S.O.

Or

Whatever percentages are in accordance  
with your group conscience.

In addition, the Conference Finance Committee requests that each delegate advise G.S.O. on how funds are allocated by the groups in their area and return input to the 1996 Conference Finance Committee.

**1996** It was recommended that:

The pamphlet "Self-Support Where Money and Spirituality Mix" be revised to include only two pie charts, as follows:

Under the heading:

"Examples of Group Contributions to A.A. Service Entities"

"Distribution of funds from groups that support four service entities"

|                           |     |
|---------------------------|-----|
| District                  | 10% |
| Area                      | 10% |
| G.S.O.                    | 30% |
| Intergroup/Central Office | 50% |

AND

"If you have no intergroup/central office, distribution of funds from groups that support three service entities"

|          |     |
|----------|-----|
| District | 40% |
| Area     | 30% |
| G.S.O.   | 30% |

Also, information be added adjacent to the pie charts under a new heading, "After group expenses, what is your informed group conscience for distribution of excess funds?" which includes space for the group name, group service number, and the percentage the group wishes to contribute to each entity. (Page 16 in the current pamphlet is suggested).

AN EXAMPLE IS AS FOLLOWS:

Distribution Plan of \_\_\_\_\_  
(YOUR GROUP NAME)

YOUR GROUP SERVICE # \_\_\_\_\_

|                           |         |
|---------------------------|---------|
| District                  | _____ % |
| Area                      | _____ % |
| G.S.O.                    | _____ % |
| Intergroup/Central Office | _____ % |
| Other                     | _____ % |
| Other                     | _____ % |

And further, space be provided for the group to list addresses of the various entities to which it wishes to contribute, along with G.S.O.'s address. (Page 18 of the current pamphlet is suggested)

In order to allow for a smoother and more understandable flow of the process that financially supports the Grapevine, begin-

ning with fiscal year 1996, the interest income earned from the unfilled subscription investment with the General Service Board Reserve Fund, after adjustment to ensure that the liability is appropriately funded, be transferred to the Grapevine's operating cash on an annual basis.

**1997** It was recommended that:

The phrase "Any suggested prudent reserve for a group should be dependent on local needs. A suggested prudent reserve for central offices, intergroups, and area committees could be one to twelve months' operating expenses, depending on local needs" be substituted for: "At the group level, this usually means approximately two months' worth of group expenses which can be used to help the group through any unforeseen circumstances. Districts, areas and central offices/intergroups also maintain some percentage of their operating expenses in a prudent reserve fund" as the definition of a prudent reserve in the current Self-Support pamphlet. This would appear on page 9 of the September '96 printing of F-3.

The area contributions for delegates' expenses for the Conference be increased from \$600 (U.S.) to \$800 (U.S.) and that, in the spirit of the Seventh Tradition, areas continue to be encouraged to make contributions over and above this requested amount to help cover a greater portion of the Conference costs.

**1999** It was recommended that:

The annual limit contributed to the General Service Office from individual A.A. members be increased from \$1,000 to \$2,000 and that bequests from A.A. members should be subject to the same limit and be on a one-time-only basis and not in perpetuity.

The General Service Conference supports the General Service Board policy which states: "Whenever a discount or subsidy is that which would be offered to any other organization of similar size requiring a purchased service or product of similar character and magnitude, i.e., convention rates at hotels, it may be accepted. Whenever a discount or subsidy is partly or in total offered because we are Alcoholics Anonymous, it must be declined."

**2001** It was recommended that:

If the Reserve Fund exceeds the 12-month upper limit we allow a one-year period to review the Reserve Fund level, followed by a second year to formulate actions to adjust Reserve Fund below 12 months' operating expenses.

**2005** It was recommended that:

In the interest of self-support, area contributions for delegates' expenses be increased from \$800 to \$1,200 effective with the 2006 Conference and that areas continue to be encouraged to make contributions over and above this requested amount to help cover a greater portion of the Conference costs.

**Note:** The last increase was in 1997 from \$600 to \$800 at which time the requested area contribution covered approximately 26% of the direct costs. By 2004, the percentage has fallen to 17% and this increase will result in approximately 26% of the direct costs being covered.

**2006** It was recommended that:

The word "donation" be replaced with the word "contribution" in A.A.W.S. literature as it comes up for reprint.

The following be added to the end of the Q & A section of the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix":

Q. Does A.A. have any specific information for our group or group treasurer about how to handle our group's finances?



- A. Yes. There are two excellent publications available from G.S.O., A.A. Guidelines on Finance and the pamphlet "The A.A. Group Treasurer," that provide specific information to groups regarding practical matters related to their group finances, such as setting up bank accounts, obtaining tax ID numbers, and outlining the responsibilities of a group treasurer.

**2007** It was recommended that:

The annual limit contributed to the General Service Board from individual A.A. members be increased from \$2,000 to \$3,000 and that bequests from A.A. members should be subject to the same limit and continue to be on a one-time basis and not in perpetuity.

The following text: "G.S.R. travel expenses to attend service functions" be added to the sentence "Once the basic group expenses have been taken care of (rent, refreshments, A.A. literature, local meeting lists)" on page 7, paragraph 3, first sentence of the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix" (F-3) as these expenses are suggested in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

**2008** It was recommended that:

The trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee gather input from the Fellowship on the benefits and liabilities, both spiritual and practical of fully funding G.S.O. services to the Fellowship (G.S.O. functional expenses) by the voluntary contributions of A.A. members and groups and that this information be forwarded to the 2009 Conference Committee on Finance.

**2009** It was recommended that:

The trustees' Finance Committee gather input from the Fellowship on the following for review by the 2010 Conference Committee on Finance:

- If we continue to use literature profits to partially fund services, should there be a limit?
- If there is a limit how do we continue to pay for services if there is a shortfall in contributions?

(The committee requests that the statement of policy "Self-Support of the World Services of Alcoholics Anonymous" be distributed as background.)

A discussion of additional ways to communicate with the Fellowship about Self-Support be included on the agenda for the Conference Finance Committee for the 60th General Service Conference.

**2010** It was recommended that:

The following be added to the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix" where appropriate:

- Can our group make financial contributions to A.A. Grapevine?
- No. A.A. Grapevine Inc. is not set up to take contributions from groups or individuals. Groups and individual A.A. members support the Grapevine by purchasing Grapevine and La Viña magazine subscriptions and other Grapevine publications and using them in their Twelfth Step work.

In the second paragraph on page 7 under the heading "How can groups participate?" in the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix"; the second sentence "(rent, refreshments, A.A. literature,...)" be changed to read "(for example: rent, refreshments, A.A. and A.A. Grapevine literature,...)"

The trustees' Finance Committee gather personal stories drawn from the Fellowship that humanize the impact of Seventh Tradition monies for the purpose of communicating with the Fellowship about Self-Support in new or existing literature.

The request to replace the existing pie charts on page 12 of the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money & Spirituality Mix" be recommitted to the trustees' Finance Committee and report back to the 2011 Conference Committee on Finance. (Floor Action)

**2011** It was recommended that:

The following changes be made to the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix:"

- "AND" be replaced with "OR" between the pie charts that start on page 12 and an additional "OR" added after the second pie chart.
- Insert an additional blank pie chart and distribution text as follows to the beginning of the pie chart examples:

|                                                                                    |                             |         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|---------|
|  | District                    | _____ % |
|                                                                                    | Area Committee              | _____ % |
|                                                                                    | G.S.O.                      | _____ % |
|                                                                                    | Intergroup/Central Office   | _____ % |
|                                                                                    | Other A.A. Service Entities | _____ % |
|                                                                                    | Other A.A. Service Entities | _____ % |

- Other minor editorial changes.

**2012** It was recommended that:

The annual delegate's contribution be increased from \$1,200 to \$1,600.

The limit on one-time bequests from A.A. members to the General Service Board be increased from \$3,000 to \$5,000. (Floor Action)

**2014** It was recommended that:

Because all Conference members are considered equal, all members should have equal access to Conference material and that a plan be created by the General Service Office to translate Conference material (background material, Conference Manual, etc.) into French and Spanish for use during the Conference, with a report being presented to the 2015 General Service Conference. This plan may include coordinating the use of the volunteer network throughout the Fellowship, hiring professional translators or any other facilities that the office deems necessary. The report should include costs and any other considerations deemed necessary to allow timely translations to occur.

**2015** It was recommended that:

Phase 1 of the G.S.O. proposed plan (February 5, 2015) to translate pre-Conference and Conference material into Spanish and French be implemented beginning with the 2016, 66th General Service Conference.

At minimum the following items will be included:

- Welcome correspondence to new panel delegates
  - » Letter
  - » Memo to a Delegate from a Delegate, The Role of the Delegate
- Communications Kit (71 pages total)
- Committee Material:
  - » Agenda 1-3 pages per committee



- » Composition, Scope and Procedures for 13 committees (17 pages total)
- » History and Actions of 13 committees (484 pages total)
- Pre-Conference documents
  - » Board reports (G.S.B., A.A.W.S., A.A. Grapevine)
  - » Trustee committee reports
- Conference Kit

This initial phase of translations would be coordinated by G.S.O. departments, including staff and Publishing department personnel. Costs currently estimated by G.S.O. for the initial phase would be included in the G.S.O./A.A.W.S. budget at approximately \$80-120,000 for the year. Actual cost may be higher or lower upon receiving competitive bids.

The trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference create a plan to translate all Conference material with a progress report given to the 2016 Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions that describes the process and costs, including options using third party translators and a proposal to change agenda submission deadlines.

**2016** It was recommended that:

General Service Conference delegates be provided a copy of the final approved annual General Service Office and A.A. Grapevine budgets with the pre-Conference material for all future Conferences. (Floor Action)

**2017** It was recommended that:

The suggested area contribution for delegate expense for the Conference be increased from \$1,600 to \$1,800.

Review of the suggested Area contribution for delegates' expenses to the Conference be every other year. The next review will take place in 2019.

Review of the Conference-approved level for bequests to the General Service Board from A.A. members be every other year. The next review will take place in 2019.

Review of the Conference-approved maximum annual contribution to the General Service Board from an individual A.A. member be every other year. The next review will take place in 2019.

The following text be added to the pamphlet:

"Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix":  
 "Question: Can an individual or group make a recurring online contribution? Answer: Yes, online at aa.org."

**2018** It was recommended that:

The Conference-approved maximum annual contribution from an individual A.A. member to the General Service Board be increased from \$3,000 to \$5,000.

**2019** It was recommended that:

The level of \$5,000 for individual bequests to the General Service Board from A.A. members be raised to \$10,000.

**2020** It was recommended that:

The draft language related to the "virtual basket" be included in the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix." The language reads:

Q. Some members of our group wanted to pass a "virtual" basket — to collect Seventh Tradition contributions digitally. How could we do this?

A. A number of groups have utilized digital payment platforms as an adjunct to passing the basket in the conventional sense in order to provide opportunities for cashless contributions. There are different payment platforms to facilitate this service and it is up to the group to determine which one to use. Some groups have found that a smart-phone app-based payment platform is the most efficient, seamless, and minimally disruptive solution for providing a digital contribution. Experience suggests that the treasurer is a likely choice to handle digital contributions, though some groups add more than one trusted servant to share the responsibilities or create a new service position to inform the group about digital payment options and assist other group members who are interested in contributing this way.

**2021** It was recommended that:

A watermark with the word "SAMPLE" be added to the 2nd and 3rd pie charts on page 13 of the pamphlet, "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix."

The following language to the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix" be revised:

On page 7 after the bulleted section entitled "A.A.'s General Service Office":

Please note that not all areas, districts, intergroups and central offices follow these divisions of service for institutions work, cooperation with the professional community, public information, etc. Therefore, prior to making contributions in your area, please find out which entity is providing these services and allocate your contributions accordingly.

On page 13 after the pie chart examples and before the question, "Where should I send contributions?":

Duties of the entities notated above are described on page 7 of this pamphlet. Performance of these service duties vary from area to area. Please be sure to inquire which services these entities provide in YOUR area and contribute accordingly.

**2023** It was recommended that:

- The materials produced and maintained by A.A. World Services, AA Grapevine, La Viña, and the General Service Office (GSO), clarify that the General Service Board is the entity which receives all voluntary A.A. contributions and that GSO performs contribution processing. Any text changes should be implemented when each item comes up for reprint or revision.
- The suggested area contribution for delegate expense for the Conference be increased from \$1,800 to \$2,200.
- The Trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee develop additional ways to report quarterly the fiscal performance of the AAWS, GSB and GV Boards throughout the year to the members of the General Service Conference for the purposes of transparency and assisting in the reporting to the A.A. Fellowship

**2024** It was recommended that:

- The following change to the language in the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix" be implemented: At the bottom of page 9 where it currently reads:  
 Q. Who manages GSO's share of your group contributions?



- A. The General Service Board's Finance Committee meets quarterly to review and approve GSO's budget and the audited financial accounts.

The A.A. World Services Board meets monthly and maintains direct control of income and expenditures. The annual General Service Conference reviews A.A.'s finances through its own Finance Committee. A.A.'s financial affairs are an "open" book. A summary is published in each Quarterly Report and a full accounting is in the Final Conference Report. The account books themselves are available at the General Service Office for scrutiny at any time.

Be revised, to read:

Q. Who manages GSB's share of your group contributions?

A. The General Service Board's Finance Committee meets quarterly to review and approve the financial reports of the General Service Board, inc., A.A. World Services, Inc., and AA Grapevine, Inc. In addition, the committee reviews and approves the budgets two times per year.

- The A.A. World Services Board meets regularly and maintains direct control of income and expenditures. The annual General Service Conference reviews A.A.'s finances through its own Finance Committee. A.A.'s financial affairs are an "open" book. A summary is published in each Quarterly Report and a full accounting is in the Final Conference Report. These reports are available at [www.aa.org](http://www.aa.org) and at the General Service Office for review at any time.
- \*Suggested changes highlighted in black.
- The maximum annual contribution from an individual A.A. member to the General Service Board be increased from \$5,000 to \$7,500.

**2025** It was recommended that:

- The phrase "A group may also decline to hear reports from a GSR at all" be removed from page 10 of *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- The Conference-approved level of \$10,000 for individual bequests to the General Service Board from A.A. members be raised to \$12,500.
- The General Service Board Quarterly Financial Report include supplemental reporting on current capital projects and current and estimated maintenance costs.



## Advisory Actions Relevant to the Conference Committee on Grapevine and La Viña

### 1951

It is suggested to the Board of Directors of the Grapevine that some mild form of promotion for an increase in circulation be adopted. An illustration might be the distribution of a post-age-free envelope in a distinctive color to provide for an initial trial subscription at a cost of \$1. for four months. (Advisory Committee on the Budget)

It is suggested that on October 1, 1951, the financial results of the operations of the Grapevine to that date be reviewed. If there is no considerable improvement, an increase in price is recommended to avoid further impairment of the Alcoholic Foundation reserve fund. (Advisory Committee on the Budget)

### 1952

The Conference, in a special resolution, affirmed its support of the traditional "Grapevine" policy of carrying news of non-A.A. happenings when they relate to the interests of A.A. readers, directly or indirectly. (Floor Action)

### 1954

Following the adoption by the Conference of a resolution suggesting some affirmative action with respect to the Grapevine, a Grapevine Committee was selected to meet during the Conference. The committee felt that emphasis should be placed on the value of the Grapevine in carrying the message of recovery and the following further resolution was presented:

1. That the delegates on their return, incorporate in their report on the Conference, the suggestion that each group appoint a Grapevine reporter who will be responsible for subscription and bulk orders, and who will encourage members to submit articles and stories;
2. That each delegate contact those groups in his area which do not have the Grapevine available at meetings and draw their attention to the importance and advantages of obtaining copies for the group either through monthly or yearly bulk orders; and
3. That delegates emphasize the value of the Grapevine to the individual member.

### 1955

It was suggested that the Grapevine send out free sample copies of the issue carrying Convention news (August) to the groups that do not take bulk orders; the copies to be accompanied by a covering letter encouraging subscriptions.

The Committee heartily endorsed the appointment of a Grapevine representative at the group level as a method of getting the Grapevine into the hands of the members.

### 1956

It is suggested that a plan along the lines outlined in "The New Jersey Story" be inaugurated, with the goal of carrying the message to 5,000 new readers.

It is recommended that delegates also make an attempt to search out contributors and encourage the submission of manuscripts, in order to arouse wider participation in the Grapevine.

Asked that quarterly financial and circulation reports of the Grapevine be made available to Delegates. (Floor Action)

### 1957

The committee wholeheartedly endorsed the decision to increase the price of the magazine from \$.25 to \$.35 for single copies, and from \$2.50 to \$3.50 for yearly domestic subscriptions, with proportionate increases in foreign sales prices, as a necessity for the financial survival of the Grapevine.

**1958** It was recommended that:

Occasional use of 48 pages when feasible and necessary in the judgment of the Grapevine Board of Directors is permissible.

A middle-of-the-road plan of circulation stimulation be followed with the Delegate and his respective committees carrying the major portion of the effort.

The three-fold card for individuals be used in a test area with Delegates and their Committees also participating. Delegates will be supplied with the above forms in time to incorporate same with their area reports.

Heavy intensive promotions be opposed, but some form of continuous "reminders" be used as needed and at the discretion of the Grapevine Board of Directors.

While it is realized that articles for sale should pay their own way, it be recognized that under present conditions this may not be possible in the case of the Grapevine for some time.

The \$10,000 previously authorized by the trustees, which to date has not been used, be maintained as a reserve fund for emergency purposes.

**1959** It was recommended that:

The emphasis in all circulation-building efforts be directed toward stressing an increased awareness of A.A. Grapevine as a vital service tool for the use of individuals and groups.

The continuity of this "awareness" of the Grapevine be insured by initiating a plan at the state and area level, whereby a permanent area Grapevine representative be appointed to work independently of the general service representative, stressing the Grapevine as a special tool of communication within A.A.

All promotion suggestions made by the delegates in the Conference Grapevine session be incorporated into a special report to be sent to all delegates, committeemen and area representatives as additional suggestions of useful ways of spreading the A.A. Grapevine message.

State and area conferences be encouraged to have a local Grapevine representative in attendance at conferences or conventions to encourage subscriptions by individuals and groups.



The Grapevine office prepare, as soon as possible, materials to be made available for these Conference representatives with a suggested method of displaying them at the meetings.

The recommendation of the Study Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies for a brief folder on *cooperation* but *not affiliation* with outside agencies be handled as a Grapevine article and reprinted and made available to A.A. members and outside agencies by G.S.O. (Literature Committee)

**1960** It was recommended that:

The “share” or “quota” plan requested by the N.E. Ohio Grapevine Representative Committee for increasing Grapevine circulation for the coming year, by a minimum of 5,000 new subscribers, be adopted.

Due to the success of the N.E. Ohio Area program accepted by the Conference last year, all states be urged to participate actively in this plan, i.e. to appoint a Grapevine Representative at the State or Area level responsible for establishing Grapevine Committees to work with groups or Areas, depending on the needs of the particular Delegate’s State or Area Representative, subject only to the (advice and) approval of their local State or Area Committee.

Maintaining an “informative attitude” in all Grapevine presentation plans, rather than “hard sell” promotion, be continued.

The outstanding work done by the Grapevine Editorial Board (all volunteers), in helping to make *A.A. Today* (book commemorating A.A.’s 25th anniversary) be commended.

**1961** It was recommended that:

The Grapevine Group sponsorship program whereby groups are encouraged to send a new subscription, each month, to a local doctor, minister, psychiatrist, library, law-enforcement agency or member, prison or hospital, or any other person or agency selected by the group as a joint Twelfth Step venture be adopted.

The action of the previous G.S.O. Conferences in establishing and encouraging Grapevine representation at the state, area and group levels, depending on the problems and needs of each delegate’s area, be continued.

Where possible, appoint a knowledgeable A.A. member as a central Grapevine “editor” to search out A.A. writers and artists for Grapevine contributions.

The quota of 5,000 new subscriptions as a continuing goal for 1961 be re-adopted.

**1962** It was recommended that:

Retiring delegates will become Grapevine Representatives and recruit other G.V.R.s in their areas, with the objective that each A.A. group have a G.V.R.

Group sponsorship of gifts of Grapevine subscriptions to local doctors, clergymen, public officials and institutions is recommended for all groups.

Grapevine subscriptions for newcomers are recommended as a useful tool of sobriety; subscriptions to be entered automatically for each newcomer who may reimburse the group when he can.

Grapevine representatives will aim for 100% subscriptions in their groups, with follow-up on expirations to ensure 100% renewals.

The Grapevine boards, at the request of the delegate from Puerto Rico, will investigate the possibility of printing the Grapevine in Spanish.

**1963** It was recommended that:

All retiring delegates will act as Grapevine representatives be reaffirmed and notice of this be placed in the Grapevine and the General Service Office Bulletin.

All delegates should help select the Grapevine representative in every group in their area.

All G.S.O. pamphlets be scrutinized for mention, wherever possible, of the Grapevine as a recovery tool of A.A. World Services.

Review of the plans of the Grapevine to be published in Spanish and other languages be continued.

**1964** It was recommended that:

The Board of Directors of the Grapevine and the General Service Board explore the possibilities of using Grapevine material in a French edition of the magazine.

No legal action be taken at this time in connection with the use of copyright Grapevine material by “The Older Member Press.”

All Grapevine committee members henceforth be kept informed during the year on all Grapevine matters of Conference importance.

The Grapevine Committee be an active working part of the Grapevine effort and that the co-chairman of the committee report on behalf of the area delegates in the course of the presentation on the Grapevine at the 1965 Conference.

**1965** It was recommended that:

Area Committee members be appointed to inform members on Grapevine developments. (A need was shown for some action on the part of all interested to indicate the many uses of the Grapevine in Twelfth Step work.)

An article, instead of promotional inserts, would be more effective in interesting individuals and groups in obtaining subscriptions for Loners, Institutional Groups, foreign members and friends of A.A.

The Grapevine use the service of area committees in promoting the sale of the Grapevine at the group and individual levels.

An article or series of articles be published pointing out the value of individual subscriptions.

**1966** It was recommended that:

A stiff binder which would hold 12 issues of the Grapevine be produced and trial-marketed.

Delegates should lend their efforts toward increasing readership of the magazine in each area.

Delegates should search out new material—articles, stories, anecdotes—for the Grapevine in their areas.

The words “There are no dues or fees” remain in the Preamble. (Floor Action)

**1967** It was recommended that:

Delegates suggest to groups the need for sponsoring subscriptions to the Grapevine for prisons, jails, and hospitals in their areas.

The difference in price, owing to Canadian rate of exchange with U.S. currency, be indicated on future G.V. order forms.



The Serenity Prayer be incorporated into the GV's regular monthly format.

**1968** It was recommended that:

The Grapevine, being the voice of individual A.A. members, continue to publish the opinion of A.A. members, provided, however, that the Grapevine does not add its editorial endorsement to articles, and that it state that the opinions expressed therein are not necessarily those of the Grapevine.

Encouragement be given to the Grapevine Group Sponsorship program whereby groups are encouraged to send a new subscription each month to doctors, ministers and others interested in alcoholism, as well as institutions or other agencies selected by the group as a joint Twelfth Step venture.

**1969** It was recommended that:

A.A. World Services, Inc., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., with the primary purpose of the Fellowship foremost in mind, study their promotional efforts in each other's behalf and extend to each other the fullest cooperation in making the Fellowship aware of the tools of A.A.

All delegates consider it a part of their responsibility to make the Fellowship aware of the Grapevine as a tool of sobriety, either through their own efforts or by recruiting others.

**1970** It was recommended that:

Plans to act as Grapevine representatives in their areas, to request past Grapevines for use in institutions and to carry the Grapevine message as a vital tool when making reports to areas be reaffirmed.

**1971** It was recommended that:

The Grapevine Corporate Board be given Conference approval to raise the price of the Grapevine from \$.35 to \$.50 for a single copy, and from \$3.50 to \$5 for a yearly subscription, if the trend of rising costs indicates that the need is there.

All delegates return to their home groups with a determination to begin thinking of the Grapevine as a major tool in helping to achieve and maintain sobriety.

**1972** It was recommended that:

Retiring delegates continue their service to A.A. by acting as Grapevine Representatives in their areas.

Areas be encouraged to invite the Grapevine staff to visit state and provincial conferences.

The Grapevine resume its annual presentation to the Conference.

**1973** It was recommended that:

The 1962 action, retiring delegates become Grapevine Representatives (GvRs) and recruit other GvRs in their areas, with the objective of a GvR in each group be reaffirmed.

Each Conference area select a Grapevine chairman who would create a structure to work with the groups to enhance the readership of the A.A. Grapevine.

No new pay-as-you-go groups be accepted after July 31, 1973, in view of increasing bad debts. Pay-as-you-go groups in good standing, however, will be continued. The committee recommended prepaid subscriptions.

**1974** It was recommended that:

The Grapevine continue to publish responsible personal opinions of A.A. members, although the Grapevine does not necessarily endorse those opinions.

The "About Alcoholism" section in the gray pages of the Grapevine continue to report developments in the field of alcoholism even though they may be contrary to A.A. philosophy.

The Grapevine Corporate Board be given Conference approval to raise the price of the Grapevine for single copies and subscriptions, if the trend of rising costs indicates that the need is there.

Delegates carry back to their areas a proposal that groups institute the practice of giving birthday or anniversary gift subscriptions, with which the Grapevine will mail appropriate greeting cards.

The use of full names in correspondence with the Grapevine would facilitate A.A. communications. (The Grapevine protects anonymity at all times.)

**1975** It was recommended that:

Delegates communicate with the publishers of A.A. newsletters in their areas and urge them to use Grapevine blurbs, discussion topics, or other notices in the Grapevine regularly in their newsletters.

A letter be sent to the remaining pay-as-you-go groups explaining the advantages of prepaid subscriptions and notifying these groups that the pay-as-you-go plan will be terminated as of January 1, 1976.

All delegates make all A.A. members aware that they can subscribe to the Grapevine as individuals.

**1976** It was recommended that:

The recommendation that areas be encouraged to invite the Grapevine staff to visit state and provincial conferences be reaffirmed with the suggestion that the invitation be made to the Grapevine staff directly. The committee feels that personal contact between Grapevine staff and A.A. members will stimulate interest in the Grapevine.

Groups or individuals send Grapevine subscriptions to local libraries.

Groups be encouraged to increase their subscriptions as their memberships increase.

**1977** It was recommended that:

Delegates be responsible for establishing area Grapevine committees, using the area and district service structure to achieve the goal of a Grapevine representative in every group.

One copy of the Grapevine, along with a Grapevine order form, be included in every kit mailed out to new groups by G.S.O.

The Grapevine continue to publish the "About Alcoholism" section along with the disclaimer.

**1978** It was recommended that:

Delegates continue their efforts in using the area and district service structure to achieve the goal of a Grapevine representative in every group.

A Grapevine information table be made a regular feature at all conferences, conventions, and assemblies. (A Grapevine Conference Display Kit is available at no cost.)

Committees on public information, cooperation with the professional community, correctional facilities, and treatment facilities explore the use of the A.A. Grapevine in their endeavors.

Area and state functions consider Grapevine workshops similar to other workshops held at the area level from time to time.



**1979** It was recommended that:

When feasible, groups consider bulk orders as a means of making the Grapevine available at the group.

Grapevine representatives recommend to their groups that they sponsor subscriptions, where possible, for institutions, treatment facilities, and professionals being "sponsored."

The Grapevine office make available Grapevine prepaid gift certificates.

Delegates continue their efforts in using the area and district service structure to achieve the goal of a Grapevine representative in every group.

No changes be made in magazine format.

**1980** It was recommended that:

Shorter-term subscriptions for groups and treatment facilities not be considered at this time.

Delegates continue their efforts in using the area and district service structure to achieve the goal of a Grapevine representative in every group.

Grapevine Conference Display Kits be made available to district GvRs at cost.

Groups make every effort to introduce newcomers to the Grapevine as one of our best tools in sobriety.

**1981** It was recommended that:

The Grapevine provide a discount package of Grapevine miscellaneous items for sale to groups and central offices/inter-groups with a reasonable discount.

Delegates, in their continuing effort to achieve GvRs in their groups, work toward establishing district GvRs.

The Grapevine Corporate Board consider increasing the cover price of the Grapevine.

**1982** It was recommended that:

The price of miscellaneous items sold by the Grapevine be increased as needed.

No action be taken at this time on quantity sales of Grapevine subscriptions to outside organizations.

**1983** It was recommended that:

A trial tape cassette of articles from the Grapevine classic issues be prepared and made available as a special item, with future taping to be considered by the 1984 Conference.

Delegates research the need for the "About Alcoholism" section in their areas, and that the question of the function of and need for this section be brought to the 1984 Conference.

All communications to area Grapevine chairpersons also be sent to delegates.

Making the Grapevine available to outside agencies be left for area service structures to handle, in the spirit of autonomy.

**1984** It was recommended that:

Because of the positive response to the trial cassette, the Grapevine produce at least one tape a year as a special item.

The Grapevine continue to publish the "About Alcoholism" section, along with the disclaimer.

The "Portable A.A. Meeting" brochure be included in mailings of G.S.O. bulletins, and that a supply of this brochure be made available to all area Grapevine chairpersons.

The Conference reaffirm the 1977 Conference recommendation that "delegates be responsible for establishing area Grapevine committees, using the area and district service structure to achieve the goal of a Grapevine representative in every group." Also that delegates explore the possibility of utilizing alternates throughout the service structure as Grapevine representatives.

**1985** It was recommended that:

Grapevine committees seek ways to work with Public Information, Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, Treatment Facilities, and other service committees, with the aim of increasing the use of the Grapevine as a tool in carrying the message.

Since each issue of the Grapevine cannot go through the Conference-approval process, the Conference recognize The A.A. Grapevine as an international journal of Alcoholics Anonymous.

A workbook be produced for Grapevine committees.

Sections be added to the *Service Manual* defining the role of Grapevine Representatives at all levels, providing more information about the operation of The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and refer this item to the Report and Charter Committee.

**1986** It was recommended that:

The draft of the workbook for use by Grapevine committees be approved.

The Grapevine produce a trial tape in Spanish and a trial tape in French, at a price comparable to the Grapevine tapes in English. In making this recommendation the committee recognized the possibility of a financial loss, but considers that in this instance the need to carry the message to French-speaking and Spanish-speaking A.A.s makes such a possible loss acceptable.

The 1985 Conference Advisory Action #17 be corrected to read: "Since each issue of the Grapevine cannot go through the Conference-approved process, the Conference recognizes the A.A. Grapevine as the international journal of Alcoholics Anonymous."

Because the twelve articles on the Traditions, by B.L. of Manhattan, New York, and the article "The Whisper of Humility" contain the opinions of individuals only, and because they are already reprinted in Best of the Grapevine, these articles not be published as a pamphlet.

If the Grapevine Corporate Board approves development of the proposed book of Bill W.'s Grapevine writings, a draft be brought to the 1987 Conference for consideration.

**1987** It was recommended that:

Staff monitor ongoing distribution of Spanish and French Grapevine cassette tapes and report fuller results to the 1988 Conference.

No changes or additions be made to the Preamble.

Delegates focus their efforts on the district service structure as a means of reaching individual groups, in order to make every group aware of the value of the Grapevine as a recovery tool.

Delegates and area Grapevine chairpersons be encouraged to invite Grapevine staff personnel to attend local, area, and regional conventions, forums, and A.A. gatherings.

The Grapevine staff be responsible for communicating updated information to the delegates at appropriate intervals regarding editorial, circulation/fulfillment, and financial matters.



In view of the need for the entire Grapevine operation to be fully accountable to the Fellowship, the committee recognized serious management problems and believes them to be the responsibility of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

The Grapevine Board establish a mechanism for timely communications to all Conference members of actions taken and progress toward resolution of these problems.

A disclaimer be prepared by Grapevine staff for the calendar of events and be printed before each month's listing of coming events.

The Grapevine Corporate Board consider publishing a special issue written by Native North Americans and devoted to their recovery stories. (Literature Committee)

**1988** It was recommended that:

The Grapevine not publish a monthly section of daily messages/reflections.

The matters of format and editorial policy raised in the "Resolution to the A.A. Grapevine" from Area 70, Vermont, are within the right of decision of the Grapevine editorial staff.

The 1987 Conference Advisory Action number 29 be reaffirmed: "The Grapevine staff be responsible for communicating updated information to the delegates at appropriate intervals regarding editorial, circulation/fulfillment, and financial matters."

Since the Grapevine Corporate Board has fully complied with 1987 Advisory Action number 30, timely communication from the board to all Conference members regarding resolution of the management problems is no longer necessary, though the standing practice of sending quarterly Corporate Board minutes to Conference Grapevine Committee members will be continued.

The Grapevine proceed with a one-time trial distribution of complimentary Grapevines to nonsubscribing groups (selected on a random basis) in order to make them aware of the Grapevine as an effective recovery tool. In order to stay within the Grapevine's 1988 budget, the cost of this trial distribution should not exceed \$2,500. Results of this effort and any further action of the Corporate Board should be reviewed by the 1989 Conference.

The Grapevine proceed with publication of Bill W.'s collected Grapevine writings, with brief factual introductory material to be prepared by Grapevine staff and approved by the Grapevine Corporate Board.

The 1987 Conference Advisory Action #27 be reaffirmed: "Delegates focus their efforts on the district service structure as a means of reaching individual groups, in order to make every group aware of the value of the Grapevine as a recovery tool."

In order to encourage full participation, the Grapevine consider establishing a Grapevine awareness month, and areas continue to hold Grapevine workshops, Grape-a-thons and Grapevine meetings.

In response to concerns about the elapsed time between ordering and receiving the Grapevine, that the Grapevine Corporate Board investigate the feasibility of early acknowledgment of new subscription orders.

**1989** It was recommended that:

The Grapevine develop an ongoing A.A. history section, drawing on archival material, including area and regional histories.

In recognition of the need for a magazine price increase in the near future, delegates clarify in their areas the fact that the Grapevine is supported by subscription income and does not accept group contributions to cover operating expenses.

**1990** It was recommended that:

The words "one-time trial distribution of complimentary Grapevines to nonsubscribing groups" in 1988 Conference Advisory Action #25 no longer be considered binding.

**1991** It was recommended that:

The Grapevine discontinue publishing the "About Alcoholism" section.

Because of an expressed need, the Grapevine commence as soon as possible to include at least one article in Spanish in each month's issue.

**1992** It was recommended that:

After review of 1991 Conference Advisory Action #12:

- a. The Grapevine continue to include at least one article in Spanish in each month's issue.
- b. As a possible future replacement for the monthly Spanish articles in the magazine, the Grapevine Corporate Board investigate the feasibility of developing a quarterly Spanish newsletter based on original material and translations of current Grapevine articles, and bring cost and format proposals to the 1993 Conference Grapevine Committee.

The following proposal from the Grapevine Corporate Board be accepted:

In order to achieve some uniformity of procedure and to gain desired Conference input to Grapevine special items, yet not to compromise the Grapevine Corporate Board's "right of decision" to manage the fiscal affairs of the Grapevine, let it be proposed that:

Based on the positive model of mutual Conference and board involvement in the production of *The Language of the Heart*, the Grapevine Corporate Board offer to the Conference Grapevine Committee, on an ongoing basis, a general list of proposed special items at least two years in advance of possible production in order that the Conference should offer any guidance or register any disapproval they might have. Having so presented the conceptual basis of these special items to the Conference Committee, final approval for the completed items would rest with the Grapevine Corporate Board.

**1993** It was recommended that:

After considering 1992 Advisory Action #12 concerning the feasibility of a quarterly Spanish newsletter:

- a. The current policy of publishing monthly Grapevine articles in Spanish be reaffirmed;
- b. Because of staffing needs and other cost factors, a quarterly newsletter not be implemented at this time;
- c. Delegates and the Grapevine Corporate Board continue to explore different ways of carrying the message to the Spanish community through Grapevine materials.

The Grapevine Corporate Board not actively pursue the placement of Grapevine materials for resale in commercial (non-A.A.) outlets.



**1994** It was recommended that:

All A.A. members be strongly urged to work toward the goal that the A.A. Grapevine magazine be self-supporting through the sale of magazine subscriptions.

**1995** It was recommended that:

Based on an expressed need, a Spanish edition of the Grapevine be produced, contingent on the following: that the Grapevine Corporate Board proceed to gather information and develop a business plan for a bi-monthly Spanish edition of the Grapevine, for presentation to the trustees' Finance Committee, and that funding for up to five (5) years be obtained from the General Service Board Reserve Fund, with start-up costs estimated at \$84,000 for the first year. It was further recommended that if a Spanish edition is established, the monthly Spanish articles be removed from the English-language Grapevine, and that if, after five (5) years, the Spanish edition of the magazine is determined to be no longer feasible, publication be discontinued.

**1996** It was recommended that:

A manuscript be developed for a pamphlet providing basic information on the A.A. Grapevine magazine and its place in Alcoholics Anonymous and be brought to the 1997 Conference for approval.

**1997** It was recommended that:

That information about La Viña be included in the 1997-98 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* (Chapter XI: "The Grapevine").

The manuscript providing basic information of the A.A. Grapevine magazine and its place in Alcoholics Anonymous be produced as a pamphlet.

The Grapevine use mailing lists to provide introductory information about the Grapevine and La Viña to correctional facilities and treatment facilities.

**2001** It was recommended that:

La Viña continue to be published by the A.A. Grapevine and supported by the General Service Board as a service to the Fellowship.

La Viña continue to be published utilizing A.A. Grapevine resources in order to achieve efficiencies in production and distribution.

**2002** It was recommended that:

The pamphlet "The A.A. Grapevine: Our Meeting in Print" (P-52) be revised to accurately reflect changes in Grapevine operations and to clarify the text.

The Conference Committee on the Grapevine annually review a list of proposed related items at least one year in advance of possible production, so that the Conference might provide guidance, recognizing that the committee may request more than one year to review some proposed items.

**2003** It was recommended that:

The first paragraph of the description of the Grapevine representative on page 9 of the pamphlet "The A.A. Grapevine: Our Meeting in Print" be revised to read as follows:

#### **Grapevine and La Viña representatives**

"Grapevine representatives (GvRs) and La Viña representatives (RLVs) perform a service for A.A. members, bringing them two vital tools of recovery — the international journal of Alcoholics Anonymous and La Viña. GvRs and RLVs are engaged in practical, hands-on work. Their basic job is to

make the magazines available to the group, to encourage A.A.s to read them, subscribe to them, and use them in Twelfth Step work."

**2004** It was recommended that:

To allow the widest distribution of the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña to all purchasers, while guarding against affiliation with any outside enterprise, a) subscriptions to the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña magazines be issued only by the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., or by A.A. trusted servants directly; and b) the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., adopt standardized sales practices and pricing structures for all purchasers.

**Note:** This recommendation is to clarify the 1993 Advisory Action stating that "the Grapevine Corporate Board not actively pursue the placement of Grapevine materials for resale in commercial (non-A.A.) outlets."

The pamphlet "The A.A. Grapevine: Our Meeting in Print" be revised to include the proposed references to La Viña and La Viña representatives where the Grapevine magazine and its representatives are mentioned.

The A.A. Grapevine Workbook be designated as service material and be reviewed on an annual basis by the Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine.

**2007** It was recommended that:

The Grapevine and La Viña include a section on the medical, legal and social aspects of alcoholism, with an appropriate disclaimer.

**2010** It was recommended that:

La Viña achieve spiritual parity with the A.A. Grapevine, beginning in the following manner:

- Publishing La Viña as a bimonthly, perfect-bound, black-and-white, 68-page issue at an additional estimated cost of \$21,400 per year for one year beginning in 2011 followed by a year of review and assessment in 2012. The results of this review and assessment will be brought to the 2013 Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine.
- Content and substance be of primary importance.
- An announcement will be published in La Viña magazine, beginning immediately and throughout the trial year, encouraging increased submissions and subscriptions, moving toward the goal of being self-supporting.

It was recommended to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, that in order to reach the broadest spectrum of the Fellowship, sharing on the following items be gathered from the General Service Conference delegates on behalf of the 2010 Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine:

- What is the value of the Grapevine magazine to you?
- How do you use the Grapevine magazine?
- What would you like to change about the Grapevine magazine?
- What do you think the purpose of the Grapevine magazine should be?

**Note:** Responses are to be submitted to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board by 12/31/2010 and included as background material for the 2011 Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine.

**2011** It was recommended that:

In the spirit of being self-supporting, while also protecting our Traditions of attraction, anonymity, and non-affiliation, A.A.



Grapevine be permitted to utilize digital channels and current (commissionable) support and distribution technologies, such as, but not limited to, smart phones, tablets, e-readers, applications and commissioned online stores for the sale and distribution of magazines, books and products. The committee requests that the Board ensure that all contracts protect our Traditions, with the option to discontinue any and all contracts at any time. The committee requests that a status and financial report be submitted to the 2012 Grapevine Conference Committee.

The A.A. Grapevine Board, in consultation with the A.A. World Services Board and under the guidance of the General Service Board chairman, continue to investigate what efficiencies and objectives can be accomplished by combining services and sharing resources, including reviewing Concept XI, while still maintaining editorial and corporate independence.

The editorial revisions made by the A.A. Grapevine staff to "The A.A. Grapevine and La Viña: Our Meetings in Print" pamphlet be approved with minor suggestions.

**2012** It was recommended that:

AA Grapevine, Inc. move forward with an audio strategy to have members call in and record their story on 3rd party recording technology.

- The stories will be subject to the same editorial process as print stories.
- The Audio endeavor will, at a minimum, break even financially.
- The committee requests that the board ensure that all contracts protect our Traditions, with the option to discontinue any and all contracts at any time.
- The committee requests that a status and financial report be submitted to the 2013 Conference Committee on the Grapevine as background.

A.A. Grapevine, Inc., carry out the "Sunset" proposal for Grapevine items. The "Sunset" proposal is a plan to phase out older or slow-moving Grapevine items and archive them digitally or make them available in another format.

**2015** It was recommended that:

The revised pamphlet "A.A. Grapevine and La Viña: Our Meetings in Print" be approved.

**2016** It was recommended that:

The delegate chair for the Grapevine Conference Committee be allowed the same participation at the January A.A. Grapevine Board Meeting as all other delegate chairs at their corresponding trustees' committees.

**2017** It was recommended that:

A.A. Grapevine create a Google for Nonprofits account, with use of the account limited to the YouTube Nonprofit Program and with a guarantee that comments not be shown on the A.A. Grapevine YouTube pages. The A.A. Grapevine Board will track its effectiveness through website metrics. (Floor Action)

**2018** It was recommended that:

AA Grapevine, Inc. allow sales of Grapevine and La Viña books, single-issue magazines (as available), and other products to non-AA entities, such as (but not limited to) hospitals, treatment centers and book stores. [Note: As a current practice, AA Grapevine, Inc. does not seek outside sales for magazine subscriptions.]

AA Grapevine, Inc. continue to seek opportunities to expand bulk sales. [Note: AA Grapevine, Inc. currently offers volume discounts and will respond to requests, rather than solicit sales from outside entities.]

AA Grapevine, Inc. provide notification to A.A. World Services' list of non-A.A. entities to let them know that they can now purchase AA Grapevine and La Viña books, single-issue magazines (as available) and other products.

La Viña be published at its current frequency of six times per year as a service to the Fellowship, with perfect binding, at 68 pages, and in full color.

The revised pamphlet "AA Grapevine and La Viña: Our Meetings in Print" be approved and the title changed to "AA Grapevine and La Viña: Our Meetings in Print and Other Media."

**2020** It was recommended that:

The name of the Conference Committee on Grapevine be changed to the Conference Committee on Grapevine and La Viña.

**2021** It was recommended that:

The AA Grapevine Board implement an Instagram account and that a report on the Instagram account be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Grapevine and La Viña.

The A.A. Preamble be changed from:

Alcoholics Anonymous is a fellowship of men and women who share their experience, strength and hope with each other that they may solve their common problem and help others to recover from alcoholism. The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking. There are no dues or fees for A.A. membership; we are self-supporting through our own contributions. A.A. is not allied with any sect, denomination, politics, organization, or institution; does not wish to engage in any controversy; neither endorses nor opposes any causes. Our primary purpose is to stay sober and help other alcoholics to achieve sobriety.

To:

In Alcoholics Anonymous we share our experience, strength and hope with each other that we may solve our common problem and help others to recover from alcoholism. The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking. There are no dues or fees for A.A. membership; we are self-supporting through our own contributions. A.A. is not allied with any sect, denomination, politics, organization or institution; does not wish to engage in any controversy; neither endorses nor opposes any causes. Our primary purpose is to stay sober and help other alcoholics to achieve sobriety. (Floor Action)

The first sentence of the A.A. Preamble be revised with gender-neutral language by replacing the words "men and women" with the word "people" to read: "Alcoholics Anonymous is a fellowship of people who share their experience, strength and hope with each other that they may solve their common problem and help others to recover from alcoholism." (Floor Action)

The Preamble revision replacing the words "men and women" with the word "people" be presented to the General Service Board for approval as the new revised A.A. Preamble. (Floor Action)

**2024** It was recommended that:

- The AA Grapevine Board develop a 5-year financial plan for La Viña with the goal to reduce shortfalls and increase revenue to be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Grapevine and La Viña.



**2025** It was recommended that:

- The five-year plans for both Grapevine and La Viña be reviewed annually by the Conference Committee on the AA Grapevine and La Viña. The background materials for both plans should include at least five years of financial history and any relevant historical and/or strategic narrative that supports their projections.
- The pamphlet “Grapevine and La Viña: Our Meetings in Print” (P-52) be revised to clarify the text and accurately reflect changes in Grapevine operations.
- The Grapevine Board obtain feedback from the Fellowship by conducting a survey of the membership to identify relevance, usefulness and financial viability of products and services provided by Grapevine, such as the magazines, books (print, digital, and audio), podcast and social media (Instagram and YouTube), with a progress report to be brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on AA Grapevine and La Viña, and a final report be provided to the 2027 committee. The committee will provide a memo to the Board with suggestions for the content of the survey within 60 days.



## Advisory Actions Relevant to the Conference Institutions Committee<sup>1</sup>

### 1954

The Conference voted not to approve the proposal to list Hospital and Prison Groups in the 1955 Directory. It was agreed that, while it was in the spirit of A.A. to regard all groups as essential parts of the Fellowship, certain problems might arise if groups in this category are listed. (Floor Action)

### 1955

It was the sense of the Conference that Service Headquarters should consider the preparation of special literature designed for use in institutional programs. (Floor Action)

### 1956

The Conference agreed that inquiries from institutions should initially be referred to an Intergroup office, if one is active in the area involved, and to the Area Delegate. If no acknowledgment is received from these contacts within two weeks, General Service Headquarters is to use its own best judgment in referring the inquiry to a local group. (Floor Action)

### 1957 It was recommended that:

Consideration be given to the possibility of developing material for a pamphlet to include case histories for the skid row alcoholic, a pamphlet that might be available in jails. Furthermore, when an outline or treatment of such a pamphlet is ready, it be submitted to the members of the Conference Literature Committee for approval. (Literature Committee)

At least once a year, an announcement be made in the "A.A. Exchange Bulletin" that specially-priced gift packages of A.A. literature are available for Prison and Hospital Groups. (Literature Committee)

### 1958 It was recommended that:

There is no need for a pamphlet to include case histories for the skid row alcoholic to be available in jails at the present time because: (Literature Committee)

- In general, A.A. groups cooperate with local jails either through a sponsorship arrangement or jail meetings.
- Present pamphlet literature offers adequate A.A. reading material for the alcoholic in jail who desires to do something about his problem.
- The responsibility for placing information about A.A. in local jails is a matter for local A.A. groups and service committees.

There is no need for a special pamphlet for the inmate member in prisons and jails. Recommend that the staff member handling Institutional Services encourage the exchange of prison group experiences and publications to meet any need expressed by an individual prison group. (Literature Committee)

The participation of institutional groups in the Conference structure be left to the discretion of local Conference assemblies. (Policy)

### 1959 It was recommended that:

A new pamphlet for inmate alcoholics as outlined in the memorandum from G.S.O. literature consultant be approved. (Literature Committee)

### 1960 It was recommended that:

The Conference reaffirm the need for the pamphlets approved by the 1959 Conference, namely: for the Clergy, the Inmate, a revision of "Young People and A.A." and "The Alcoholic Employee." (Literature Committee)

### 1964

It was the sense of the meeting that the proxy system of voting could lead to abuses and that few areas were prepared to endorse the practice at this time, as far as general representation of regular Groups is concerned. At the same time, it was recognized that groups in correctional institutions and in certain hospitals might be unrepresented at Area Assemblies if they were not permitted to assign their voting privileges to members outside their groups. (Floor Action)

### 1965 It was recommended that:

The draft of "A.A. in Hospitals" be approved. (Literature Committee)

### 1966 It was recommended that:

A Conference Institutions Committee be established. (Policy Committee)

### 1967 It was recommended that:

A.A.s carrying the message to institutions abide by regulations and cooperate with personnel.

A.A. groups and members on the outside take the responsibility of providing literature to A.A. groups in institutions when possible, in line with the tradition of self-support.

Immediate sponsorship of the outgoing patient or inmate is of major importance in carrying the message to institutions.

Where no such committees exist, all states and areas consider formation of institutions committees to work in cooperation with area committees.

A twice-yearly bulletin be prepared for hospital and prison groups, institutional committees and sponsors.

A questionnaire concerning membership, self-support, etc. be sent to institutional groups, and that such groups be encouraged to handle their own activities when possible, with outside help provided by A.A.'s when necessary.

<sup>1</sup> Also see Correctional Facilities and Treatment Facilities/Accessibilities. In 1977, the Conference Institutions Committee was discontinued and replaced by these two committees.



An expression of gratitude be extended to all nonalcoholic institutional personnel.

**1968** It was recommended that:

Institutions committees be encouraged to use a post office box address so that referrals can be made without using an individual's name and address.

A.A. groups in correctional facilities and hospitals adhere to A.A.'s Fifth Tradition, on primary purpose of carrying the message to the alcoholic. That anyone with problems other than alcohol be made welcome at inside open meetings, but not participate in group activities.

The present use of the *World Directory* be continued in order to provide immediate A.A. sponsorship for new members leaving an institution.

Members be reminded that A.A. offers sobriety and does not provide housing, food, clothes, jobs, money, or other welfare or social services when carrying the message inside the walls.

G.S.O. make a survey of the duties performed by local institutions committee chairmen.

**1969** It was recommended that:

Guidelines be prepared outlining procedures for A.A. members to follow in working with institutions and ways of informing the nonalcoholic staff about A.A. The following committee recommendations are to be included in the guidelines:

- a. A.A.s attending meetings at prisons or hospitals should be selected carefully so that relations with the institution's staff remain harmonious.
- b. A.A.'s position on membership in institutional groups be defined as follows:
- c. We cannot give A.A. membership to nonalcoholic narcotic addicts and other unrelated groups or organizations. A.A. groups in institutions can welcome anyone with problems other than alcohol to inside open meetings, but it is suggested that they do not speak or otherwise participate in these meetings.

The *Institutions Bulletin* should have a wider distribution.

A.A.s should work toward coordination of all institutional work in the state or province so that there will be cooperation between all local, intergroup, and general service institutions committees.

The institutions directories be distributed every two years with yearly supplements.

**1970** It was recommended that:

The possibility of separating the hospital and prison services into subcommittees of the present Conference Institutions Committee be discussed with the membership and presented again on the 1971 Institutions Committee meeting agenda.

A group institutions representative be chosen at the direction of the group when practical.

An effort be made to contact doctors and other personnel by personal visit or phone call to ask their help in informing other doctors about the Fellowship of A.A.

This committee help in the formation of an institutions committee in an area where none exists and that A.A. members from other areas who are experienced in institutions committee work be consulted or asked to speak at an area assembly meeting on this subject.

The wording of the 1969 Institutions Committee recommendation concerning the definition of A.A.'s position on membership in institutions groups be changed to read as follows:

Open meetings are traditionally open to all interested in A.A., but should be devoted exclusively to the alcoholic problem. Closed meetings should traditionally be restricted to alcoholics.

**1971** It was recommended that:

In a discussion of separating the hospital and prison service into subcommittees of the present Institutions Committee, it was the sense of the meeting that the Institutions Committee remain the same.

The delegates give wholehearted support to the efforts of the General Service Office to establish an Institutions Correspondence Service on an individual basis, similar to the Loner Sponsor Service.

Each delegate study the possibility of receiving the necessary quantity of Institutions Bulletins for his area.

The General Service Board participate more directly with the Conference Institutions Committee.

**1972** It was recommended that:

The Literature Committee reexamine institutions literature in an attempt to reach all levels of understanding.

The possibility of a trustees' Committee on Institutions be considered.

**1973** It was recommended that:

A letter be sent to local institutions committees or contacts asking them to send G.S.O. a list of facilities (both hospitals and prisons) where there are currently *no* A.A. groups.

The General Service Office conduct a survey by contacting administrative officials or correctional rehabilitation facilities where there are A.A. groups, for a full assessment of A.A. in their facilities.

We update testimonials in "A.A. in Prisons" and "A.A. in Hospitals" as per information gathered from survey.

We change titles of institutional discount packages from: Men's Prison Package, Jail Package, Women's Prison Package, Hospital Package to: Discount Package A, B, C, etc., with contents of packages still indicated on order forms.

Simplified editions of "Memo to an Inmate" and "Is A.A. for You?" be prepared in an attempt to reach all levels of understanding.

We cooperate with administrative officials in the institutional setting to the utmost within the confines of our Traditions and the suggestions contained in "A.A. in Prisons" and "Memo to an Inmate." If, because of prison procedure, inmates are encouraged to attend A.A. meetings, we have to assume that they are coming for the right reasons.

Any A.A. member's evaluating another A.A. member is totally in opposition to our Traditions.

The 1973 Conference reaffirm the action taken by the 1968 Conference on the use of the *World Directory*:

That the present use of the *World Directory* in institutions be continued in order to provide immediate A.A. sponsorship for new members leaving the institution.



The next edition of the *Institutions Bulletin* include an article stressing careful use of the *World Directory* in institutional groups.

**1974** It was recommended that:

The General Service Office send an inquiry to all delegates to find out the functions and structure of the institutions committees in their areas and the body to which committees report.

All institutions committees and outside sponsors make every possible effort to cooperate with institutions' regulations and to maintain good communications with institutions' personnel.

Institutions committees and outside sponsors inform inside A.A. group officers what the outside A.A. members can and cannot do.

The following topics be considered for the institutions session at the 1975 International Convention:

- a. Working with detox centers and rehabs.
- b. Making A.A. more attractive to inmates serving time for alcohol-related crimes.

**1975** It was recommended that:

We endeavor to improve communications between intergroup (central office) and general service institutions committees by emphasizing the concept that general service committees exist to provide service wherever needed, including service to intergroup or central office institutions committees.

One person from each institutions committee be charged with the responsibility of acting as liaison to the other, and that communications may be further improved by: a) exchanging minutes of meetings between the two committees, and b) instituting joint workshops and sharing sessions at area assemblies.

In an effort to place greater emphasis on the importance of hospitals as part of the overall Institutions Committee, delegates, upon returning to their areas, furnish the G.S.O. secretary of the Institutions Committee with the names and addresses of A.A. members who are currently interested in hospital work. The secretary would then be in a position to keep these particular people fully informed of institutional activity, thereby creating a greater interest and more activity in the hospital field.

The following changes be made in the Guidelines on Institutional Committees: (a) Page 4 heading be changed to read, "Relationship to A.A. in the Area or District"; (b) Number 1 under this same heading to read: "Group representative at intergroup/central office or area meetings."

"The Suggested Duties of the G.I.R." be published in the *Institutions Bulletin*.

**1976** It was recommended that:

Whether we agree or disagree with a hospital's or a correctional facility's policy, we carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic when feasible, following the rules of the facility and cooperating the best we can within A.A. Traditions.

A.A. members on the staff of a hospital or facility should not control A.A. meetings, but cooperate with institutions committees or responsible A.A. members who are carrying the message to that facility; also, to refer to Guidelines for A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field.

An excellent format for a hospital meeting was outlined in one of the editions of the A.A. Guidelines: "A.A. members not only tell briefly their own story, but also tell something about how A.A. works. A.A. members' experience says it is very important never to be argumentative, nor critical of anything. This seems to work best when the speakers . . . are very tolerant and good-natured; when, in other words, they make the A.A. way of life seem attractive."

Outside A.A. members taking meetings to institutions are more effective than meetings of inside A.A. members only.

Taking a collection at a hospital A.A. meeting be left to the discretion of the institutions committee.

Next year the 1977 Conference Institutions Committee add to its agenda the following: Define what a rehabilitation facility is and how the Institutions Committee can handle it.

The trustees' and Conference Institutions Committees be divided into two subcommittees each: (a) Correctional Institutions, (b) Hospitals and Rehabilitation Centers.

**1977** It was recommended that:

The Institutions Committee be dissolved and two new committees—one dealing with Correctional Facilities, and one with Treatment Facilities—be formed.

It is not practical to hold a joint meeting of the Conference and trustees' Committees on P.I., C.P.C., and Institutions, but that the quarterly highlights of the trustees' Committees on P.I., C.P.C., Correctional Facilities, and Treatment Facilities be sent to all members of these Conference committees.

There is no need for the Institutional Groups to receive the A.A. Directory at this time.

It is not within A.A.'s province to define a rehabilitation facility.

The committee will review the outline of the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Hell Out of Sitting in a Cell" and also the two pamphlets "A.A. in Prisons" and "A.A. in Hospitals."



## Advisory Actions Relevant to the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities<sup>1</sup>

**1978** It was recommended that:

The manuscript of the new inmate pamphlet, "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," be accepted pending mail-poll approval by the committee of the final edited version and illustrations; that production then proceed under the direction of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities, with the word "hell" being omitted from the title. The committee further recommended that consideration be given to the use of color illustrations if financially feasible.

A future Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities consider developing a booklet aimed at the alcoholic inmate, if warranted.

**1979** It was recommended that:

Mail-poll approval of "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" be confirmed.

A booklet aimed at the alcoholic inmate is not warranted at this time, and further recommended that this subject be considered by the 1980 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities.

"Where Do I Go From Here?" and "A.A. at a Glance" be added to the institutions discount packages, and that the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities further explore rearranging the contents of the packages when "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" becomes available.

The trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities explore the feasibility of producing a filmstrip based on "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" and report its findings to the 1980 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities.

**1980** It was recommended that:

In helping the inmate "bridge the gap" between "inside" and "outside" A.A.:

- a. Emphasis should be put on cooperation with the correctional facility administration and the judicial system.
- b. More emphasis be put on prerelease sponsorship, utilizing *responsible* A.A. members and recovering ex-inmates where possible.
- c. The local institutions committees be used in referrals to A.A. groups.

A new pamphlet aimed at the dually addicted inmate not be considered at this time.

The pamphlet "Do You Think You're Different?" be added to Institutions Discount Package Y.

The Conference reaffirm the recommendation of the 1977 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community, as follows: "In the interest of communication and cooperation, reports of trustees' committees on P.I., C.P.C., Correctional Facilities, and Treatment Facilities be distribut-

ed to the delegate members of the corresponding Conference committees after each trustees' committee meeting. (Policy/Admissions)

**1981** It was recommended that:

The pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic" be continued, but that the recommendation be reviewed again by the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities next year.

**1982** It was recommended that:

The following statement be added to the pamphlets "Memo to an Inmate" (page 43, inside box) and "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" (page 25): "A.A. does not provide letters of reference to parole boards, lawyers, court officials."

The pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate" continue to be published.

The pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate" be translated into Spanish. It was also suggested that "Carrying the Message Inside the Walls" and "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" be translated into Spanish due to the high Spanish population in prisons.

**1983** It was recommended that:

A Correctional Facilities Workbook be developed for carrying the A.A. message into correctional facilities. Also, that this be developed through the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities and that a draft be prepared for the 1984 Conference, using the survey results and other information.

A letter explaining the Institutions Correspondence Service be sent twice a year to delegates and correctional facilities chairpersons asking for A.A. volunteers to write inmates on an individual basis.

"It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" and "Carrying the Message Inside the Walls" be translated into Spanish.

**1984** It was recommended that:

The Correctional Facilities Workbook, which has now been prepared, be approved for production and distribution.

The following lines from "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be added to page 12 of the "A.A. in Prisons" pamphlet:

"In A.A. groups, the people who get the jobs done are called 'officers,' but our Second Tradition reminds us, 'Our leaders are but trusted servants; they do not govern.'"

"Officers are usually chosen by the group for limited terms of service.

"The jobs they do may have titles. But titles in A.A. do not bring authority or honor; they describe services and responsibilities.

"They are ways of carrying the message. They are forms of Twelfth Step work A.A. members do, primarily to help themselves recover."

<sup>1</sup> For pre-1978 actions related to correctional facilities, see Institutions.



A specific reference to the year 1974 be deleted from page 17 of "A.A. in Prisons" to keep from dating the pamphlet.

Correctional facilities news be included in *Box 4-5-9*, eliminating the need for a separate Correctional Facilities Bulletin, with concern that costs be held to a reasonable level, and that a larger *Box 4-5-9* be indexed and categorized.

**1985** It was recommended that:

The language of the pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic" be rewritten in a simpler style, and that two of the seven male stories be replaced by female stories.

There be affirmation of the paramount importance of full compliance with all correctional facilities' rules and regulations by all A.A.s who carry the message into correctional facilities; A.A. members are "guests" of the facility and subject to all security measures and constraints.

The words "and minorities" be deleted from the pamphlet "A.A. in Prisons." Thus the sentence in the pamphlet that now reads:

"And it keeps over-ambitious individuals and minorities from ever becoming entrenched in the leadership of a group."

would be changed to read:

"And it keeps over-ambitious individuals from ever becoming entrenched in the leadership of a group."

Preliminary work begin on the creation of a filmstrip based on the thoughts contained in the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," directed toward the inmate.

The Treatment Facilities, Correctional Facilities, and Cooperation With the Professional Community Workbooks be translated into Spanish. (Floor Action)

**1986** It was recommended that:

In the 4-minute videotape proposal for a 15-minute video/16mm film based on the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," reference to "copping drugs and dealing drugs" on page 1 of the transcript be deleted, as well as the sentence "Anything but drink" on pages 6 and 7 of the transcript, to be replaced with "Just don't drink."

This 15-minute film be produced in full to be presented to the 1987 Conference, and that the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee monitor and report on the progression of the film during the year.

The outline of the rewrite of the pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate Who May be an Alcoholic" be completed for approval at the 1987 Conference.

Relative to sponsoring inmates upon release, that area committees, district committees, central/ intergroup office committees, and group correctional facility representatives discuss specific ways to coordinate efforts in sponsoring inmates upon release from prison.

The Institutions Correspondence Service be utilized by groups, as well as by individuals, as a means of effective sponsorship.

**1987** It was recommended that:

The 16-minute video based on the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" be produced for distribution to the Fellowship, with the following deletions: (a) "in this film" be eliminated from the opening statement, and (b) "A.A." in credit 4, page 7 of the script, be eliminated.

The video "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" be produced with closed captions for the hearing impaired, at a cost not exceeding \$1,500.

The finalized draft of the pamphlet "Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic" be accepted for distribution to the Fellowship as presented, with the following addition to page 29 under "What A.A. Does Not Do": "No 14. Furnish initial motivation for alcoholics to recover."

The Institutions Correspondence Service not be dissolved at this time.

The General Service Office take such steps as are necessary to avoid delay in the Institutions Correspondence Service's response from G.S.O.

All areas be encouraged to begin working in the direction of establishing an area institutions correspondence service, coordinating this with G.S.O., as necessary.

The trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities find a method of adapting the film "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" into the Spanish language.

The trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities consider the feasibility of adapting the film "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" into the French language.

**1988** It was recommended that:

The pamphlet "A.A. in Prisons" be replaced with two separate revisions of the material: (1) An easy-to-read pamphlet for inmates and outside A.A.s interested in starting A.A. groups in correctional facilities, which will explain how inside groups are formed and how they function. (2) A brief pamphlet or leaflet to provide information about A.A. to administrators of correctional facilities.

The phrase "A.A. contact" be used in place of "prerelease sponsorship" in A.A. literature and communications about inmates who will soon be released, in order to encourage more participation on the part of outside A.A.s.

**1989** It was recommended that:

The name of the "Institutions Correspondence Service" (I.C.S.) be changed to "Corrections Correspondence Service" (C.C.S.) as literature comes up for reprint.

That the flyer "Carrying the Message Inside the Walls" be replaced with the revised version entitled "Carrying the Message Into Correctional Facilities."

**1990** It was recommended that:

The trustees' committee recommendation for publication of a collection of Correctional Facilities stories from previous Grapevines (and other A.A. sources) be approved.

The trustees' Literature Committee consider adding a story of a young person who entered A.A. while in prison to the pamphlet "Young People and A.A.," because of an expressed need for Correctional Facilities materials addressed to young people.

**1991** It was recommended that:

The trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee produce a 60-minute audiotape of selected stories from the booklet *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, including culturally varied voices and some female stories, in response to an expressed need for audiovisual material. Estimated cost: \$2,475.



**1992** It was recommended that:

The Correctional Facilities Workbook be published in a softcover format and be enclosed in a folder which would include the appropriate pamphlets and A.A. Guidelines. The committee felt it would allow more versatility for the use of the Workbook within correctional facilities and would result in annual cost savings of \$3,400.

The Correctional Facilities Directory be discontinued. It was felt by the committee that there is no viable service provided to inmates and the Directory serves no purpose to warrant the annual expenditure of \$5,600.

The following paragraphs be included in the pamphlets "A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators" and "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" when reprinted:

Many local A.A. service committees will, upon request, provide informational presentations for your organization. Sessions can be tailored to meet your needs. A typical agenda might include one or several A.A. films and a presentation by one or more A.A. members on "What A.A. Is and What It Is Not."

Please check your local telephone directory or newspaper for the number of Alcoholics Anonymous.

**1994** It was recommended that:

Changes in the pamphlets "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" and "A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators" from a report by the Trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities be accepted and forwarded to publications for the next printing of the pamphlets.

Guidelines for A.A. presentations to corrections professionals and to inmates by correctional committees be added to the Correctional Facilities Workbook booklet at its next printing.

**1996** It was recommended that:

Sample video footage be made that focuses on encouraging more A.A. participation in carrying the message into Correctional Facilities, and brought back to the 1997 General Service Conference for review. (**Note:** The cost would be approximately \$20,000.)

The following should be reflected in the footage:

- a. Singleness of purpose.
- b. Correctional Facilities Workshops.
- c. Reaction from men and women inmates attending A.A. meetings at their facility, and from outside members who carry the message inside.
- d. Inmate speakers at an A.A. event.
- e. Unpredictability and roadblocks to carrying the message inside.
- f. How to improve communication within A.A. and with prison administrators.
- g. Once A.A.s are involved, how to keep them involved.

A one-page newsletter be published quarterly, whenever feasible, for A.A. members on the inside, which would reflect sharing from inmate letters to G.S.O. and which would be sent to Conference members, Area Correctional Facilities Chairs and to inmates who write to G.S.O. (**Note:** The cost would be approximately \$6,000 per year.)

**1997** It was recommended that:

The video on encouraging more A.A. members to participate in carrying the A.A. message into correctional facilities be completed, and brought back to the 1998 Conference Committee on

Correctional Facilities for review. (**Note:** The additional cost of completing the video would be approximately \$41,000.)

The following should be reflected in the video footage:

- a. Singleness of purpose.
- b. Correctional Facilities workshops.
- c. Reaction from men and women inmates attending A.A. meetings at their facility and from outside members who carry the message inside.
- d. Inmate speakers at an A.A. event.
- e. Unpredictability and roadblocks of carrying the message inside.
- f. How to improve communication within A.A. and with prison administrators.
- g. Once A.A.s are involved, how do we keep them involved.
- h. Emphasis on the outside members' participation and perspective.

The name of the pamphlet "A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators" be changed to "A Message to Correctional Professionals," and that the following two paragraphs from the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional" be included: "A.A. Wants to Work With You," and "What A.A. Does Not Do."

**1998** It was recommended that:

The video entitled "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls" be developed to encourage more A.A. members to participate in carrying the message into correctional facilities, be approved with two minor focus adjustments to safeguard the anonymity of A.A. members.

An addition relative to carrying the message into youth detention centers and short-term facilities be added to the Correctional Facilities Workbook.

**1999** It was recommended that:

In the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," the first six paragraphs on pages 18 and 19, under the heading "We Set Up A.A. Contacts," be replaced with the changes selected by the committee.

To get more A.A.s interested in participating in the Corrections Correspondence Service, the 1983 Conference Advisory Action that "A letter explaining the Institutions Correspondence Service be sent twice a year to delegates and correctional facilities [committee] chairpersons asking for A.A. volunteers to write inmates on an individual basis" be reaffirmed.

**2000** It was recommended that:

The revision of the pamphlet to replace "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" be approved.

A list of literature for young people be added to the Literature Guide section of the Correctional Facilities Workbook.

The Correctional Facilities Kit and Workbook be designated as service material rather than "A.A. General Service Conference-approved Literature." (Floor Action)

**2003** It was recommended that:

The trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities revise the booklet *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* by adding/replacing stories to better reflect current experience, and that a draft manuscript or progress report be brought to the 2004 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities.

**Note:** The committee suggested that stories/sharing of young people and women be included in the revised booklet.



**2004** It was recommended that:

The trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities consider including the statement on A.A.'s Singleness of Purpose, which follows, in the pamphlet "A Message to Correctional Professionals:"

"Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend *open* A.A. meetings, but only those with a *drinking* problem may attend *closed* meetings."

**2005** It was recommended that:

The "Singleness of Purpose" statement, which follows, be included in the pamphlet "A Message to Correctional Professionals":

### **Singleness of Purpose and Problems Other than Alcohol**

Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as "substance abuse" or "chemical dependency." Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend open A.A. meetings, but only those with a *drinking* problem may attend *closed* meetings.

A progress report on the development of an effective informational media presentation introducing A.A. to training academies and in-service training for corrections personnel be brought back to the 2006 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities. The following should be reflected in the presentation:

- a. What A.A. is and is not.
- b. How to contact A.A.
- c. An inmate's chances of maintaining sobriety on the outside are improved by participation in the A.A. program of recovery.
- d. Correctional facilities usually regard A.A. as contributing to the objectives of their institution.

The name of the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities be changed to the Conference Committee on Corrections.

**2006** It was recommended that:

An informational media presentation be developed featuring someone highly credible in the corrections field introducing A.A. to training academies and in-service training programs for corrections personnel and be brought back to the 2007 Conference Committee on Corrections. [The estimated cost of production and distribution is \$50,000]

The following should be reflected in the presentation:

- a. What A.A. is and is not.
- b. How to contact A.A.
- c. An inmate's chances of maintaining sobriety on the outside are improved by participation in the A.A. program of recovery.
- d. Correctional facilities usually regard A.A. as contributing to the objectives of their institution.

The draft manuscript of *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* be approved and that the Publications Department maintain standard editorial responsibilities.

**2007** It was recommended that:

The draft informational media presentation featuring someone highly credible in the corrections field introducing A.A.

to training academies and in-service training programs for correctional personnel be approved with a suggested change to be reviewed and approved by the trustees' Committee on Corrections.

**2009** It was recommended that:

The trustees' Committee on Corrections undertake a revision of the pamphlet, "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," which will take into consideration:

- More stories of recovery from alcoholism through the principles of Alcoholics Anonymous, drawn from *Sharing From Behind the Walls, Box 4-5-9* or other available sources.
- Less use of 'directive' language (such as that used in the section on H.A.L.T.)
- Including photographs that reflect current times and that a draft pamphlet or a progress report be brought back to the 2010 Conference Committee on Corrections.

The photo on page 18 of the pamphlet, "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," which shows an inmate smoking a hand-rolled cigarette, be replaced with a photo of the current edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, in future reprints, as well as in any revision.

**2010** It was recommended that:

The pamphlet "Carrying the Message Into Correctional Facilities" be revised so that the sentence "Obey the rules of the facility you are visiting" is replaced with the following text:

"Deciding to participate in Corrections Twelfth Step work is an important individual decision. A.A. members should carefully read all paperwork required by correctional facilities, and fully understand and be willing to comply with all rules/regulations prior to commencing such work."

The pamphlet "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" be revised so that the last sentence on page 4 under the heading "Policy Meetings" that previously read:

"Policy matters include deciding when and where the group is to meet; and setting the conditions under which A.A. visitors may attend these meetings."

Will now read:

"Policy matters include deciding when and where the group is to meet; and setting the conditions under which visiting A.A. members may attend these meetings, including any required volunteer orientation and forms that must be completed."

The pamphlet "A Message to Corrections Professionals" be revised so that the following two sentences are added to the end of the first paragraph under "Inmate Groups":

"Since regulations *can and do vary*, A.A. members will need to be specifically informed about the rules/regulations of each facility they will enter. To that end, good communication between corrections administrators and local A.A. committees is essential."

**2011** It was recommended that:

The following changes to the pamphlet "A.A. in Correctional Facilities":

That the text in the pamphlet "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" in the section on "Meetings," which reads,

"Since the Twelve Steps are the basis of our recovery in A.A., many groups hold Step meetings. The leader might share a bit of his or her story and talk briefly about a particular Step and then throw the meeting open for discussion. Each type of meeting serves a different purpose; all are needed."



Be replaced with:

"Many groups also hold Step meetings, Tradition meetings or Big Book studies. Each type of meeting serves a different purpose; all are needed."

And that the heading and text of the section "Step meetings," which reads,

*"Step meetings*

*"In addition to a leader sharing his or her experience with a Step, some groups might read from Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions, followed by a discussion. Many groups find listening to cassette tapes on the Steps helpful. (Tapes are available from the General Service Office.)"*

Be replaced with:

*"Step meetings, Tradition meetings and Big Book studies*

*"Since the Twelve Steps are the basis of our recovery in A.A., many groups hold Step meetings. Some groups read passages from the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* or the Big Book, followed by a discussion.*

*"Groups may also read and discuss the Twelve Traditions, the best answers we have found to the questions "How can A.A. best function?" and "How can A.A. best stay whole and so survive?"*

*"Since the Big Book contains not only directions for how many of our members practice the Twelve Steps, but also a brief history of our Fellowship's beginnings and personal stories to help newcomers identify with other alcoholics, many A.A. groups devote meeting time to the study of this basic text.*

*"Audio recordings of the Big Book and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* are available from the General Service Office. The pamphlets "The Twelve Steps Illustrated" and "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated" may also be helpful."*

**2012** It was recommended that:

The revised draft pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" be approved.

The pamphlet "A Message to Corrections Professionals" be revised with the following changes:

- a. Replace the first paragraph under the section "Release and paroles" with the following paragraph:

One point which usually needs to be explained is why inmates have any need of A.A. while they are incarcerated. The answer is that the A.A. program is far more than staying away from alcohol. A.A. has been called a way of life, and its success for groups that meet while in custody shows that this program can help the alcoholic inmate live a sober and contented life, both while in custody and after release.

- b. Change the title of the section currently called "Release and paroles" to "Re-entry and Parole."

- c. The current statement regarding "Singleness of Purpose" in the last paragraph, which reads:

Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as "substance abuse" or "chemical dependency." Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend open A.A. meetings, but only those with a drinking problem may attend closed meetings.

Be revised with wording that is consistent with the description of the difference between Open and Closed meetings in the pamphlet "The A.A. Group" on page 13, to read as follows:

Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as "substance abuse" or "chemical dependency." Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Nonalcoholics may attend *open* A.A. meetings as observers, but only those with a drinking problem may attend *closed* A.A. meetings.

The trustees' Corrections Committee develop a draft replacement for the section "A.A. in correctional facilities" in the pamphlet "A Message to Corrections Professionals" to be brought back to the 2013 Conference Committee on Corrections.

**2013** It was recommended that:

The revised pamphlet "A Message to Corrections Professionals" be approved.

**2014** It was recommended that:

The section "What A.A. does NOT do" in the pamphlet "A Message to Corrections Professionals," which currently reads:

***What A.A. does NOT do***

A.A. does not: Furnish initial motivation for alcoholics to recover; solicit members; engage in or sponsor research; keep attendance records or case histories; join "councils" of social agencies; follow up or try to control its members; make medical or psychological diagnoses or prognoses; provide drying-out or nursing services, hospitalization, drugs, or any medical or psychiatric treatment; offer religious services; engage in education about alcohol; provide housing, food, clothing, jobs, money or any other welfare or social services; provide domestic or vocational counseling; accept any money for its services or any contributions from non-A.A. sources; provide letters of reference to parole boards, lawyers, court officials, social agencies, employers, etc.

Be revised to read (additional text in **bold**):

***What A.A. does NOT do***

A.A. does not: Furnish initial motivation for alcoholics to recover; solicit members; engage in or sponsor research; keep attendance records or case histories; join "councils" of social agencies (**although A.A. members, groups and service offices frequently cooperate with them**); follow up or try to control its members; make medical or psychological diagnoses or prognoses; provide **detox, rehabilitation** or nursing services, hospitalization, drugs, or any medical or psychiatric treatment; offer religious services or **host/sponsor retreats**; engage in education about alcohol; provide housing, food, clothing, jobs, money or any other welfare or social services; provide domestic or vocational counseling; accept any money for its services or any contributions from non-A.A. sources; provide letters of reference to parole boards, lawyers, court officials, social agencies, employers, etc.

A new video be developed to replace "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" at a cost not to exceed \$70,000.

**2016** It was recommended that:

The video to replace "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" with the title "A New Freedom" be approved.

**2021** It was recommended that:

Revisions be made to A.A.W.S. literature directed to members behind the walls and that the terms "inmate" and "offender" be replaced with "person in custody."



**2023** It was recommended that:

- The committee recommended that item #5 in the Procedures of the Conference Committee on Corrections which currently reads:
- "To maintain correspondence with committee secretary and other committee members during the year,"

Be revised, to read:

- "To maintain communication with committee secretary and other committee members during the year."
- The following section be added to the pamphlet "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" on page 12 between the sections titled "Corrections Correspondence Service (CCS) — a special kind of A.A. service" and "The follow-through — released A.A. persons in custody":

Sponsorship

- Like all A.A. members, persons in custody can benefit from sponsorship. For more information, please refer to the Corrections Kit and Workbook or contact your local Corrections committee.

**2024** It was recommended that:

- The Singleness of Purpose description in the pamphlet "A Message to Correctional Professionals," which currently reads:  
"Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Nonalcoholics may attend open A.A. meetings as observers, but only those with a drinking problem may attend closed meetings."

Be replaced with the following text:

- "Some professionals refer to alcoholics and drug addicts as a single group when using professional terminology. Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Nonalcoholics may attend open A.A. meetings as observers, but attendance at closed meetings is limited to persons who have a desire to stop drinking."
- The video "Carrying the Message Behind the Walls" be discontinued.
- A pamphlet on the transgender alcoholic in A.A. be developed. The committee requested that a draft pamphlet or progress report be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Corrections.

**Note:** As a result of the 2023-2024 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, the previous item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Corrections.



## Advisory Actions Relevant to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities/Accessibilities<sup>1</sup>

**1978** It was recommended that:

The outline for revision of the pamphlet “A.A. in Treatment Facilities” be approved with suggestions to be incorporated in the pamphlet.

**1979** It was recommended that:

The Conference approve the pamphlet “How and Why A.A. Members Carry the A.A. Message into Treatment Centers” (formerly “A.A. in Hospitals”) with revisions.

The Conference reaffirm the previous Conference actions adopted in 1976, which are: “(a) Establish greater communication between the referral sources and local A.A. groups; (b) recognize the necessity of meeting the new member where he presently is; listen to him; try to determine what he really knows about the A.A. program; (c) see that specific programs are set up for sponsoring people from treatment centers into local A.A. groups.”

With regard to hospital discount packages, adopted trustees’ committee recommendation that the contents of this package remain unchanged. When local areas have special needs, it is their responsibility to make up their own packages.

**1980** It was recommended that:

A modification in the scope of the Treatment Facilities Committee be made so that it will now read as follows:

The purpose of the committee is to encourage A.A. members to assume responsibility to carry the message to alcoholics in treatment facilities.

The committee will review all aspects of A.A. services to treatment facilities and make recommendations for changes and/or improvements in these A.A. services.

It is not appropriate to send a specific (“bridging-the-gap”) letter to treatment facilities’ administrators at this time. However, G.S.O. is encouraged to forward copies of the newly published “A.A. in Treatment Centers” pamphlet to all facility administrators.

Although the directory of *A.A. Groups in Treatment Facilities* may be of value to a limited number of treatment facility administrators and A.A. members, its value to the A.A. community is questionable. It was, therefore, recommended that the Report and Charter Committee and G.S.O. review this matter, at their earliest convenience, for possible continued value.

The submitted modifications to the pamphlet “A.A. in Treatment Centers” were not significant enough to modify the pamphlet at this time.

No new action is required on ways to distribute the Guidelines for A.A. Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field.

The Conference reaffirm the recommendation of the 1977 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional

Community, as follows: “In the interest of communication and cooperation, reports of trustees’ committees on P.I., C.P.C., Correctional Facilities, and Treatment Facilities be distributed to the delegate members of the corresponding Conference committees after each trustees’ committee meeting. (Policy/Admissions)

**1981** It was recommended that:

The additions and changes in the “A.A. in Treatment Centers” pamphlet by the trustees’ Committee on Treatment Facilities be accepted.

These changes basically involve the clarification of the two types of meetings held in treatment facilities: regular group meetings and treatment facilities meetings. It was specifically recommended that the six-point definition of an A.A. group be included in a “boxed-in” form in the pamphlet. These changes will result in new terminology; what has previously been known as a “treatment center group” will now be known as a “treatment center meeting.”

**1982** It was recommended that:

In light of the recent statistics showing the greater influx of members coming from treatment facilities, a bulletin directed primarily to treatment facilities committees be instituted. This recommendation be referred to the appropriate trustees’ committees for implementation.

**1983** It was recommended that:

A copy of the *Treatment Facilities Bulletin* with a cover letter be sent to alcoholism treatment facilities. The cover letter is to suggest that the facilities get in touch with Alcoholics Anonymous.

Delegates ask their treatment facilities committees or other appropriate committees to compile a mailing list of alcoholism treatment facilities in their areas for the purpose of establishing a G.S.O. mailing list for the *Treatment Facilities Bulletin*.

**1984** It was recommended that:

We affirm the 1978 Conference action which is as follows:

“A.A. members who meet with the administration of a treatment facility concerning the formation of an A.A. group on its premises should explain group autonomy as well as what A.A. can and cannot do (Traditions), and also should have a good understanding of the facility’s rules and regulations. After mutual agreements are reached, it is important that this information be shared with the A.A.s who will be attending the group’s meetings. It was suggested that groups meeting in treatment facilities try to abide by the self-support Tradition. If money for rent is not accepted by a facility, groups should contribute in some other way. It was also felt that A.A.s employed by the facility should not run the groups at the facility.”

<sup>1</sup> For pre-1978 actions related to treatment facilities, see Institutions.



A draft of a treatment facilities workbook be prepared by the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities in time for the 1985 General Service Conference.

The Guidelines on Correctional and Treatment Facilities Committees be separated.

**1985** It was recommended that:

The draft of the Treatment Facilities Workbook be approved, with minor changes, for production and distribution.

In the Scope of the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee, the sentence "The purpose of the committee will be to encourage A.A. members to assume responsibility to carry the message to alcoholics who cannot, of their own free will, seek A.A. help" be changed to "The purpose of the committee will be to encourage A.A. members to assume responsibility to carry the message to alcoholics in treatment facilities."

The Treatment Facilities, Correctional Facilities, and Cooperation With the Professional Community Workbooks be translated into Spanish. (Floor Action)

**1986** It was recommended that:

To more explicitly state the scope of the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities, under Scope, the paragraph:

"The purpose of the committee is to encourage A.A. members to assume responsibility to carry the message to alcoholics in treatment facilities"

be changed to the following paragraph from the Treatment Facilities Guidelines which reads:

"The purpose of a treatment facilities committee is to coordinate the work of individual A.A. members and groups who are interested in carrying our message of recovery to alcoholics in treatment facilities, and to set up means of 'bridging the gap' from the facility to the larger A.A. community."

That the letter in the Treatment Facilities Workbook which addresses the issue of nonalcoholics' attendance at closed A.A. meetings be revised to provide a more sensitive introduction to the subject as follows: the sentence "It has been brought to our attention that *nonalcoholic drug addicts* are attending A.A. meetings in your facility" be changed to "It has been brought to our attention that *nonalcoholic drug addicts* may be attending A.A. meetings in your facility."

Item 5 of the "Suggested Do's" for the treatment facilities chairperson (page 79 of the Treatment Facilities Workbook) be changed from "Play some Grapevine cassette tapes—always good listening and learning" to read: "Play some Grapevine cassette tapes—always good listening and learning, and leave some copies of the A.A. Grapevine."

Each area treatment facilities committee conduct workshops, as frequently as needed, to effectively utilize the Treatment Facilities Workbook.

Treatment facilities committees send liaisons to other service entities' meetings in their area and, in turn, invite them to send liaisons to the treatment facilities committee meetings.

The trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities study ways to develop contact sponsorship committees for prospective newcomers just leaving treatment facilities and report back to the 1987 Conference.

The pamphlet "A.A. In Treatment Centers" be revised as follows:

The A.A. Grapevine be added to the list of literature suggestions in paragraph 5 on page 13. The paragraph will read as follows:

Leaving a few pieces of A.A. Literature and a copy of the A.A. Grapevine is a good idea, too. Maybe "If You Are a Professional...", "A.A. in Your Community," "A.A. at a Glance," and "Where Do I Go From Here?" Maybe even this pamphlet.

The words "regular" A.A. group in paragraph 1 on page 12 and "treatment center meetings" in paragraph 5 on page 12 be highlighted by using italics.

Paragraphs 4 and 5 on page 7 of the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Centers" be revised to accommodate information on the Treatment Facilities Workbook. The revised paragraph will read as follows:

The Treatment Facilities Workbook (available from G.S.O.) contains Guidelines, sample letters, workshop presentations and other information useful to local treatment facilities committees who are carrying the A.A. message into treatment centers. The pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate With Other Community Efforts to Help Alcoholics" answers specific queries on working within A.A. Traditions, and the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" gives suggestions for helping the newcomer who may have had exposure to A.A. in a treatment center.

The title of the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Centers" be changed to "A.A. in Treatment Facilities," as "facilities" is currently a more generally used term. It was also recommended that the word "facilities" replace the word "centers" throughout the body of the pamphlet.

**1987** It was recommended that:

The following phrase in the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Centers," "Since A.A.'s co-founders first got sober by carrying the A.A. message into treatment centers. . ." be changed to read: "Since one of the ways A.A.'s co-founders helped maintain their sobriety was by carrying the A.A. message into hospitals. . ."

The report, developed in response to the 1986 General Service Conference recommendation that the trustees' committee on Treatment Facilities study ways to develop contact sponsorship programs, be returned to the trustees' committee to develop a service piece to be added to the *Treatment Facilities Workbook*. Also, that the trustees' committee prepare this service piece using only shared experience that reflects strict adherence to the Traditions. (Some of the sharing in the initial report reflected violations of the Traditions.) Also that the service piece include sharing from both successful and unsuccessful contact sponsorship programs and that the format include sharing that reflects contact sponsorship programs in various stages of development.

The word "larger" be deleted from the "Scope" section of the Composition, Scope and Procedure. The revised "Scope" will read as follows: The purpose of a treatment facilities committee is to coordinate the work of individual A.A. members and groups who are interested in carrying our message of recovery to alcoholics in treatment facilities, and to set up means of "bridging the gap" from the facility to the A.A. community.

The 1986 Conference Action that "each area treatment facilities committee conduct workshops, as frequently as needed, to effectively utilize the Treatment Facilities Workbook" be reaffirmed. Also, that the workshops include groups and district committees.

The 1986 Conference Action that "treatment facilities committees send liaisons to other service entities' meeting in their



area and, in turn, invite them to send liaisons to the treatment facilities committee meetings" be reaffirmed.

**1988** It was recommended that:

An audiovisual presentation for Treatment Facilities including three minutes of sample footage be made and brought to the 1989 General Service Conference for further review.

The following topics be included in the film:

- a. What A.A. is and is not
- b. Anonymity
- c. Traditions
- d. Steps
- e. Meeting types
- f. Sponsorship
- g. Home Groups

The film be appropriate for use by all other related committees, A.A. groups, and as an additional tool for our Twelve Step work.

The cost of the sample footage be in the neighborhood of \$17,000.

The newsletter drafted by the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities for annual distribution to Treatment Facilities chairpersons be a quarterly newsletter whenever possible and reflect shared experience from other areas on how they are solving problems related to treatment facilities.

The word "educate" in the introductory statements of the proposed newsletter to Treatment Facilities chairpersons be deleted in favor of the word "inform," in keeping with A.A.'s tradition of sharing rather than educating.

**1989** It was recommended that:

A 15-minute film be produced for A.A. members carrying the message into treatment facilities and be presented to the 1990 General Service Conference.

**Note:** Although the following item did not receive the necessary two-thirds vote to become a Conference recommendation, it did receive a substantial majority and is therefore a strong suggestion for the board's consideration.

"Suggested that in the proposed film for treatment facilities that the Louis B. segment of the script be deleted because of implied endorsement of Narcotics Anonymous."

**1990** It was recommended that:

The film "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous" be accepted as presented to meet an expressed need from the A.A. members carrying the message into treatment facilities; and that the film be translated into French and Spanish, and be captioned for deaf and hearing-impaired alcoholics, consistent with recommendations for our other recent videos.

The following 1988 Conference Action be reaffirmed:

"The newsletter drafted by the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities for annual distribution to treatment facilities chairpersons be a quarterly newsletter whenever possible, and reflect shared experiences from other areas on how they are solving problems related to treatment facilities."

The "Treatment Facilities Newsletter" mailing list be expanded to include district committee members, as well as delegates, alternate delegates and trustees; and that the 1991 Conference reevaluate the need for this newsletter.

There be a pamphlet on "Bridging the Gap" developed through the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee in conjunction with the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee; and that it be brought back to the 1991 General Service Conference for consideration. (Floor Action)

**1991** It was recommended that:

The manuscript prepared by the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities for a pamphlet on bridging the gap be approved, because of the need to encourage A.A. members to serve as temporary contacts to help the alcoholic in treatment make the transition into A.A.

The "Treatment Facilities Newsletter" be distributed semi-annually for the purpose of sharing information among committees carrying the A.A. message into treatment facilities, and that it continue to be mailed to district committee members, delegates, alternate delegates and trustees in addition to members of treatment facilities committees. Estimated cost: \$5,500.

Once supplies are depleted, the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities" be revised to include information about "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous" and other Conference-approved videos/films relevant to treatment, by inserting the following text just preceding "A few plain suggestions. . .":

The video "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous" explains the principles of A.A. and is a wonderful tool for A.A.s making presentations to administrators and staff as well as carrying the message of recovery.

**1992** It was recommended that:

The six points defining an A.A. group in the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities" be deleted, and that the definition of a group in the pamphlet be consistent with the definition of a group in the "A.A. Group" pamphlet.

The following paragraph be added to pamphlets directed to treatment facilities professionals to provide them with as much information as possible:

"Many local A.A. service committees will, upon request, provide informational presentations for your organization. Sessions can be tailored to meet your needs. A typical agenda might include one or several A.A. films and presentation by one or more A.A. members on 'What A.A. Is and What It Is Not.'"

"Please check your local telephone directory or newspaper for the number of Alcoholics Anonymous."

The following sentence of the third paragraph on page 1 of the "Bridging the Gap" pamphlet be removed from all subsequent printings as the Membership Survey is not specifically related to the temporary contact program: "Responses to questions in the most recent Membership Survey indicate that approximately 50% of those coming to A.A. for the first time leave within three months."

The words "temporary sponsor" and "sponsorship" on pages 8 and 13 of the "A.A. in Treatment Facilities" pamphlet be replaced with the words "temporary contact(s)" when the current supply is depleted, to reflect current A.A. terminology.

A.A.W.S. retain a three-ring binder format for the Treatment Facilities Workbook.

**1993** It was recommended that:

In an effort to guide members more fully in understanding Twelfth Step activity with prospective members, the pamphlet "Bridging the Gap" be revised in two sections as follows:



In the section "Temporary Contact Guidelines"—

- a. "Keep in mind that this is basic Twelfth Step work.
- b. "Experience suggests that it is best to be accompanied by another A.A. member when meeting our newcomer. One of the two temporary contacts should have at least a year of sobriety.
- c. "Experience also suggests that men work with men and women work with women.
- d. "The intent is to provide the newcomer with your help for a limited time. You need not have experience with treatment facilities. Your qualifications are experience as an alcoholic and recovery in A.A.
- e. "It may be helpful for you as a temporary contact to attend workshops on bridging the gap and attend meetings of your area's hospital and/or treatment facilities committees."

The above would replace the following:

- a. "It is suggested that the temporary contact be sober one year or more.
- b. "Keep in mind that this is basic Twelfth Step work. The intent is to provide the newcomer with your help for a limited time. You need not have any experience with treatment facilities. Your qualifications are experience as an alcoholic and recovery in A.A. It may be helpful for you as a temporary contact to attend workshops on Bridging the Gap and be a member of your area's treatment facilities committee or hospital committee."

In the section "Points to Remember"—

"A.A. does not provide housing, food, clothing, jobs, money or other welfare or social services.

"The professional treatment facility is in charge of its patients or clients and is responsible to them. While we cannot compromise our A.A. Traditions, we should remember that we are there as guests of the facility, and must abide by their rules. We are there to carry the A.A. message to the newcomer, and to answer any questions regarding the A.A. program of recovery and the A.A. way of life. Statements that may be interpreted as medical or psychological diagnosis or advice on medication should be avoided. We are there only to share our experience of staying away from one drink, one day at a time, through the program of Alcoholics Anonymous.

"In many cases, months of hard work have gone into establishing a relationship which enables us to be invited into a facility. A careless action could destroy that trust and interfere with carrying the message. If problems arise, inform the local service committee. They may wish to present an A.A. informational meeting.

"No one speaks for A.A. as a whole. When we carry the A.A. message to those in treatment, we are just one drunk talking with another. How we look, act and talk may be all they are going to know about Alcoholics Anonymous. Since we may be seen as part of A.A., let our new friends see, hear and talk to a winner!"

The above would replace the following:

"A.A. does not provide housing, food, clothing, jobs, money or other welfare or social services.

"The professional treatment facility is in charge of its patients or clients and is responsible to them. If A.A. members do not conform in every way to the rules and

regulations of the facility, it has a perfect right to keep A.A. members out. A.A. members go into treatment facilities as guests. Avoid statements or situations that may be interpreted as medical or psychological diagnosis or prognoses or advice on medications. Avoid challenging the teachings of the facility; guide the newcomer to A.A. membership and the A.A. way of life.

"Some of these suggestions may be strongly stated. In many cases, months of hard work have gone into establishing a relationship which enables us to be invited into a facility. A careless action could destroy that trust and interfere with carrying the message.

"When we carry the A.A. message to those in treatment, we are not just one drunk talking with another. While no one speaks for Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole, how we look, act and talk may be all they are going to know about Alcoholics Anonymous. Since we may be seen as part of A.A. let our new friends see, hear and talk to a winner!"

Minor editorial changes in the "Bridging the Gap" pamphlet be accepted.

A.A.W.S. consider production of an A.A. poster similar to the one used by an area P.I. committee.

A.A.W.S. explore the production of an inexpensive pamphlet holder of durable material that could hold up to four different pamphlets in a format which may be free-standing or wall-mounted.

**1994** It was recommended that:

The proposed changes in the Treatment Facilities pamphlet be implemented with some editorial changes. The revised pamphlet is directed more toward A.A. volunteers than to treatment personnel. The testimonials have been removed and the Concepts have been added after the Steps and Traditions.

When the "Bridging the Gap" pamphlet is revised, the Personal Information page be retained but moved to the back page, with the deletion of the following information: home group, age, sobriety date, and sex. And, that the section entitled "If you would like to help..." be placed on the same page as the Personal Information. The last sentence of this section should read, "Or send it to the Treatment Facilities Desk General Service Office, Box 459, Grand Central Station, New York, NY 10163, so that G.S.O. can forward the information to your Area Treatment Facilities Committee."

**1996** It was recommended that:

A soft-cover Treatment Facilities Handbook be developed and a concise and streamlined version of the existing Treatment Facilities Workbook (three-ring binder) be produced.

The "Treatment Facilities Newsletter" be discontinued as the expressed need appears to have diminished.

**1997** It was recommended that:

A concise and streamlined version of the Treatment Facilities Workbook (three-ring binder) be accepted with minor changes.

The final draft of the soft-cover Treatment Facilities Handbook be accepted.

**1999** It was recommended that:

A soft-cover Treatment Facilities Kit, designated as service material, replace the current Workbook [3-ring binder] to be consistent with the other service committee kits. The committee recognized that much of the material in the Workbook was a duplication of Handbook materials.



**2006** It was recommended that:

The word “institutional” be deleted from the scope so that the second paragraph on the scope of the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities will read as follows:

“The committee will review all aspects of service to A.A. groups/meetings in treatment facilities and other noncorrectional environments and make recommendations for changes and/or improvements.”

The phrase “and other noncorrectional environments” be added to the scope of the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities so that it will read as follows:

“The purpose of a treatment facilities committee is to coordinate the work of individual A.A. members and groups who are interested in carrying our message of recovery to alcoholics in treatment facilities and other noncorrectional environments, and to set up means of ‘bridging the gap’ from the facility to the A.A. community.

“The committee will review all aspects of service to A.A. groups/meetings in treatment facilities and other noncorrectional environments and make recommendations for changes and/or improvements.”

**2007** It was recommended that:

The video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* be revised, retaining only the script, and that sample footage or a progress report be brought to the 2008 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities. **Note:** The cost would be approximately \$50,000.

**2008** It was recommended that:

The revised video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* be completed with minor changes and brought back to the 2009 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities for review.

**2009** It was recommended that:

The revised video, *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous*, be approved.

The committee’s scope be expanded to include service to Special Needs/Accessibilities committees and that the name of the committee be changed to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities/Special Needs/Accessibilities.

**2011** It was recommended that:

The recovery pamphlet “A.A. for the Alcoholic with Special Needs” be approved.

The name of the committee be changed to the Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities and that these changes be reflected in the committee’s Composition, Scope and Procedure.

The title of the pamphlet “A.A. in Treatment Facilities” be changed to “A.A. in Treatment Settings” and that the term “treatment facilities” be replaced with a more appropriate reference such as “Treatment Committees” or “treatment settings” wherever it appears in the pamphlet.

**2016** It was recommended that:

The term “Special Needs” be removed from the name of the Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities and throughout the committee’s Composition, Scope and Procedure. The new name of the committee will be the Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.

**2017** It was recommended that:

The pamphlet “A.A. for the Alcoholic with Special Needs” be approved with suggested editorial changes and be retitled “Accessibility for All Alcoholics.”

**2018** It was recommended that:

The title of the pamphlet “Accessibility for All Alcoholics” be changed to “Access to A.A.: Members Share on Overcoming Barriers.”

The proposed changes by the trustees’ Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities to the pamphlet “Accessibility for All Alcoholics” be approved with additional revisions.

The Scope of the Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities be expanded as follows (additions in **bold**):

The purpose of a Treatment and Accessibilities committee is to coordinate the work of individual A.A. members and groups interested in carrying our message of recovery to alcoholics in a wide variety of treatment settings, and to set up means of “bridging the gap” from the treatment setting to the A.A. **Fellowship. In addition, the committee supports the work of individual A.A. members and groups serving those who experience barriers to accessing the A.A. message and participating in A.A.’s Three Legacies — Recovery, Unity, and Service. Finally, the committee supports the work of individual A.A. members and groups striving to ensure that A.A. members who live in underserved or remote communities — communities difficult to reach because of geography, language or culture — have access to the A.A. message.**

The committee will review all aspects of service to A.A. groups/meetings in non-correctional in-patient and out-patient treatment settings, as well as to **A.A.s who experience access barriers**, and make recommendations for changes and/or improvements.

**2019** It was recommended that:

Ashley’s story (an A.A. member who is Deaf) be added to the pamphlet “Access to A.A.: Members Share on Overcoming Barriers” and that the video version of the pamphlet be updated to reflect this change.

The pamphlet “A.A. for the Older Alcoholic – Never Too Late” be updated with a revised introduction; current and inclusive stories; reference to online A.A.; and an updated “How Do I Find A.A.?” section. The committee requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2020 Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.

The trustees’ Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities develop anonymity-protected audio interviews with military professionals about their experience with A.A. as a resource for posting online.

**2020** It was recommended that:

The pamphlet “Bridging the Gap” be updated for currency and inclusion to reach a broader scope of treatment settings about temporary contact services, and that a progress report or draft be brought to the 2021 Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.

**2021** It was recommended that:

The following audio interviews with A.A. members who are in the Armed Forces, developed by the trustees’ Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee, be approved and posted on G.S.O.’s A.A. website:

Male — Navy Captain

Female — Air Force Pilot

Male — Army Combat Medic



**2022** It was recommended that:

The Long Form of Tradition Five be added to the pamphlet “The A.A. Group” on page 12 in the section “What Is an A.A. Group?” at its next printing.

**Note:** As a result of the 2021-22 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, this item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.

**2023** It was recommended that:

- The revised pamphlet “A.A. for the Older Alcoholic—Never too Late” be approved with minor edits in a format that does not require folding.
- The 22 interviews recorded to date as part of the Military Audio project be approved, giving the General Service Office (GSO) the latitude to distribute the audio interviews in various formats and on various platforms, and that an update report be provided to the 2024 Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.

**2024** It was recommended that:

- The draft pamphlet “Bridging the Gap” (P-49) be approved with minor editorial revisions.
- The flyer “Where Do I Go from Here?” (F-4) be updated with current inclusive language and information on how to find A.A. both in person and online. The committee requested that a progress report or draft flyer be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.

**2025** It was recommended that:

- The update to the flyer “Where Do I Go From Here?” (F-4) be approved with the following change:

The sentence which currently reads:

- “This mutual understanding gave them the strength each desperately needed to pass up the first drink that had always paved the way to disaster.”

Be replaced with the following sentence:

- “This mutual understanding and program of recovery gave them the strength each desperately needed to pass up the first drink that had always paved the way to disaster.”



## Advisory Actions Relevant to the Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums<sup>1</sup>

Since the early days of the Conference, there has been an ad hoc International Convention Committee which met on an as-needed basis to make recommendations as requested by the trustees' Committee on International Conventions. Since 1993 the committee has met annually and has also addressed issues of Regional Forums. In 1995, the committee was renamed Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums. It is a secondary committee with eight voting members—one from each region. The committee meets jointly with the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums during the General Service Conference.

**1954** It was recommended that:

A proposal for a 20th anniversary meeting, open to all A.A.s (similar to the 1950 Cleveland meeting) to begin the day following the close of the '55 Conference be approved. The "Convention Committee" to cooperate in determination of a time and site, will include four persons designated by the Trustees and seven delegates. (Floor Action)

All arrangements for the proposed 20th Anniversary International Meeting, since they involve substantial financial commitments, be approved by the Board of Trustees. (Floor Action)

**1956** It was recommended that:

The next A.A. movement-wide Convention be held in California. It was understood that the privilege of determining the date, circumstances and other details of such a convention was reserved to the Trustees. (Floor Action)

**1958** It was recommended that:

Long Beach, California, be approved as the site for an International A.A. Convention to be held the weekend of July 1-3, 1960. (Floor Action)

**1960** It was recommended that:

Preliminary programming and arrangements for the 25th Anniversary International Convention in Long Beach, California, July 1-3, 1960, be approved and urged Delegates to make information about the Convention available in their Areas.

The holding of an International meeting in 1965 be approved. (Floor Action)

Consideration and discussion of possible sites for the 1965 meeting be deferred until 1961. (Floor Action)

The same procedures adopted in the case of the 1960 Convention in regard to the selection of the convention site be followed for the 1965 meeting. (Briefly, these permit any Area to submit proposals to the General Service Board during the coming year with the understanding that the Board will submit a report for consideration by Delegates to the 1961 Conference.) (Floor Action)

**1961** It was recommended that:

A 30th Anniversary International Convention of Alcoholics Anonymous be held in 1965 in Toronto, Ontario, Canada. In accordance with the procedures followed in arranging recent international meetings, the General Service Board reserved the right to make the final determination on financing, programming, site selection and other matters related to a movement-wide meeting. (Floor Action)

To release a short film based on footage ordered as a historical record of the 25th Anniversary Convention at Long Beach in 1960 for local or Area showings would not be compatible with the anonymity tradition in view of the difficulty of limiting such showings strictly to A.A. members. (Floor Action)

**1962** It was recommended that:

A proposal that the 1965 General Service Conference be held in Toronto, Canada, in conjunction with the 30th Anniversary Convention of A.A. scheduled to be held in July 1965 be rejected. (Floor Action)

**1963** It was recommended that:

The following statement of policies and procedures for the 30th Anniversary International Convention of A.A. at Toronto, Ontario, Canada, July 2-4, 1965, be endorsed and approved as submitted by the chairman of A.A. World Services, Inc.:

### GENERAL POLICY

In accordance with approved procedures, Convention plans will be in the hands of the following committees:

1. **1965 Convention Committee** of the General Service Board comprises the Chairman of General Services, the Chairman of the Public Information Committee of the General Service Board, and the Staff Member serving as Conference Secretary. This committee is responsible to the Board of Trustees and works closely with the **Convention Advisory Committee** and the **Convention Host Committee**. It has the responsibility of programming, meeting facilities, housing and feeding, registration, public relations, sale of literature, decorations and signs, and all arrangements with the Convention Bureau.
2. **The Convention Advisory Committee** comprises the Chairman, all current and past Ontario Delegates, current Delegates from other Canadian provinces, fifteen U.S. Delegates. This committee serves in an advisory capacity on matters of policy referred to it by the Convention Committee. The Canadian Delegates on the Advisory Committee have been responsible for the securing of the Guarantee Fund. Current Canadian Delegates of all provinces will be responsible for Advance Registration.

<sup>1</sup> Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.



3. **The Convention Host Committee** is a local committee. It may have as many subcommittees as deemed necessary and is responsible to the Chairman of the Convention Committee. The co-chairman of the Host Committee will coordinate Al-Anon Convention activities. Current subcommittees of the Host Committee are as follows:

- a. Courtesy Car Fleet Committee
- b. Decorating Committee
- c. Entertainment Committee
- d. First Aid Committee
- e. Housing Committee
- f. Greeters Committee
- g. Information Booth Committee
- h. Interpreters Committee
- i. Nursery Committee
- j. Registration Committee
- k. Special Events Committee
- l. Transportation Committee
- m. Visitation Committee

All plans concerning expenditures by the Advisory and Host Committees are to be cleared beforehand with the Chairman of the Convention Committee.

**The 1965 Convention Committee** of the General Service Board has the following officers:

|                         |                                                                            |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| As Chairman             | Herb Morse<br>(Chairman, G.S.O.<br>General Services)                       |
| As Public Relations     | Allan B. Chairman<br>(Chairman, Trustees' Public<br>Information Committee) |
| As Convention Secretary | Beth K.<br>(G.S.O. Staff Secretary<br>assigned to Conference)              |

#### **The Convention Committee**

|                        |                   |
|------------------------|-------------------|
| Chairman—Whit H.       | Treasurer—Tom T.  |
| Vice Chairman—Allen B. | Secretary—Russ M. |

The other members of the Advisory Committee at this time are shown on the attached list. Three U.S. Delegates will be added each year at the 1963, '64 and '65 Conferences. Newly elected Delegates will replace retiring ones from Canadian provinces other than Ontario.

**The Host Committee.** At a meeting of the Advisory Committee held on December 8, 1962, the following officers were elected:

Chairman—Jim L.                      Co-chairman—Edythe D.

### **Financing**

An amount in excess of \$6,500 has been collected in Canada for the Guarantee Fund; \$6,000 debentures were purchased from the Canada Permanent Mortgage Corporation, and set aside in a custody account (with first purchase of debentures earning 4 1/2%). Interest rates fluctuate and the last purchase made was at 5 1/4%.

Upon authorization by the General Service Board, \$6,500 from the General Fund has been placed in a thrift account at the Chase Manhattan Bank in New York City, representing the General Service Board's share of the 1965 Convention Guarantee Fund. No withdrawals are permitted on either one of these accounts until July 1965. Accumulative interest earned by the money in the Guarantee Fund will be turned over to the

General Service Board of A.A. and the monies returned to the owners if there is no deficit.

If deficit occurs, amount necessary to meet loss will be prorated on a dollar basis against the Guarantee Fund, as the General Service Board will share in any loss. Interest earned by the \$6,500 underwritten by the General Service Board and that earned by the Canadian deposits will be applied equally against the loss, if any. A cutoff date in Canada for contributions to the Guarantee Fund was set at July 31, 1963.

Preliminary Convention expenses to date are being advanced by A.A.W.S., Inc., and by the Ontario General Service Committee. The Chairman of the Convention will be kept informed of all expenses incurred.

### **Registration Fee**

A tentative registration fee of \$5.00 was set to cover meetings and panel discussions only. There may be an extra charge for entertainment and these arrangements will be handled by the chairman of the local Host Committee.

### **Advance Registration**

Advance registration will open March 1, 1964, and carry through November 15, 1964, in Canada only. General registration will open on January 15, 1965.

### **Convention Facilities**

Headquarters for the A.A. Convention will be the Royal York Hotel. The King Edward Sheraton Hotel will be the headquarters for the Al-Anon portion of the Convention. Manager of the Convention Bureau is Mr. John Moore.

An offer will be made to lease the facilities of the Maple Leaf Gardens for the large meetings to be held Friday and Saturday evenings and Sunday morning. The Gardens has a capacity of 13,000 including 2,000 on floor surface. A tentative hold has been made for three days at a rental of \$1,500 per day, but it is hoped that a lower lease figure can be negotiated.

Toronto Convention Bureau will handle all housing and registration at no charge—but will not handle money. The Chairman of the Convention Committee and the G.S.O. Accounting Supervisor will meet with the Bureau in 1963.

### **Publicity**

It was felt that the 30th Anniversary International Convention of A.A. be publicized only in the "Group Exchange Bulletin" and the "Grapevine" during 1963.

### **Future Meetings**

The Host Committee and subcommittees will have organizational meetings in the first six months of 1963. No meeting of the Advisory Committee is required until the fall of 1963.

**1964** It was recommended that:

"Policies and Procedures for the 30th Anniversary International Convention be approved. In accordance with approved procedures, Convention plans will be in the hands of the following committees:

1. *1965 Convention Committee* of the General Service Board comprises the Chairman of General Services, the Chairman of the Public Information Committee of the General Service Board, and the staff member serving as Conference Secretary. This committee is responsible to the Board of Trustees and enjoys the help of the



*Convention Advisory Committee* and the *Convention Host Committee*. It has the responsibility of programming, meeting facilities, housing and feeding, registration, public relations, sale of literature, decorations and signs, and all arrangements with the Convention Bureau.

2. *The Convention Advisory Committee* comprises the Chairman, all current and past Ontario Delegates, current Delegates from other Canadian provinces, eighteen U.S. Delegates (twenty-one in 1965). This committee serves in an advisory capacity on matters of policy referred to it by the Convention Committee. The Canadian Delegates on the Advisory Committee have been responsible for the securing of the Guarantee Fund. Current Canadian Delegates of all provinces will be responsible for Advance Registration.
3. *The Convention Host Committee* is a local committee. It may have as many subcommittees as deemed necessary and is responsible to the chairman of the Convention Committee.

The preparation of a small edition of Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions to be introduced at the 30th Anniversary Convention in 1965 be approved. (Policy)

**1965** It was recommended that:

Approval be given to reports on the preparation of a book entitled "A.A./30" being prepared for sale at the 30th Anniversary International Convention of A.A.

A suggestion that Convention Funds be used to defray expenses incidental to attendance at the Convention by certain early A.A. members not be approved but suggested that Area Committees might be interested in such projects.

An invitation to hold an International Convention in Colorado be added to the existing file of bids for a 1970 International Convention.

**1966** It was recommended that:

Miami, Florida, be the site for A.A.'s 35th Anniversary Convention in 1970 and that Chicago, Illinois, be designated as second choice. (Floor Action)

**1971** It was recommended that:

The following cities, in order of choice, be considered for the 1975 A.A. Convention: Denver, Seattle and Detroit.

**1974** It was recommended that:

Recommendations of the 1972 Conference be confirmed:

The number of non-A.A. speakers be limited, and that they be people who are interested in A.A. and alcoholism.

There be at least one A.A. meeting held at the same time non-A.A.'s are speaking, so that members will have a choice.

Speakers on the Sunday spiritual panel be A.A. members.

Al-Anon be requested not to hold the Sunrise Meeting at Red Rocks because it might interfere with the buses needed for the A.A. Sunday morning spiritual meeting.

The Host Committee have the responsibility for planning and handling the luncheon for delegates, past delegates, trustees, and past trustees.

First flyer on the Convention will be mailed in the fall, with information about Denver, the weather, and other pertinent data.

**1975**

The committee accepted the trustees' Convention Committee report as read by Don Austin, chairman.

The Convention Committee reported that there are 12,000 registrations as of April 24; Registration deadline is May 15.

There will be: two Big Meetings—Friday night and Sunday morning; the Big Show on Saturday night; 34 Alkathon A.A. meetings; 12 Panel Meetings; 12 Workshops. Two guest speakers, one A.A. speaker, and a trustee/director chairman will make up the panels.

The luncheon for past and present delegates and trustees will be Saturday, July 5, in the Holiday Inn Downtown. The price is \$6.50 per person, and a letter went to all concerned on April 16, 1975.

A Convention evaluation questionnaire will be distributed to all registrants with their badges. Some items on the questionnaire include ratings of meetings, food, housing, and transportation.

Convention meetings will open with the Serenity Prayer and close with the Lord's Prayer.

The concept presented by Dr. Norris on conferences in which staff and trustees would visit in the regions and work with local service people should be further explored and developed. (Floor Action)

**1976** It was recommended that:

Al-Anon be allowed one vote on the Convention Site Committee at the 1980 International Convention. (Floor Action)

We go forward with mini-conferences and provide them as often as possible, and that these be held at the request of the region. The sense of the meeting was that for the time being the regional meetings be known as A.A. regional forums. (Floor Action)

The Conference approve the Convention Site Committee's selection as follows: (1) New Orleans, (2) Houston, (3) Seattle. (Floor Action)

**1977**

After discussion, it was decided that there was no substantial unanimity regarding the showing of the 1960 International Convention film at regional forums, and it was also decided that the subject should be discussed in the areas before a final decision is made. It was also suggested that an additional print be obtained and safeguarded. (Floor Action)

**1978** It was recommended that:

The film of the 1960 International Convention in Long Beach, Calif., be kept for archival purposes only. (Floor Action)

**1979** It was recommended that:

The report of the trustees' International Convention Committee be accepted as read.

The staff report on the 1980 International Convention be accepted as read.

The number of non-A.A. speakers to be invited to participate in the 1980 International Convention remain the same (21) as at previous International Conventions.

Three commercial taping organizations be invited to establish guidelines and submit bids for providing the equipment to tape the 1980 International Convention. It was further recommended that the services of A.A. volunteers be utilized to do the actual taping with the guidelines established by the firm providing the equipment. It was felt that this procedure would cut the retail cost of the tapes to about 50% of the cost of tapes from the 1975 International Convention.



Box 4-5-9 publish information on:

- a. Convention services for deaf A.A. members
- b. Convention policy regarding travel agencies and their handling of registration and reservation forms
- c. When registration and reservation forms will be available

The 1980 International Convention include showing(s) of the films, "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions" and "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View."

The general manager of G.S.O. personally inform area delegates of invitations to A.A. members in their respective areas to chair major functions of the International Convention prior to issuance of the invitations.

Simultaneous translation services (depending on foreign registration) be provided free of charge at the 1980 International Convention. (Floor Action)

**1980** It was recommended that:

Simultaneous translations in French, Spanish, and German be provided at no charge for the Big Meeting on Friday night and the Spiritual Meeting on Sunday morning.

**1981** It was recommended that:

The report of the 1985 International Convention Site Selection Committee be accepted; first, second, and third choices as follows: (1) Montreal, (2) San Diego, (3) Minneapolis.

Complete financial reports of the International Conventions be published in the *Final Conference Reports*, including the 1980 International Convention.

All future events, such as the International Convention, not be planned to operate on a deficit basis, and it was also recommended that all future events of this type be self-supporting. (Finance)

**1983** It was recommended that:

We send an invitation to a friend of A.A. to share with us spiritually on Sunday morning at the 1985 International Convention; and we would like that person to be a member of Al-Anon. (Floor Action)

**1984** It was recommended that:

The principal speakers at the major A.A. meetings all be A.A. members, as it has been at our A.A. International Conventions in the past.

Due to the 1985 International Convention, state, local and provincial convention committees be alerted to the possible effect on attendance at local conventions held between May 10 and August 23.

**1985** It was recommended that:

For public information purposes, we permit a TV camera to film the flag ceremony from afar at the Olympic Park Stadium.

Because the Convention questionnaire is not helpful from one Convention to the next, we discontinue its use.

**1986** It was recommended that:

Three cities be specified for the 1990 International Convention: Houston, Texas; Seattle, Washington; Vancouver, British Columbia.

**1987** It was recommended that:

The 1988 General Service Conference select three cities for the 1995 International Convention; and that the Convention Site Selection Committee not determine its preference for first,

second or third choice and that the top three cities be given equal consideration by the 1988 General Service Conference. The final selection of the site will be made by the General Service Board in July 1988, following an inspection trip by the Convention Site Selection Committee.

**1988** It was recommended that:

Four cities be specified for the 1995 International Convention (in alphabetical order): Atlanta, Georgia; Minneapolis/St. Paul, Minnesota; San Diego, California; Toronto, Ontario, Canada.

**1989** It was recommended that:

State, provincial, and regional convention committees be alerted to the possible effect on attendance at local conventions held between May 11 and August 24, 1990, due to the International Convention.

A TV camera be permitted to film the Flag Ceremony from afar at the Kingdome Stadium, if appropriate precautions are taken to protect the anonymity of those in attendance at the 1990 International Convention.

The number of non-A.A. speakers to be invited to participate at the 1990 International Convention remain the same (21) as at previous International Conventions.

The Registration Form for the 1990 International Convention include a statement on travel option discounts.

**1990** It was recommended that:

The Site-selection Guidelines for the International Convention in the year 2000 be approved as presented.

The 1990 International Convention posters in English, Spanish and French be sold in the registration area as mementos.

The Conference reaffirm the 1976 Conference Advisory Action, that a request from a bidding city's convention bureau for the names and addresses of Site-selection Committee members be denied, and this information be included in the bidding information sent to delegates. (**Note:** There was no advisory action to that effect in 1976. It was a recommendation included in the trustees' International Convention Committee report.)

The 1991 General Service Conference select three cities for the International Convention in the year 2000; and that the Convention Site-selection Committee not determine its preference of first, second, or third choice; and that the top three cities be given equal consideration by the 1991 General Service Conference. The final selection of the site will be made by the General Service Board in October 1991, following an inspection trip by representatives of the Convention Site-selection Committee.

There be a continuation of the Conference International Convention Ad Hoc Committee, which would also address issues of Regional Forums, through 1995. This committee, to be composed of one delegate from each region, could serve as the Site-selection Committee for the International Convention in the year 2000. The committee suggests this recommendation be reviewed in 1995 by the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions. (Policy/Admissions)

**1991** It was recommended that:

The undernoted three (3) cities, expressed here in alphabetical order, be given equal consideration as a site for the International Convention in the year 2000: Atlanta; Minneapolis; Toronto.



**1993** It was recommended that:

As at previous International Conventions, non-A.A. speakers be invited to participate at the 1995 International Convention, with the number not to exceed twenty-one people.

In response to the proposal to create a standing Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums, the 1990 General Service Conference Action #30 be reaffirmed as follows: (Policy/Admissions)

"There be a continuation of the Conference International Convention Ad Hoc Committee, which would also address issues of Regional Forums, through 1995. This committee, to be composed of one delegate from each region, could serve as the Site-selection Committee for the International Convention in the year 2000. The committee suggests this recommendation be reviewed by the 1995 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions."

**1994** It was recommended that:

An anonymity-protected photograph of the flag ceremony be taken at the 1995 International Convention.

**1995** It was recommended that:

The Conference Committee on International Conventions continue to meet on an annual basis, discussing Regional Forums when there are no International Convention items; and that the committee be renamed Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums. (Policy/Admissions)

**1996** It was recommended that:

The following four (4) cities, expressed here in alphabetical order, be given equal consideration as a site for the International Convention in the Year 2005: Atlanta, St. Louis, San Antonio, Toronto.

Any sitting delegate of the Conference International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee whose area is presenting at the General Service Conference as a possible International Convention site city withdraw from that committee and a replacement be selected. (Policy/Admissions)

**1998** It was recommended that:

As at previous International Conventions, non-A.A. speakers be invited to participate in the 2000 International Convention at A.A.'s expense with the number not to exceed 21 people.

**1999** It was recommended that:

An anonymity-protected photograph of the flag ceremony be taken at the 2000 International Convention.

The General Service Conference supports the General Service Board policy which states: "Whenever a discount or subsidy is that which would be offered to any other organization of similar size requiring a purchased service or product of similar character and magnitude, i.e., convention rates at hotels, it may be accepted. Whenever a discount or subsidy is partly or in total offered because we are Alcoholics Anonymous, it must be declined." (Finance)

**2001** It was recommended that:

The undernoted three (3) cities, expressed here in alphabetical order, be given equal consideration as a site for the International Convention in the Year 2010.

Detroit  
Indianapolis  
San Antonio

The bid process for city site-selection for International Conventions be moved forward from ten years to twelve years out from the event; site-selection taking place as follows:

Site-selection to occur in 2003 for 2015  
Site-selection to occur in 2008 for 2020

**2003** It was recommended that:

Up to 21 non-A.A. speakers be invited to attend the 2005 International Convention at A.A.'s expense.

**Note:** It is estimated that transportation, housing and meal reimbursement will be \$2,500 to \$3,000 for each speaker.

The under noted three (3) cities, expressed here in alphabetical order, be considered as possible sites for the International Convention in 2015:

Atlanta  
Indianapolis  
Vancouver

**2004** It was recommended that:

An anonymity-protected photograph of the flag ceremony be taken at the 2005 International Convention.

The General Service Conference support the General Service Board Policy as amended on November 2, 2003, which reads:

"Whenever a discount or subsidy is that which would be offered to any other organization of similar size requiring a purchased service or product of similar character and magnitude, for example, convention rates at hotels, it may be accepted. Whenever a discount or subsidy is partly or in total offered because we are Alcoholics Anonymous, it must be declined."

**Note:** The original board policy text contained the letters "i.e." which were replaced with the words "for example." The General Service Board amended the policy because "**for example**" more accurately reflected the intention of the 1989 trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums. The 1999 General Service Conference supported the Board's 1989 policy through an Advisory Action.

The committee noted the Additional Consideration of the 1999 Conference Committee on Finance which reads:

"The committee unanimously recognizes that the acceptance of discounts or subsidies in the form of cash causes discomfort to some members of our Fellowship. The committee suggests that any future negotiations regarding International Convention discounts or subsidies be carried out with this in mind."

**2005** It was recommended that:

An encrypted, anonymity-protected, delayed extranet broadcast of the 2005 International Convention Opening Flag Ceremony be approved.

**2008** It was recommended that:

The undernoted four cities, expressed here in alphabetical order, be considered as possible sites for the International Convention in 2020: Detroit, Michigan; Los Angeles, California; New Orleans, Louisiana; Vancouver, British Columbia.

Up to 21 non-A.A. speakers be invited to attend the 2010 International Convention at A.A.'s expense.

**2009** It was recommended that:

An anonymity-protected photograph of the flag ceremony be taken at the 2010 International Convention.



An encrypted, anonymity-protected Internet broadcast of the 2010 International Convention Opening Flag Ceremony be approved.

**2013** It was recommended that:

The undernoted three cities, expressed here in alphabetical order, be considered as possible sites for the International Convention in 2025:

Montreal, Quebec  
St. Louis, Missouri  
Vancouver, British Columbia

Up to 21 non-A.A. speakers be invited to attend the 2015 International Convention at A.A.'s expense.

**2014** It was recommended that:

An anonymity-protected photograph of the flag ceremony be taken at the 2015 International Convention.

An encrypted, anonymity-protected Internet broadcast of the 2015 International Convention Opening Flag Ceremony be approved.

**2018** It was recommended that:

The following two cities, expressed here in alphabetical order, be considered as possible sites for the International Convention in 2030: Indianapolis, Indiana; St. Louis, Missouri.

Up to 21 non-A.A. speakers be invited to attend the 2020 International Convention at A.A.'s expense.

**2019** It was recommended that:

An anonymity-protected photograph of the flag ceremony be taken at the 2020 International Convention.

An anonymity-protected Internet broadcast of the 2020 International Convention Opening Flag Ceremony be approved.

Anonymity-protected video footage with highlights of the 2020 International Convention be produced for maintaining archival footage of the Convention, as well as for sharing the spirit and enthusiasm of the 2020 International Convention.

**2023** It was recommended that:

- The committee recommended that the following three cities, expressed here in alphabetical order, be considered as possible sites for the International Convention in 2035:

Phoenix, Arizona  
Indianapolis, Indiana  
New Orleans, Louisiana

- The committee recommended that up to 21 non-A.A. speakers be invited to attend the 2025 International Convention at A.A.'s expense.

**2024** It was recommended that:

- An anonymity-protected photograph of the flag ceremony be taken at the 2025 International Convention.
- An encrypted, delayed anonymity-protected Internet video of the 2025 International Convention Opening Flag Ceremony be approved and that the video be placed on appropriate communication channels.
- Providing six options for closing the Big Meetings at an International Convention: The Serenity Prayer, Responsibility Statement, Declaration of Unity, the Third Step Prayer, the Seventh Step Prayer, or a Moment of Silence.
- Anonymity-protected video footage with highlights of the 2025 International Convention be produced for maintaining archival footage of the Convention, as well as for sharing the spirit and enthusiasm of the 2025 International Convention.
- That a delayed, anonymity-protected, digital access stand-alone product offering of the three Big Meetings be created.

**2025** It was recommended that:

- The following language be added to the IC/RF Composition, Scope, and Procedure under the Composition section: "The new chairperson and alternate chairperson are elected by written ballot at the final committee meeting during the Conference session from the first-year panel members and take office immediately following the Conference."

\*Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.